

Field Management Operations Guide (FMOG)

Index

- Ch. 1 – General Information - Pg. 2**
- Ch. 2 – Customer Service and Other Interactions - Pg. 8**
- Ch. 3 – Daily Procedures - Pg. 16**
- Ch. 4 – Weekly Procedures - Pg. 47**
- Ch. 5 – Semi-Monthly, Monthly, Semi-Annual, and Annual procedures – Pg. 55**
- Ch. 6 – Call Flow Guideline – Pg 61**
- Ch. 7 – Marketing Your Facility – Pg. 79**
- Ch. 8 – Unit Rentals – Pg. 91**
- Ch. 9 – Sugar CRM – Pg. 115**
- Ch 10 – Payments – Pg. 134**
- Ch 11 – Merchandise – Pg. 147**
- Ch 12 – Auctions – Pg. 156**
- Ch 13 – Accident and Emergency Procedures – Pg. 184**
- Ch 14 – U-Haul – Pg. 212**

Ch 15 – Computer Troubleshooting – Pg. 216

Ch 16 – Audit Preparedness – Pg. 222

Chapter 1:

General Information

This guide is the first place to look for answers to your questions. Please take the time to review and understand the material.

Other Resources

You can also use the following reference materials:

Baco Employee Handbook (available online on the ADP website)

SiteLink webinar tutorials:

<https://storable.teachable.com/p/sitelink>

SiteLink online help

SiteLink technical support: If you can't resolve your problem using the above resources, call SiteLink at 1-919-865-0789 and press 2 for technical support.

If you still can't find the answers you need, contact your Regional Manager (RM).

- **Forms**

Copies of all forms can be found on the Security Public Storage intranet:
www.wearesps.com

ADP Forms and resources

<https://workforcenow.adp.com/theme/index.html#/ResourcesTab/formsLibrary>

A limited number of forms are available online on the Security Public Storage website: <http://www.securitypublicstorage.com/customer-forms>.

Instructions for using the forms are provided in the appropriate sections of this guide.

Tip: Many managers print several copies of each form and keep them in a file for quick use.

Deviations Binder

Each manager maintains a binder called the “Deviations binder” to store copies of important documents related to the rental units in their facility.

To set up the Deviations binder:

- Get a 3.5-inch 3-ring binder.
- Inside the binder, put 12 dividers with tabs. Label the tabs with the months of the year.
- Within each month, you will file that month’s paperwork in chronological order, front to back. You will keep the paperwork for four types of transactions in the binder. Detailed information about each of these transactions is in **Chapter 8: Unit Rentals**:

Permanent discounts

A permanent discount (previously known as a “forever discount”) is one that the tenant receives every month.

Tenant referral discounts

A tenant who refers someone to Security Public Storage will get a discount based on the new rental.

Online reviews

Every week, you will track the online reviews that your facility has received, and you’ll file copies of any reviews that result in a \$15 discount for a tenant.

Insurance deviations

When a tenant has homeowners’ or renters’ insurance that will also cover the contents of their storage unit, ask for a copy of the policy showing this coverage.

Update the Deviations binder **daily** as you get paperwork. This binder should **always be available on demand** and might be needed for future facility audits.

At the end of each year: Remove the binder’s contents and store the paperwork in a labeled manila envelope. Place the envelope in a file box labeled with the year and the contents. If the corporate office ever needs to review anything for audit purposes, you must have easy access to this information.

•

Petty Cash

Every Security Public Storage (SPS) manager is given a petty cash fund when they are hired. The maximum for this fund is \$200, depending on the facility's needs. Where you keep the petty cash is up to you, but it **must always be separate from the \$200** that is kept in the cash drawer for

doing daily business. Most managers keep the petty cash fund in an envelope in the safe.

Important: Petty cash must always be available on demand at a supervisor's request or during an audit. Never mix petty cash with your personal funds or store it in a bank account, on a prepaid credit card, or off site. **Failure to comply will result in written discipline, including termination of employment.**

You or an employee can make purchases for your facility and be reimbursed from the petty cash fund. However, if the purchase is for more than \$50, you must first get approval from your Regional Manager.

When you get down to about \$100 in the petty cash fund, submit a Petty Cash Request form to replenish the fund.

To submit a Petty Cash Request form:

- Gather all the receipts for which you've reimbursed yourself or your employees. Number your receipts in chronological date order. For example, receipt #1 is dated 1/3/2023, receipt #2 is dated 1/4/2023, etc.
- Fill out an SPS Petty Cash Request form.
- Total the receipts. This total plus the total remaining in your petty cash fund should equal the total petty cash that you normally keep on hand. For example, if you normally keep \$200 in petty cash, and your receipts total \$73, you should have \$127 remaining in your petty cash fund.
- Make a copy of each receipt and the request form, and file the copies in your facility records. Put the original receipts and the original report into an envelope and mail them to the corporate office.

- **Monthly Gas Allowance**

Every SPS manager has a single \$50 per month gas allowance. The manager pays for any gas used over this amount. To receive the gas allowance, fill out a purchase order at the beginning of each month and send it to Accounts Payable.

Note: This reimbursable expense should not be confused with petty cash.
Computer Usage

Important: Failure to comply with any of the following rules will result in written discipline, up to and including termination of employment.

Baco Realty Corporation owns, maintains, and services all computers, internet lines, peripheral devices, and data storage devices in its facilities. Baco Realty Corporation retains the right to monitor

and record all computer activity on any system whenever necessary. This includes but is not limited to:

- All computer keystrokes
- Data

- Telephone conversations, both incoming and outgoing

Audio and video recordings are made by security cameras that can record and view live, streaming video from each office.

Security Public Storage follows specific guidelines for acceptable use of the onsite computer systems at each facility. **Under no circumstance** is it acceptable to use company computers for personal use. This includes but is not limited to:

- Personal email, documents, and photos
- Games of any type
- Streaming video or music (Netflix, Hulu, Pandora, etc.)
- Chatting, instant messaging, Skype, and YouTube
- Facebook, Twitter, Instagram, Pinterest, and similar social networking sites
- Banking or other personal account management
- Non-work-related browsing

DO NOT distribute the company email addresses to discount or bargain websites that can lead to excessive spam and solicitation. Please be selective to whom you give the addresses.

DO NOT install any program on company computers without authorization; specific programs may interfere with system operation. This includes but is not limited to downloaded toolbars, search engines, widgets, utilities or trials, demo software, and similar program add-ins.

DO NOT store personal files, photos, or documents or use company resources to manage personal affairs.

DO NOT store your password for ADP on the work terminal; other employees will have access to your personal information.

DO NOT connect any personal computers, flash drives, cell phones, tablets, or hard drives to the existing network, computers, or peripheral devices (wireless or wired).

You may use the company computer system for any purpose related to the daily operations of the office and your daily duties as manager, including:

- Determining accurate mailing information, such as zip codes, etc.
- Finding local businesses for marketing purposes
- Viewing Google, Yahoo, Craigslist, Yelp, Superpages, YP, CitySearch, and related ratings and listings sites
- Checking company email
- Directory services (Yahoo, Yellow Pages)

All programs, files, and data contained in the company computer system are the property of Baco Realty Corporation and can be inspected at any time without prior notice to you. In addition, the data contained in the data files are the property of Baco Realty Corporation, and you are only permitted to use the data with respect to your duties as an employee of Baco Realty Corporation and in the capacity of your job duties at your respective facility.

It violates company policy to reproduce, distribute, or take off-site any information owned by

Baco Realty Corporation or Security Public Storage for any capacity outside of your job duties as described in your employment agreement.

Secret Shoppers

Several times during the year, the corporate office hires a “secret shopper” to shop in person at each facility.

The shopper will pretend to be interested in renting a unit. They will have a rating sheet and will check off the important points as you achieve them, such as standing and greeting the shopper, explaining honest pricing, and discussing the importance of having a quality onsite management team, to name a few. The shopper will rate you on the information you provide, the questions you ask about their needs, your general friendliness, etc., and will complete a report for the corporate office to review. If you’re using your Walk-In Guidelines whenever you handle an in-person inquiry, you should get a high score.

If you get a score of 90% or higher, you’ll be rewarded with a gift card based on the score, as follows:

Score	Reward
95% or higher	\$50 gift card
90%-94.9%	\$25 gift card

Important note: All leads must be entered in Sugar. Failure to enter a lead in Sugar voids any bonus eligibility, and written warning will be issued.

Chapter 2: Customer Service and Other Interactions

Office Dress Code

For a copy of the current SPS dress code go to:
www.wearesps.com

- Resources
- Dress Code Policy

Visitors to the Office

When someone comes into the office, you should give them your undivided attention and the courtesy of acknowledgement. Even if you are with another customer when someone arrives, take a moment to greet them and let them know you'll assist them as soon as you're finished with the customer you are with.

The following best practices should be observed when visitors come in to the office:

- Always stand when someone enters.
- Shake hands and introduce yourself.
- Call the tenant by name when you are able.
- Show a positive attitude and that you are willing to help resolve whatever they need.

Phone Calls

It is very important to avoid missing calls during office hours. This is a major priority, and it is important that each employee is aware of this and that everything possible is done to avoid missing calls.

The following best practices should be observed to accomplish this:

- **Taking a call when you're out on the property.** Always take your company iPhone when out on the property. If your iPhone is not properly functioning, report it to your RM immediately.
- **Taking a call when you have customers in the office.** It is your responsibility to multitask and answer any incoming calls. If you get a call while waiting on a customer in person, politely excuse yourself to that customer and tell them you'll simply get a phone number from the person calling and then be right back with them.
- **Taking a call when you're on another call.** Sales calls are very high priority. However, much like a customer in the office, most potential customers calling in will be completely understanding of a brief hold if you explain that you will simply get a phone number for the other person calling in and then be right back with them, then thank them for holding when you come back. Keep in mind that many of our competitors route their sales calls through automated call centers, so a 30-60 second hold won't be a major concern to most

potential customers. Return the secondary call promptly, because a missed call could be a missed rental.

- **Helping a U-Haul customer.** U-Haul is a very useful resource at many of our facilities and a great secondary product. However, we are a storage company first and foremost. Some facilities that are U-Haul dealers may have a separate U-Haul phone line. This is intentional and intended to help you always maintain storage as top priority. No Security Public Storage call should ever be missed for anything related to U-Haul.

- **Email**

The body text of all emails should be written in Arial 11-point font. Your automatic email signature should follow a strict format, as shown in the following example:

Joe Example

Onsite Manager

Security Public Storage

Office 209-566-2306

www.securitypublicstorage.com

Put only your name in bold type and everything else in regular type. All managers use the same title of **Onsite Manager** regardless of actual position (Associate Manager, Relief Manager, etc.). The address is listed on a single line. The phone number uses dashes and no parentheses around the area code. No additional lines will be added to this format (images/logos, fax numbers, office hours, or email addresses). If you need assistance configuring any of your email defaults, contact your RM.

Follow these instructions to add a new signature:

- In Outlook, go to **File**, then **Options**, then **Mail**.
- Select **Create or Modify Signatures**.
- Select **New**, then name the new signature with the employee name it will have.

Follow these instructions to change signatures:

- From an open email, select **Signatures** from the toolbar.
- Click on the name you wish to use as the email sender.

- **Sending messages**

If you send an email to multiple customers, **never** put them all in the **To** or **Cc** lines since this will share personal information between customers. Always put their addresses in the **Bcc** line. (If the **Bcc** line is not visible in Outlook while composing an email, go to Options and click the **Show fields Bcc** box).

- **Replying to messages**

Important: Be mindful of who you are replying to before hitting **Reply** or **Reply All**.

As a rule, when receiving an email with multiple parties in the **Cc** line, it indicates that the sender is expecting these parties to participate in the email discussion. An example of this would be the auctioneer sending you a question with your RM copied. This would be a time to use **Reply All** so that your regional manager can be included in your answer.

However, in another example, you would use **Reply** only. Let's say you are part of a group email with multiple facilities that asks for a specific document to be emailed to the sender. Unless specifically requested to reply to all, you would use only **Reply** to send the document to the original sender, omitting others from the chain.

Email Templates

Use the following email templates in the appropriate situations:

Auto Pay CC Did Not Process

Hello,

This is a friendly reminder that the credit card you have set up for automatic payments did not successfully process this month. As such, your payment is past due. If you would like to place a new credit card on file, I have attached a new credit card authorization form. We also offer ACH payments from your checking account. You also have the option of logging in to the website at www.securitypublicstorage/locations/ to update payment information and manage your account.

If you would like to save \$15 off on your monthly bill, please provide a review of our business on Facebook or Yellow Pages. Please let me know if you have any questions.

Auto Pay CC Has Expired

Hello,

The credit card you have set up for autopay for your storage unit has expired. I have attached a new credit card authorization form to this email. If you would like to place a new card on file or update the expiration date on the current card, please fill out the attached form and return it to us via email. Please let me know if you have any questions. Have a great day.

Auction

Hello,

This is _____ with Security Public Storage. I am emailing you regarding your unit at our

_____ facility. Your unit is currently __ days past due. The contents of your unit have been scheduled for auction on _____ at 12:00pm. Currently, your balance is \$_____. Rent will assess again on _____. Due to your account being in lien status, payments can only be made via cash, money order, or cashier's check. Payment in full, before the auction date and time stated above, is required to stop the auction of your items. Please let us know if you have any questions. We hope to hear from you soon.

Lead Follow-Up

Hello,

Thank you so much for your interest in storing your valued property with Security Public Storage. We enjoyed speaking with you about your needs, and we know that we are the right place for you to store your items.

We called and left a message at the phone number you provided as well, but we wanted to follow up on that conversation to make sure that you do not miss out on the unit that is just right for you. Please get in touch with us at (____) ____-_____ so that we can help lock in that unit for you. If we can get the unit locked in today, we can offer _____% off.

We look forward to hearing from you soon.

- **Spam Messages**

Important: You will receive spam email messages. These will often contain attachments or links that can compromise your computer if downloaded or clicked on. If you do not recognize the sender or receive a suspicious message asking for information that would normally be provided by the corporate office, do not reply to the message, open any attachments, or click any links. **If you're unsure about the validity of a message, contact IT for more information.**

Here are some things to consider when reading a suspect message:

- All corporate contacts will come from an email address formatted with a name, e.g., jsmith@bacoproperties.com. A legitimate corporate contact will never use a vague address such as fax@bacoproperties.com.
- Be very mindful of similar domains, such as bac0properties, securitypublicsstorage. A tactic that is often used is mimicking a known domain to try to get information or plant a virus.
- Occasionally there are data breaches, and you may get an email from a known sender from your domain making an unusual request, such as, "I need you to purchase some gift cards for X reason." This is almost always spam. When in doubt, call your RM or the sender of the email.
- Under no circumstance will you need to give out financial information about your facility to any third party. We will never use wire transfer services, such as Western Union, to complete any transactions.

- Messages that ask you to verify passwords, typically from Microsoft or other mail clients, are always spam; no reputable system will ask you to fill in or validate your credentials.
- Spam may appear to come from reputable business sources that we routinely conduct business with, such as ADP, Wells Fargo (or other financial institutions), UPS, FedEx, or other vendors.
- Messages indicating a prize or contest winning are suspect and should be considered as spam.
- Messages urging you to respond (or click a link) to avoid service interruption are most likely spam.
- Messages from senders posing as potential customers inquiring about storage with the intent to ship and/or receive to your property are usually spam.

• **Advertising Solicitations**

It is common to get solicitors from advertising companies. If a representative from Yellow Pages (or any other advertising or search engine optimization [SEO] companies) contacts you, simply inform them that the corporate office deals with all advertising, without exception, and that nothing can be authorized or discussed by the field offices.

If the representative insists on speaking with a supervisor or someone in charge of advertising, do not give out phone numbers or email addresses for any employees or any additional information about your facility or the company. You may offer to take down the representative's name and number and tell them you will pass it along, but also tell them that any future correspondence must come from someone at the corporate office and ask them not to contact your local office directly again.

When in doubt, ask a supervisor. Many solicitors sound convincing.

Customer Service Surveys – Net Promoter Score (NPS)

To ensure that we are providing the best possible customer service to our customers, surveys are sent to each customer at move-in and move-out. The surveys contain multiple questions about their experience with our company. The one question that determines our NPS score is, "How likely are you to recommend us to your friends or family?" The options for the customer to answer are 1-10.

The breakdown for responses is as follows:

The graphic below shows how the NPS Score is calculated:

You are encouraged to let your customers know that they will be receiving a survey, and the following examples can be used to have that conversation:

- “We’re so happy that you have chosen to rent with us. You will be receiving a survey in the next couple of days asking about your move-in experience. These surveys are important to us, and we hope that we provided you with an experience that rates as a 10.”
- “We’re sorry to see you go. Please know that we will always be here to help with your storage needs. You will be receiving a survey in the next few days to ask about your storage experience. We hope that we helped create an experience for you that allows you to rate us as a 10.”

Trustpilot

Trustpilot is an online review platform where consumers can write reviews about companies they do business with. Any consumer with a Trustpilot profile can leave a star rating for a business, and the platform uses the individual ratings to calculate a cumulative TrustScore from 1 to 5 for the business.

A score of 5 equates to “excellent,” while a 1 indicates a “bad” experience. However, the TrustScore is not simply an average of all existing reviews for the business. The company’s algorithm is affected by:

- **Time span** – More recent reviews are weighted more strongly than older ones.
- **Frequency** – The more frequently that companies collect their reviews, the more consistent their TrustScores will be.
- **Bayesian average** – Companies with few reviews are more likely to see large fluctuations in their scores. To counteract this, Trustpilot includes seven reviews with a 3.5-star rating to stabilize the overall score. When the business acquires more reviews, these initial 3.5-star ratings begin to have a smaller effect on the TrustScore.

In addition to the star rating, customers can enter comments about their experience with the company, such as the quality of its products and their experience with order fulfillment or customer service.

Chapter 3:

Daily Procedures

The following is a list of procedures that you must perform **DAILY** at your facility. In general, these procedures should be followed in the order presented.

- **Sign in to ADP at your scheduled time (within five minutes of the start of your shift).**
- All personnel must clock in when they begin work for the day and when they return from breaks or lunch.
- They must clock out every time they stop work, whether for lunch or at the end of the day.
- It is also mandatory for all Regional Managers (RMs) to approve their employees' timecards on the 9th and 24th of each month.
- All work must be completed on the clock, we have a zero-tolerance policy for off the clock work. If you need to clock in after your regular shift for any reason get approval from your regional manager.

Information about the ADP system is available online and is not discussed in this guide. For questions about ADP, contact your **Human Resources Manager**.

For clock in/clock out time adjustments, contact your **Regional Manager**.

- **Sign in to SiteLink within five minutes of clocking in.**

Important: The corporate office requires that you, or someone you designate, **sign in to SiteLink within five minutes after opening in the morning**. This will indicate that you are onsite and the office is ready for business.

SiteLink is the main tool you will use to manage your Security Public Storage (SPS) facility.

To sign in to SiteLink:

- Click on the SiteLink icon to open the software.

The **Corp Code** and **Location Code** fields are filled in with your facility information.

Note: The first time you sign in to SiteLink, make a note of your location code for future reference.

- Enter your **User Name** and **Password**.
- Click the **Login** button.
- Select **Perform the Start-of-Day Gate Update**, then click the **Continue** button.

The system will update the gate for any overlocks that have occurred overnight. You will handle overlocks in a different procedure later in this chapter.

 - You will see the SiteLink **Operations** screen.

On the lower left are your **Reminders**.

For most of your SiteLink activities, you will start either from this **Reminders** list or from one of the boxes on the main part of the **Operations** screen.

- Click the icon at the top right of the **Reminders** list to get the latest updates. The number to the right of each reminder indicates the number to be handled this morning.
- **Complete a role-play call/exercise.**
- **Remember to take a 30-minute lunch when working with another manager (before 5th hour of work shift). Alternate lunches.**
- **Run Start-of-Day Gate Update.**
- **Clear all alarms and update Graphics in Falcon/StorLogix.**

- **Balance daily cash.**

Important: Every morning before starting the day, you must count the cash and verify that it balances from the night before.

To complete the Daily Opening Cash Count:

- Go to your safe and pull out the cash. Before putting the cash into your cash drawer, you must physically count it and enter it in Sugar:
 - Open Sugar and click the **drop-down arrow next to “Daily Cash.”**
 - Click **Create Daily Cash Count.**
 - This screen will default to the “Opening Drawer(s)” tab. Enter the **name of the employee** who is physically counting the cash.
 - Enter the **quantities of each bill** next to the various denominations. *(The system will automatically convert the number of bills to the dollar amount it equals.)*
-
- Once you have entered all your cash in Sugar, click **Save** on the top right.
 - A message will appear saying the system has found several duplicates. Click **Ignore Duplicate** and **Save.**
-
- **Do daily banking and audit procedures.**

- **Send daily deposits.**
- You must send deposits via email by **10 a.m. on Mondays through Saturdays** and by **11 a.m. on Sundays.**
- **Notify your Regional Manager and the Internal Auditor if you cannot complete this as scheduled.**
- Email the deposit following these instructions:
- Send to Internal Auditor at **docs@bacoproperites.com** and copy your RM.
- Use the subject line “Deposit XX/XX/XXXX” (for example, “*Deposit 10/30/2023*”).
*The “**deposit date**” is the date of the **SiteLink closing paperwork.**
- Create the attachment and name it “Deposit XX/XX/XXXX” (for example, “*Deposit 10/30/2023*”).
- You must include the following in the attachment **(in this order):**
 - Copy of Loomis receipt

- Daily Deposit Report (**all pages**)
- Copies of checks for the day (preferred that the Daily Deposit Report shows all facing one direction, all legible)

***Important:** Make sure you view your attachment before submitting. Best practice is to CC your facility and when received to your inbox verify attachment and content.

Here are the common errors you should avoid:

- Not sending the deposit on time or failure to notify when unforeseen circumstances cause delay
- Not having the correct subject line when sending to Internal Auditor
- Not including the attachment or attaching the wrong attachment
- Not including all necessary documents (e.g., all pages of the closing paperwork, copies of checks, Loomis receipt)
- Not sending the documents in the correct order
- Inverting the closing numbers (for example, recording the cash as checks)
- Not processing checks correctly
- Not making sure the checks are legible when scanned/copied
- Depositing more or less cash into the safe due to change issues

Here is some information to help you avoid audit errors:

- When closing SiteLink, check the **View** box in the top left corner to verify that cash is being recorded as cash, checks are being recorded as checks, and credit cards are being recorded as credit cards. You must first enter an amount into a field before you can select the checkbox (for example, enter the cash amount, then select the checkbox **View**).
- When processing checks, look for the following issues:
 - Checks posted in the future (**cannot** post a check with a date in the future)
 - Checks not signed by the customer
 - Checks not made out to Security Public Storage. “SPS” is okay, but “Security Public Storage” is preferred. When customers are writing checks in front of you, make sure they use “Security Public Storage.”
 - Incorrect “written amount”
 - Incorrect “numerical amount”

***Important:** Check for these items while processing the checks AND at closing.
- When copying checks for sending, make sure they are:
 - All facing in the right direction (not sideways or upside down)

- In the order that the Daily Deposit Report shows them in
- Clear and legible (you may need to adjust the density or contrast on your printer, especially for money orders)
- All stamped on the back with the Wells Fargo stamp
- When emailing the deposit to Internal Auditor, view the attachment to make sure all of the above has been verified and that the scan is clear and legible. (Sometimes the copy is clear and legible, but when scanned, the documents are too light to read.)
- If you are unable to deposit the correct amount into the safe due to change issues, contact your RM.
 - As a best practice, there should always be small bills in the cash drawer and petty cash.
 - Whenever depositing a different amount into the safe, make a note in the body of the email to explain why so that the Internal Auditor knows.

- **Send other transactions to auditor, if applicable.**

There are some transactions that will not occur every day, but when they do occur, you must email the information to the auditor at audit@bacoproperties.com.

Here is a list of possible transactions:

- **Cash Discounts.**
- Email any Cash Discount addendums to audit@bacoproperties.com.
- **Cash Intent to Vacate.**
- Email any Cash Intent to Vacate forms with customer signatures to audit@bacoproperties.com.
- **Tenant Referrals**
- Email any Tenant Referral forms to audit@bacoproperties.com.
- Use the subject line "Referral Unit # XXXX" (for example, "Referral Unit # A101.")
- **Tenant Reviews**
- If a tenant has completed an online review to receive a credit, email the review and payment receipt to audit@bacoproperties.com.
- For the subject line, follow the format of these examples:
 - YP Review Unit # A101*
 - FB Review Unit # A101*
 - Sparefoot Review Unit# A101*
- **Approvals and Exceptions**
- If the site has sought approval from RM for waiving a fee or other exception,

send a copy of written approval and any transaction receipts to audit@bacoproperties.com.

- For the subject line, follow the format of these examples:

Exception Unit# A101

RM Approval Unit# A101

- **Respond to any email or phone messages.**

- **Storage Collections**

A Storage Collection is a courtesy text message sent to a tenant as a second reminder to pay before a late fee is assessed. Storage Collection texts are sent on the 10th, 25th, 40th, and 55th day that the account is past due.

To process Storage Collections:

- Go to the SiteLink **Operations** screen, then double-click **Reminders**, then **Storage Collections**.
- Select **All**.
- Select **Process**.

- **Send Past Due Notices.**

Send a Past Due Notice to a customer when the rent is **11 days late (5 days late in Maryland)**.

For more information about past due notices and the delinquency process, see the chapter about auctions.

To process and send past due notices:

- Go to the SiteLink **Operations** screen, then the **Reminders** list, then double-click **Past Due Notice**.
- Click on each account, checking to make sure the late fee has been assessed. If the fee has not been added, click on **Edit Charges & Payments** and add the late fee.
- In the **Selection** box, select the **All** checkbox.
- In the **Task** box, select **Print**.
- Click **Process**.
- A late fee is charged to each account (except in Maryland, which does not impose a late fee), and the Past Due Notices are printed.

- Make sure the **Balance Due** is correct.
- Sign the notices and put them in envelopes. Give to the mail carrier when the site mail is delivered.

- **Overlock delinquent units.**

You will overlock a unit when a tenant is **behind in their rent by 11 days (5 days in Maryland) and you have already sent a past due notice.**

This involves setting the unit as “overlocked” in SiteLink and placing an overlock on the unit so the tenant cannot access it. This process also prevents the tenant from entering through the gate.

Important: Maryland facilities physically lock units on the 10th day.

To overlock a unit:

- Go to the SiteLink **Operations** screen, then the **Reminders** list, then double-click **Overlock**.
- In the **Selection** box on the right, click **All** to mark the boxes next to all the tenant names you will overlock.
- Click **Print** to print a copy of the page for today. (Note: Double-click above **unit** to put units in numerical order.)
- Using the printed list, go to each unit and place an SPS overlock on it.
- Once the overlocks have been completed, Click **Process**.
- When you see a message telling you the process is complete, click **OK**.
- File the printout with the daily paperwork in your office files.

To reverse an overlock:

- Once a tenant has paid the balance due in full, you can reverse the overlock on their unit and remove the SPS overlock.
- In the **Select a Task** section, click **Reverse: Overlock**.
- Click **Days Late < 11**.
- Click **All**, then click **Print**. (Note: Double-click above **unit** to put units in numerical order.)
- Print the list.
- Remove the SPS overlock from the unit.

- Click **All**, then click **Process** when removal has been completed.
- File the printout with the daily paperwork in your office files.
- **Send pre-lien letters.**

Pre-lien letters must be completed by 10 a.m. on Mondays through Fridays and by 11 a.m. on Sundays. Do not process on Saturdays or on the day before a non-mailing holiday.

Send a pre-lien letter when the **rent is 26 days late (15 days late in Maryland)**. Pre-lien letters are part of the delinquency process that eventually leads to the auction of the unit's contents if the bill goes unpaid.

For more information about past dues notices and the delinquency process, see the chapter about auctions.

To process and send pre-lien letters:

- Go to the SiteLink **Operations** screen, then the **Reminders** list, then double-click **Pre-Lien Letter**.
- For each checked tenant, compare the SiteLink information for the unit with the rental agreement and any **Change of Address** forms that might be in the tenant file. **(Make sure to check online access for any changes.)**
 - **Important:** You must physically pull the tenant's file from the drawer and double-check the full address, spelling of the name, alternate contact, and phone numbers. If there are any discrepancies, **make the changes in the system before processing**. Also, it is a **legal requirement** that the full name (as entered on the rental agreement, including any middle initial or middle name) is recorded for the tenant's record to appear correctly on pre-lien letters.
- When you're sure all the information is correct, select **Print, Email, and Mail Service** in the **Task** box.
- Select the **All** checkbox in the **Selection** box on the right.
- The **Mail Service Preliminary Lien Notice** window opens.

Certified and Return Receipts are automatically checked for you in the **Primary** and **Additional Mailing** boxes for Nevada only. **Send Additional**

Mailing (just below the **Additional Mailing** box) is automatically selected.

Class and Certificate of Mailing are automatically checked for you in all California facilities' **Primary** and **Additional Mailing** boxes. **Send Additional Mailing** (just below the **Additional Mailing** box) is automatically selected.

For Virginia/Maryland facilities: **No Simple Certified** is required for Pre-Liens.

- Click **OK**.
- Print one copy of the tenant's file in the **Verify** box and send the letters to the mail service, SimpleCertifiedMail.com. You should have checkmarks in all of the relevant boxes.
- Click **Process**.
- You will be prompted to select a date. **The date must be 14 days after the date on which you mailed the past due notice. This is a legal requirement.** It is the last day before going into lien status and being scheduled for auction.

For example, if a past due notice was sent on Monday, January 9, the pre-lien letter must be sent on Monday, January 23, and **no earlier**.

Note: In **Maryland**, the date must be **30 days** after the past due notice is sent.

Once you've set the date, click **OK**. Double-check that the date is correct on the next screen.

The letters print automatically. These are for the site's records only, so file in tenant files accordingly.

- When the letters finish processing, you will receive a message that the process was successful. Click **OK**.
-
- If you receive a mailing error message, confirm the errors, make any fixes, and repeat the process for those tenants. For example, let's say an alternative address wasn't printed because the tenant didn't provide one. If, on checking the tenant's file, you see that there is an alternate address, make the correction in SiteLink. **You must then reverse the pre-lien letter and reprocess it. Instructions on how to reverse a pre-lien letter are below.**

To reverse a pre-lien letter:

- If you need to reverse a pre-lien letter, first **discard the printed pre-lien letter with the error**.
- Go to the SiteLink **Operations** screen, then the **Collections** box, then click **Tasks and Letters**.
- In the **Select a Task** section, click **Reverse Pre-Lien Letter**.

- Select the checkbox next to the tenant whose letter you want to reverse.
- Click **Process**.
That tenant's name will be moved to the **Pre-Lien Letter** section as if you had never processed it.
- **If you're reversing the letter on the same day you created it**, immediately email support@simplecertifiedmail.com or call them at 1-888-462-1750 to cancel the electronic letter before it is printed and shipped.
- **If you're reversing a letter that you created on a previous day**, you must send a new pre-lien letter. To resend, click **Pre-Lien Letter**, then follow the instructions in the previous section for normal processing.

- **Send lien letters (with auction date and time).**

Pre-lien letters must be completed by 10 a.m. on Mondays through Fridays and by 11 a.m. on Sundays. Do not process on Saturdays or on the day before a non-mailing holiday.

Send a lien letter **when the rent is 41 days late (45 days late in Maryland)**. Lien letters are the third step in the delinquency process, which leads to the auction of the unit's contents if the bill goes unpaid. The content of this letter includes a scheduled date for the auction.

For more information about past dues notices and the delinquency process, see the chapter about auctions.

To process and send lien letters:

- Check the auction calendar to **ensure that today's date is not past the auction cut-off date**. The cut-off date is **30 days prior** to the auction. If it is too late, use the next auction date for the letter. See the example below.

Important: Be very accurate when selecting this date. If you go through the lien letter process and the date is wrong, you must reverse the lien.

- Go to the SiteLink **Operations** screen, then the **Reminders** list, then double-click **Lien Letter**.
- For each checked tenant, compare the SiteLink information for the unit with the rental agreement and any Change of Address forms that might be in the tenant file. **(Make sure to check for online access for any changes.)**

Important: You must physically pull the tenant's file from the drawer and double-check the full address, spelling of the name, alternate contact, and phone numbers. If there are any discrepancies, **make the changes in the system before processing**. Also, it is a **legal requirement** that the full name (as entered on the Rental Agreement, including any middle initial or middle name) is recorded for the tenant's record to appear correctly on lien letters.

- Select the **All** checkbox in the **Selection** box on the right.
- Select the **Print**, **Email**, and **Mail Service** checkboxes in the **Task** box. **(CA, NV & OR sites only)**
- Click **Process**.

In the **Mail Service Lien Notice** window, First Class and Certificate of Mailing are automatically selected for you in the **Primary** and **Additional Mailing** boxes.

- Click **OK**.
- In the **Verify** window, print one copy for the tenant's file and send the letters to the mail service. You should have checkmarks in all of the relevant boxes.
- Click **Process**.
- You will be prompted to select the auction date. Select a **Date** and **Time** for the auction.

Important: You must select the auction's actual date and time (military time) for these units. For example, if the auction is on April 14, 2023, at noon, select that date and time. Be sure to check the cut-off dates before selecting the date and time.

- Click **OK**. Double-check that the date and time are correct on the next screen.
- When the letters are processed, the **Past Due Events** window lets you know it was successful.

Click **OK**.

- When prompted, print one copy for the tenant's file and make sure it is filed there.
- Double-check the auction date that was selected.

Important: If the date is wrong, contact the Auctions and Support Services Manager immediately. Find out if you can reverse the lien letter and resend it with the corrections or if you need to restart the process with a pre-lien letter.

- If you find any other errors now, such as a wrong address, **you must reverse both the pre-lien and lien letters and restart the entire process. See instructions below.**
- Fill in the **Auction Checklist** form with as much information as possible and put it in the tenant file.

This will save you time when you're getting ready for the auction. For more information about filling out this form, see the chapter about auctions.

To reverse a lien letter:

- Go to the SiteLink **Operations** screen, then the **Collections** box, then click **Tasks and Letters**.
- In the **Select a Task** section, click **Reverse Lien Letter**.
- Select the checkbox next to the tenant whose letter you want to reverse.
- Click **Process**.

That tenant's name will be moved to the **Lien Letter** section as if you had never processed it.

- Reprocess the **pre-lien letter** on the same day that you reverse the lien letter.* However, **do not reprocess the lien letter at the same time**. If you do, the pre-lien and lien letters will be sent on the same day.
- Instead, mark your calendar for when you need to reprocess the lien letter. They must be at least 14 days apart, that is, the lien letter must be sent on the 15th day (30 days apart, sent on the 31st day, in Maryland).

***If it has been more than a day since you sent the pre-lien letter,** you must start over and send a new one. To resend the pre-lien letter, click **Pre-Lien Letter**, then follow the instructions in the previous section for normal processing.

- **Process and print Final Notice of Sales.**

The Final Notice of sale is the fourth and final letter mailed to a customer prior to selling their belongings at auction. It is processed at 56 days past due (60 days past due in Maryland) and is accompanied with a \$40 fee (\$10 in Maryland and Virginia).

- Double click on **Final Notice of Sale** from your reminders board on Sitelink
- Check the box next to the customer's name and click **process**
- A small box will appear asking you to select the date and time of the auction. Physically pull the file and enter the auction date and time listed on the lien notice that was previously sent.

- Click **Ok**
- Another screen will pop up detailing the way the letter is being sent. Verify that the auction date and time listed at the bottom of this page is correct and then click **process**.
-
- A pop up will appear to print, click **OK**
- Another window will appear to send the customer an email. Click **Predefined Messages** and select the option listed as **Auction** from the drop-down menu. Click **Ok**
- A pop up will appear saying processing was successful, click **Ok**
- Two copies will print- put one in an envelope and get it prepared to be picked up with your mail and put the copy that says File Copy on the top into the tenant's file.
- **Best Practice: When processing the Final Notice of Sale, you can use a pastel pink or yellow paper. Doing this will make the notice stand out in the tenant's mail and make them more likely to address the notice as it gives the appearance of an urgent notice.**
-

- **Make collection calls.**

You should make collection calls when a tenant is 9, 24, 39, and 54 days late. **In Maryland, make the calls when a tenant is 4, 14, and 44 days late, as legally required.**

Make these calls two days before you send past due notices, pre-lien letters, and lien letters. Calling the tenant gives them another chance to make their payment.

On the tenant's 25th day late, begin calling every three days. (Reminder: Once a unit is in lien status, payment must be cash, money order, or cashier's check.)

There is no specific script to follow for these calls. Each call will be different, depending on the person you reach, but remember to be polite. Advise them that it's a courtesy call so that they will not incur additional late fees or be put into lien status (depending on when the call is made).

To make collection calls:

- Go to the SiteLink **Operations** screen, then the **Reminders** list, then double-click **Call Past Dues**.

- On the **Collection Calls** screen, click the **Days Late** column heading to sort the tenants by the number of days their payments are late.
- Call each tenant on their 9th, 24th, 39th, and 54th day late and every three days once they are 25 days past due. **In Maryland, call on the 4th, 14th, and 44th days late, and every day after that.**
- As you call each tenant, click on their name to make a note about the call.

For example, you might note that you called and left a message or talked with the tenant and reached a resolution. The date of the last note appears on the **Collection Calls** screen.

- **Review open maintenance tickets and follow up as appropriate.**
- **Print Daily Sales Plan from Veritec RMS. Keep it handy, along with a blank Call Flow Guidelines.**

- **Check for rental inquiries.**

- Check for phone, email, and needed follow-up in Sugar about rental information.
- Check callbacks every morning so that you don't keep potential tenants waiting.

- **Check move-in and move-out reports for new rentals.**

If contracts are complete, remove SPS locks.

- **Invoice your tenants.**

Invoicing must be done each morning. You can email the invoices or print and send them via regular USPS mail.

Note: For units scheduled for auction, continue to invoice them until they are auctioned off because their account is still delinquent.

To print and email invoices:

- Go to the SiteLink **Operations** screen, then the **Reminders** list, then double-click **Invoice**. SiteLink is set up to schedule invoices 15 days before the rent is due.
- Under **Selection**, select **All**. Both email and print invoices are selected.
- Click **Process**. You will see a verification message. Make sure that both **Print** and **Email**

are checked, then click **OK**.

- You will see this message: *Printing invoices will create charges for the next period's rent. Would you like to proceed?* Click **Yes**.
- You will see this message: *An invoice fee of \$1.00 will be charged to the selected tenants. (No charge created for 'no invoice fee tenants.')* Would you like to proceed? Click **Yes**.
- When prompted to print the printable invoices, click **OK**.
- When prompted to email the remaining invoices, click **OK**.
- When the processing is finished, you will receive a message that the process was successful. This means that the invoices have been printed and emailed to the tenants. Click **OK**.
- Put the invoices into envelopes. **Be sure to include a return payment envelope.**

- **Process automatic payments.**

For tenants who want to pay automatically via credit card or ACH, you must have them complete the Payment Authorization form and set them up in SiteLink for automatic payments. You must process automatic payments each morning.

To process automatic credit card payments:

- Go to the SiteLink **Operations** screen, then the **Reminders** list, then double-click **Credit Cards**.
- Ensure that the **Schedule Out** column is blank before processing automatic payments.
- **If no dates are shown**, Click **All** to checkmark all the tenants.
- **If a date is shown for any tenant:** This means the tenant is scheduled to move out (and should not be billed), but you did not remove the tenant from automatic payments. You can go back and fix this in the tenant's account now and restart this process, or, to continue now, manually select the checkboxes next to the accounts you want to process. **Do not select** the checkbox next to the names with a move-out date.
- In the **Process** box, click **Batch Process Checked Items**.
- You will see this message: *Would you like to process credit card payments for all checked tenants?* Click **OK**.
- You will see a message asking if you want to print a receipt for all processed payments. Click **No**.

(It is not recommended that you print a receipt since you can always go back and print later if needed.)

- You will see a third message asking if you want to email the receipt.
 - Click **Yes** or **No**, depending on whether you have any tenants with email addresses who want receipts for each payment. These receipts will be

emailed at the end of the process.

- You will receive a success message when the credit cards finish processing.
 - Click **OK**.
- If you have any credit cards listed as **Declined** or **Hold Card Call**, you will receive a message about them. Click **OK**.
- You will see a report listing the accounts that didn't process and the reasons for the failures. Click the red **X** to print the report for your records or for reference to contact the tenants.

To process automatic ACH payments and retrieve returns (NSFs):

- Go to the SiteLink **Operations** screen, then select **ACH to Submit**.
- Select **All** to check all pending submissions.
- Select **Process Transactions in SiteLink**.
- Select **Commit All Submitted Transactions**.
- Click **Yes** to confirm.
- Click **OK** to confirm completion
- Select **Check for Returns** with a date range of two weeks prior to the current day.
- The pop-up will indicate the number of days since the last search for returns. This number should never exceed two days.
- Click **OK** to confirm completion; if an ACH is found to be bad, it will automatically charge an NSF fee and remove payment from the tenant account.

Note: SiteLink will allow an ACH transaction to be reprocessed once returned.
Turn off ACH auto pay if ACH has been returned.

- **Check move-outs for units scheduled to move out prior to today.**
Address as needed.
 - In SiteLink, Click Reports
 - Double Click Scheduled Move Outs
 - Organize by date out
 - Verify whether or not customers have physically moved out of their units. If a customer has finished vacating their items make sure to sweep the unit, lock it with a green lock, and move it out of SiteLink.
- **Follow up on all leads that have not yet rented by using the Lead Status**

report.

- **Print rent change notices, as applicable.**

Changing the rent amount that is charged for a particular unit size can depend on varying factors. For example, the rent might increase on a unit size that is very popular in your area, or it might decrease on a size for which you have many empty units. The decision to change the amount of rent charged for a particular unit size is made by the corporate office.

Rental increases are processed on a day-to-day basis. You will be notified in SiteLink when to process rental increases. You will see **Print Rate Change** or **Pending Rate Change** in your **Reminder** bucket.

Once you're notified of a Print Rate Change, you must notify all tenants when the change applies.

Note: Although this task does not occur every day, you may have to do it during any given day.

To print a rent change notice:

- Go to the SiteLink **Operations** screen, then the **Reminders** list, then double-click **Print Tenant Rate Change Letter**.
- Click **Select All**, then click **Process**.
- Two copies of each letter will be printed. Mail one to each tenant whose rent will change and place one in each tenant's file.

- **Send credit card expiration letters or emails.**

Check for expired credit card information and notify tenants whose cards are expired.

- **Monitor the gate.**

- In general, keep an eye on the gate monitoring computer during the day to ensure that it posts updates to the gate and unit entries.
- SPS uses various systems for gate security; Falcon and Storlogix are the most common. Information about the system at your facility is explained during training.
- When an alarm goes off, verify the reason and physically check the unit. This is one of

the reasons that SPS always keeps a manager on site all the time. Clear the alarm through your gate security system.

- For more information about monitoring the gate and turning alarms on and off, refer to the documentation for the gate controller for your specific facility.

Important: Gate equipment, such as optical sensors and magnetic loops, should be checked and verified monthly.

- **Cleaning and Other Tasks**

- Always keep vacant units clean and rent-ready.
- Monitor and maintain facility grounds when you're out on the property; see your RM for assistance with cleaning schedule.
- Clean and stock bathrooms.
- Clean the office, including windows and doors. Vacuum rugs, empty trash, wipe counters and surfaces, clean coffee stations, remove clutter.
- Replace burned-out lights around the facility and in hallways. Contact maintenance if assistance is needed.
- Refer to the daily checklist to ensure that all items are completed; pay special attention to items that impact brand, safety, and our ability to rent units.

- **Close of Day**

The following tasks must be done at the end of each day:

- Verify that all employees sign the Daily Checklist, then scan and email the checklist to their RM.
- Secure all cash in your safe.
- Verify that all appropriate forms are filed in the Deviations binder.
 - Verify that all leads are entered, all calls are labeled, and all inquiry calls have leads attached.
 - Balance Sugar:
- Pull the New Rentals report from Sugar and compare it against the SiteLink Move-In and Move-Out report. These numbers should match day-to-day and month-to-date totals.
- If they do not match, you need to cross-reference the list to identify and correct the discrepancy.
- Contact your Regional Manager for assistance if you cannot find the discrepancy.
 - Verify U-Haul Preliminary closing report (if applicable).

- Verify that all mailed-in payments have been posted.
 - Pull your cash, checks, and credit card numbers to reconcile SiteLink's **Daily Close > Proof Edit**.
 - In Sugar Complete the Daily Cash record created in the morning by entering **Closing Drawer(s)** and **Misc** totals and selecting the **Submit** checkbox.
 - Make one copy of all checks and verify they were processed correctly through **Daily Close > Proof Edit**.
 - Deposit cash bills into Loomis safe and complete **End of Shift** on the machine.
 - Put all checks and coins from the deposits into their respective weekly envelopes for manual drop.
 - Go to **Daily Close**. Input your verified Cash, Checks, and Credit Card totals, then select **Close Day**. Print Daily Deposit report.

To balance your cash drawer:

- Click **Daily Close** from the main screen in SiteLink.
- This will open another window where you will ultimately enter your total counts. Before entering anything into the closing count fields, you must verify that the numbers balance. Click **Proof Edit** on the right side.
- This will pull up another screen that details all transactions in SiteLink for that day. On the right side, click **Print**.
 - Print the report that is generated.
 - This report will break down each transaction for that day and give a total at the bottom for each payment method.
- Physically pull the amount of cash it says you should have from your cash drawer and set aside to deposit in the Loomis safe later. Any coin from the deposit should be placed into an envelope for your vault drop on vault drop day. Do **NOT** deposit the money into the Loomis safe until you have finished balancing all steps.
- Go to Sugar and click **Daily Cash**.
 - Click on the blue link for the cash count created in the morning.
 - Click the **Closing Drawer(s)** tab and enter the quantities of the physical cash you have on hand.
 - Enter the **name of the employee** physically counting the cash.
 - Enter the **quantities of each bill** next to the various denominations. (*The*

system will automatically convert the number of bills to the dollar amount it equals.)

- The total listed at the bottom should balance your drawer back to the same balance it was for the morning count.

Important Note: If it does not balance back to the original amount, **STOP and call your RM for assistance before proceeding.**

- If your site has a U-Haul, enter your U-Haul cash at the bottom. Make a checkmark next to the cash on the Proof Edit report previously printed from SiteLink to indicate that you verified and balanced it.
- Before finalizing your cash count in Sugar, you must also count the petty cash and account for any additional hand receipts and deposits from the day. Click the tab at the top of the cash count labeled **Misc (Petty Cash, Hand Receipts, Held Funds)**.
 - Physically count the petty cash and enter it into the **Total Cash on Hand** box.
 - Add up the receipts that have not yet been submitted for reimbursement and put that total in the **Total in Receipts** box.
 - Enter the total of outstanding requests from your petty cash request form for any outstanding requests to the **Outstanding Requested** box.
 - This should total back to your site's starting balance of petty cash, typically \$200. If your petty cash does not balance, STOP and contact your RM for assistance.
 - Enter the number of hand receipts written that day in the **# of Hand Receipts Today** box. (This will typically only be relevant on auction days.)
 - Add up any held funds for the day and put the total amount into the **Held Funds, Total \$** box. (Again, this will typically only be relevant on auction days.)

Examples of held funds:

- Cleaning deposits from auction buyers. Each cleaning deposit should be in a separate sealed envelope with the buyer's name and the unit they purchased clearly labeled on the front of the envelope.
- Held auction payments for vehicle sales while in the 10-day waiting period. These payments should be in a sealed envelope with the buyer's name and unit/vehicle purchased clearly labeled on the front.
- Now that you have entered and accounted for all funds, click the **Submit** tab at the top of the cash count. **Check the box** next to **Submit**, then click **Save** on the top right.
- Now that you have entered your final count in Sugar, go back and finish balancing SiteLink. Refer to your printed **Proof Edit** from earlier.

To balance the checks:

- Add the physical checks, money orders, and cashier's checks you accepted for the day. This total should match the total on your Proof Edit. If it does

not balance, STOP and contact your RM for assistance.

- On your Proof Edit, make a checkmark next to the total of checks to verify that all the checks, money orders, and cashier's checks were entered correctly and are accounted for.
- Stamp the back of each check, money order, and cashier's check with an endorsement stamp.
- Set aside one copy of all the checks, money orders, and cashier's checks. (You can include multiple checks per page.)
- Put checks into your weekly vault drop envelope for deposit on your specific vault drop day.

To balance the credit cards:

Your credit card processor is now part of SiteLink, so you no longer need to go to an external website to balance.

- **Run daily Loomis process.**
- Insert money at the close of day:
 - Click **Insert Bills**.
 - Type your code and push **Enter**.
 - Insert cash into the bill reader.
 - Push **Done**.
- Print the nightly receipt at the close of day.
 - On the main screen, push **Other**.
 - Type your code and push **Enter**.
 - Select **Reports**.
 - Push **Reprint end of day**.
 - Select **This business day**.
 - Print receipt.

- **Shut things down for the night.**

- Walk the property to ensure that it's clean. Shut all exterior doors.
- Turn off the thermostat.
- Empty all trash, both inside and outside.
- Close all company spaces.

- Turn off interior office lights.
- Sign out of ADP.
- Set the alarm, make sure all window locks are closed and secure, then lock all doors.
- Secure your golf cart if applicable.

Chapter 4: Weekly Procedures

The following is a list of procedures that you must perform WEEKLY at your facility. In general, these procedures should be followed in the order presented.

- **Check the mail service to confirm delinquency letter deliveries. (CA, NV & OR sites only)**

Check the SimpleCertifiedMail.com website (www.simplecertifiedmail.com) **once or twice every week** to make sure the lien letters have been delivered. You don't want to get to auction day and find out that the tenant never received the lien letter.

To check the mail service for deliveries:

- If this is your first time checking this service, get login credentials from the Auctions and Support Services Manager.
- Go to the **Past Due Tasks** window in SiteLink, then click **Service Provider's website** to go to www.simplecertifiedmail.com. You can also go directly to the site from your browser window.
- Click **Client Login** at the top right corner of the screen.
- Enter your **Username**, **Password**, and **Client Name**, then click **Login**.

- From the **Reports** drop-down list, click **Printing Services Report**.
 - In the **Recipient Name** field, type an asterisk (*).
 - For the **Letter Type**, select **All**.
 - Enter the date range you need for the letter(s) you're reviewing.
 - Click **Search**, then print the page.
- **Submit invoices to Accounts Payable, as applicable.**
- **Process refunds to your Regional Manager within 72 hours of a tenant vacating a unit, if applicable.**
- **Make Weekly Vault Drop.**

The following steps must be completed the night before the Loomis pickup:

- Make Vault Drop:
 - On the safe, push **Enter**, type your code, and push **Enter** again. Select drop type (Cash or Check).
 - Type in the amount and push **Enter**.
 - Verify that you entered the correct amount and push **Yes**.
 - When it prompts you to make your deposit, slide the envelope into the hole.
- Prepare deposit bag (clear tamper bags) and include the following information on the bag:
 - Our company name and address
 - Bank name and account number
 - Date
 - Total value in bag
- Drop the deposit bag in the safe:
 - On the main screen, push **Other**.
 - Type code and push **Enter**.
 - Select **Doors**.
 - Push **Drop Vault**.
 - Once you hear the click, open the bottom door to grab the envelopes.
 - Put the envelopes in the prepared deposit bag, but do not seal the bag, as the Loomis guards will need to add the other cash from the safe to the bag when they pick it up.
- Prepare Customer Consignment Log (CCL):
 - Fill out the customer section in the CCL and have it ready before Loomis arrives.

Loomis Pickup:

- When the Loomis people arrive on site, they will have you physically obtain the ready-to-go deposit bag from the safe.
- The deposit bag must be 100% complete and ready when they arrive, with the coins, checks, and deposit slips inside the bag with the CCL ready for their signatures.

- **Send Weekly Deposits.**

You must send weekly deposits via email by **10 a.m., or immediately after pickup if your schedule differs, once per week, typically on Thursday. Notify your Regional Manager and the Internal Auditor if you cannot complete this as scheduled.**

Email the deposit following these instructions:

- Send to Internal Auditor at **docs@bacoproperites.com** and copy your RM.
- Use the subject line “Weekly Deposit XX/XX/XXXX” (for example, “*Deposit 10/30/2023*”).
 - ***The “deposit date” is the date of the SiteLink closing paperwork.**
- Create the attachment and name it “Weekly Deposit XX/XX/XXXX” (for example, “*Deposit 10/30/2023*”).
- You must include the following in the attachment (**in this order**):
- Copy of Loomis receipt
- Deposits Report (**all pages**)
- Copies of checks for the week preceding the Vault Drop (preferred that the Deposits Report shows all facing one direction, all legible)

*** Important:** Make sure you view your attachment before submitting.

- Any site that does not submit their deposit on time is counted as having a deposit error.

Important: Repeated deposit error offenses will result in disciplinary action.

- **Conduct weekly marketing according to the plan laid out by your Regional Manager or Local Marketing Manager**

For additional details, see Chapter 7.

- **Do Walk-Through**

- Completing a walk-through of your facility once a week is required.
- **Once a month, one of these must be an open-door walk-through.**

- You must keep a Walk-Through Reports binder for storing the physical reports. Update the binder each time a report is completed. It will be checked during site visits and audits.

To set up a Walk-Through Reports binder:

- Get a 1.5-inch 3-ring binder.
- Inside the binder, put 12 dividers with tabs. Label the tabs with the months of the year.
- Within each month, you will file that month's paperwork in chronological order, front to back.
- At the end of each year, remove the binder's contents and, store it in a labeled manila envelope. Put the envelope with the Deviations binder envelope in a file box labeled with the year and contents of the box. This information must be easily identifiable if needed for reporting.

To perform a regular walk-through:

- Verify every unit by sight.
- Ensure that each unit is properly labeled on the report (occupied or vacant).
- Ensure that all units that should be overlocked are locked securely with an SPS overlock.
- Check all areas for any rodent activity.
- Check for damaged doors, including the hasps.
- Ensure that all tenant locks are secure and haven't been tampered with.
- Look for general facility cleanliness and state of repair.

To perform an open-door walk-through (once a month):

- Open the door to each unit.
- Ensure that each unit is properly labeled on the report (occupied or vacant). Ensure that all units that should be overlocked are locked securely with an SPS overlock.
- Check all areas for any rodent activity.
- Check for damaged doors, including the hasps.
- Ensure that all tenant locks are secure and haven't been tampered with.
- Look for general facility cleanliness and state of repair.

Items to be completed after a walk-through:

- If you find a rented unit with the lock latched incorrectly, call the tenant immediately and give them 24 hours to come fix the lock. If not completed in 24 hours, call the tenant to tell them you will cut their lock, place a retail lock on the unit, put the keys inside the unit, and charge them for the lock.
- If you find a unit with no lock, place a red lock and give the tenant 24 hours to provide

their lock. If not completed in 24 hours, call the tenant and tell them you will place a retail lock on the unit, put the keys inside the unit, and charge them for the lock.

- If you find any maintenance issues, post them in MaintainX the same day so the maintenance team can schedule to repair them. Each ticket must have photos attached, so bring the site iPhone with you on the walk-through, and take photos of anything you find to be used on the ticket. Ensure that you provide enough detail on the ticket so that the maintenance team can get any needed materials before arriving to repair.
- Complete your walk-through report and file it in the Walk-Through Reports binder.
- Report the walk-through in the Sugar module **Walk Thru & Merchandise Counts**, as follows:
 - Click on **Walk Thru Merchandise Counts** at the top of the screen.
 - Click **Create** in the top right corner of the screen.
 - Select the date and enter your name.
 - Select the type of walk-through completed (**Open Door** or **Regular**).
 - Select whether any actionable items were found.
 - Select whether those items were completed or not.
 - Add notes to describe any issue(s) found and what was done to resolve them.
 - Here is an example of what is expected:

- **Maintain the postage machine.**

When the amount on the postage machine gets close to \$200, order more postage from Pitney Bowes, as follows:

- Fill out a purchase order for a postage check and send it to the corporate office (check Who to Contact on the form for your site AP contact). Postage is ordered in \$500 increments.

NOTE: The size of the postage allowance depends on the size of the facility. For example, the Riverbank facility has 417 units and orders postage in the amount of \$500; the McHenry facility has more than 1000 units and orders postage in the amount of \$1,500.

- The check will be sent directly to Pitney Bowes for processing.
- After 1-2 weeks of submitting the PO to the corporate office, check the balances on your postage machine to see if the funds have been added.

- **Replenish petty cash.**

New managers are given a petty cash fund when they are hired. The maximum for this fund is typically \$200, depending on your facility's needs.

Where you keep the petty cash is up to you, but it **must always be separate from the \$200** that is kept in the cash drawer for doing daily business. Most managers keep the petty cash fund in an envelope in the safe.

Important: Petty Cash must always be available on demand at a supervisor's request or during an audit. Never mix petty cash with your personal funds or store it in a bank account, prepaid credit card, or offsite. **Failure to comply will result in written discipline, including termination of employment.**

You or an employee can make purchases for your facility and be reimbursed from the petty cash fund. *If the purchase is for more than \$50, you must first get approval from your Regional Manager.*

It is mandatory to submit a Petty Cash Request form for reimbursement when you get down to 50% of the maximum in the fund. For example, if your maximum is \$200, you must submit a request when (or before) you get down to \$100.

To submit the Petty Cash Request form and replenish the fund:

- Gather all the receipts you've reimbursed yourself or your employees for.
- Fill out the SPS Petty Cash Request form.
- Number your receipts according to date and match the line items on the form. For example, receipt #1 dated 1/3/2023, receipt #2 dated 1/4/2023, etc.
- Total the receipts.
- This total and the remaining petty cash should equal the total petty cash that you normally keep on hand. For example, if you normally keep \$200 and your receipts total \$73, you should have \$127 in your petty cash fund.
- Make a copy of each receipt and the request form and keep them in the office for your facility records.
- Put the original receipts and the original request form in an envelope and mail them to the corporate office, attention Accounts Payable.
- You will get a check from the corporate office, which you will cash to replenish Petty Cash.

- **Do golf cart maintenance.**

- Check water levels in all batteries (fill with distilled water only).
- Clean any corrosion from cables.

- **Clear cobwebs from the facility grounds, hallways, and units.**
- **Pull and/or spray weeds around facility grounds.**
- **Check signage lights and other lights.**

Chapter 5: Semi-Monthly, Monthly, Semi-Annual, and Annual Procedures

The following is a list of procedures that you must perform SEMI-MONTHLY, MONTHLY, QUARTERLY, SEMI-ANNUALLY, and ANNUALLY at your facility.

Semi-Monthly (twice per month)

- **Run Marketing Report.**

See detailed instructions in Chapter 7.

- **Do relief manager commissions.**

When a relief manager rents a unit, they should enter the relevant information on the Commission Request form. The home site onsite manager will approve the lease commission. Before submitting the commission forms, verify the following:

- The **Store, Manager and Pay Period** are correct.
- The **Tenant Name, Store, Unit #, Date Rented, Discount % and months, and Commission \$ amount** are correct.
- A copy of the **Payment Receipt** for each rental is included.
- Both the manager and supervisor have signed the commission form.

If the conditions above are not met, there may be a delay in processing the commission.

Important: Relief Managers do not earn commission on days worked with a full-time Manager or Associate Manager. Yearly commission pay schedule is available on ADP.

- **Do merchandise counts.**

Refer to the **Taking Inventory** section in Chapter 11.

Monthly

1. Verify insurance.

Each month, you will need to verify tenant insurance. You will print a Move-In report, and for any tenant who is not paying for the SPS insurance (because they have waived it), you will check to make sure there is a copy of their personal insurance information in the Deviations binder.

To run a Move-In report:

- On the **SiteLink Operations** screen, click Reports in the list on the top left.
 - Click Move Ins & Move Outs in the Unit Reports box.
 - Select Move-Ins Only.
 - In the **Reporting Date** field, enter the date.
 - In the Selected Period box, select Monthly.
 - Click **OK** to run the report.
-
- **Send next month's auction ads to the newspaper. (CA, NV & OR Only)**

For more information see Auction Chapter 12

3. Send completed auction paperwork to Regional Manager and Senior Manager of Field Operations (within 72 hours of completion of the auction).

For more information see Auction Chapter 12

- **Do the promotional inventory count and enter in Sugar by the 10th of each month.**

- **Fill out a purchase order for your monthly gas allowance.**

- **Complete an open-door walk-through.**

For instructions, refer to Walk-Through section in Chapter 4: Weekly Procedures.

- **Complete the Market Survey and submit to Regional Manager.**

Each month, you are responsible for completing a market survey.

This means that you check your competitors' pricing, numbers of units, sizes of units, special offers, etc. You can do this by calling them, visiting their website, or visiting them in person.

Then complete the Market Survey spreadsheet and submit it to your Regional Manager via email.

Note: The first time you do this task, your Regional Manager will work with you on filling out the form.

- **Check all gate safety devices and lube the gate chains.**
- Test the safety loops by driving the golf cart over the ground loop while the gate is closing. Remember to check both the inside and outside loops.
- To check the photo beam, pass your hand through the beam while the gate is closing. Contact maintenance with any issues.
- **Install a new air conditioner filter every month during the cooling season for central and window units (or clean them if yours is washable).**
- **Confirm the time frame of camera footage history. It should be at least 30 days.**

Semi-Annually (twice per year)

- **Do Facility Status Report.**
- **Adjust all lighting timers for daylight saving time, when applicable.**
- **Change batteries in all smoke detectors (both office and apartment).**

Annually

- **Store and shred documents.**
- Bundle all of the current year's documents by month and store them in your facility's storage location.
- Get cost approval to shred documents
 - We must keep any files that have had an incident report, lien sale or insurance event (water, rodent, burglary) for seven years.
 - Any file that does not have the above may be disposed of in four years.
- **Do fire extinguisher maintenance.**

See chapter 13, Accident and Emergency Procedures for more information

Chapter 6: Call Flow Guideline

You will find a copy of our Call Flow Guidelines on the next page. You can use this as a tool when a prospective customer calls to inquire about renting space at your facility.

The guidelines provide a road map to help you take control of the call, redefine the conversation, and close the sale.

The Call Flow Guidelines are built around our **four-step sales process**:

Step 1 — Greet and Connect: Establish rapport and open a conversation with the customer.

Step 2 — Discover: Identify the customer's known and unknown storage needs.

Step 3 — Recommend: Educate the customer about what sets SPS apart.

Step 4 — Close: Ask for the sale.

The Call Flow Guidelines can help you in the following ways:

- **As a sales aid**, the guidelines provide a simple one-page summary of the above sales process to ensure that you're not forgetting anything important.
- **As a tracking tool**, the guidelines provide a call flow worksheet where you can make notes while talking with the customer. After the call, you can use that information to create a lead in Sugar.

Take a moment to review the Call Flow Guidelines now. The following pages provide additional information about the four-step sales process, resources, and training to help you use the guidelines to increase your sales effectiveness.

Step 1 — Greet and Connect: Establish rapport and open a conversation with the customer.

Why is the greeting such an important part of the four-step sales process?

Buying is an emotional decision. Recent advances in neuroscience prove what skilled salespeople have known for a long time. Customers make their buying decisions emotionally — and then use logic and information to rationalize the decisions they've already made!

Another way to think about it is that selling is a transfer of feeling. Customers will get their emotional cues from you. This means that what you say and how you say it is even more important.

The greeting is important because customers will form an emotional impression of you during the first few seconds of a call. This first impression may not be set in stone, but it does set the tone for everything that follows. If you create a positive first impression, you will go a long way toward establishing rapport and building a good relationship with

the customer. If you don't create a positive first impression, you'll have to work harder to win the customer.

Ideally, your greeting and the opening of the call will meet the "3 C Criteria": clear, caring, and confident.

During this first stage of the call, your goals are to establish rapport and open a conversation with the customer. What does it mean to establish rapport?

The dictionary defines rapport as "a relationship of mutual understanding, trust, and agreement between people." So establishing rapport means making a personal connection and building a positive relationship.

The word *conversation* means different things to different people. To understand the goal, take a moment and consider two different words: *monologue* and *interrogation*.

In a *monologue*, one person is doing all the talking.

In an *interrogation*, one person is just asking a series of questions.

A *conversation* falls in the middle of these two extremes. Ideally, you're having an open, two-way discussion. You're asking questions and providing information — and so is the customer!

On the next two pages, you will see more specific information about Step 1 — Greet and Connect. Read through the elements of this step and the examples of what you might say. Please remember that the examples are not a script that you are supposed to memorize and repeat word for word. They are only meant to give you ideas and suggest possible wording.

One of the biggest challenges when learning our sales process is to ignore the natural tendency to immediately answer when someone asks a direct question. When taking a sales call, nearly every first question asked would lead us onto a side path if we answered it — for example, "What is the price of a 10X10?" "What are your specials?" This makes it difficult to regain control of the call, and more importantly, we would likely not identify the customer's needs or educate them on the value we offer if we answered their immediate questions.

Greet the customer and create a positive first impression:

Thank you for calling Security Public Storage. My name is _____. How may I help you?

Listen closely to the customer's opening statement.

Thank and assure the customer to slow down the conversation and reintroduce yourself to gain control:

[Respond to a general request]

Thanks for calling us! My name is _____, and I'm the (onsite/live-in) manager. I'm glad you called, and I'll be happy to help you. May I get your name, please?

(Heather.)

Heather, thank you again for calling Security Public Storage. How is your day going?

[Respond to a specific pricing request]

Thanks for calling us! My name is _____, and I'm the (onsite/live-in) manager. I'm glad you called, and I'll be happy to check those prices.

Thanks for calling us! My name is _____, and I'm the (onsite/live-in) manager. I'm glad you called, and I'll be happy to check those prices. So that you don't end up paying for more space than you need, I'm going to ask a few quick questions...

Thanks for calling us! My name is _____, and I'm the (onsite/live-in) manager. We have 15 different sizes, and I'd hate for you to pay for more space than you need, so let me ask you a few quick questions...

Establish rapport with the customer and record information in the lead you create in Sugar:

What's your name?

(Use the customer's name during the conversation.)

Build rapport through small talk (e.g., ask, "How's your day going?" Talk about the weather.)

How did you hear about us?

If they found us online, ask which website and if they've read our online reviews. If not, tell them where to find them. Here are examples of what you might say:

Did you have the chance to read our online reviews?

Did you read what our customers say about Security Public Storage?

We're very proud of our online reviews, so please read what our customers say about us when you can.

We're very proud of our online reviews – they will allow you to learn about the service you can expect from SPS.

Don't believe me — read our reviews and see what our current and previous customers say about us!

Step 2 — Discover: Identify the customer's known and unknown storage needs.

This step enables you to be a true storage consultant — not just someone pushing a product. By asking good questions and listening carefully to what the customer says, you can accomplish three important goals:

- You can identify the customer's storage needs and determine the best storage solution to meet those needs. **This is a vital step.** Often, when the customer has a size in mind, it's too big or too small because they are either guesstimating (and aren't nearly as familiar with storage as you are) or a competitor told them they need a certain size and were trying to upsell them.
- You can find out what factors will be most important in helping the customer make a buying decision.
- You can sell the value we offer, including yourself, the manager, as the reason to rent from Security Public Storage.

If you establish rapport and open a two-way conversation, asking questions to identify the customer's storage needs is usually easy and comfortable. But sometimes, you may find the customer seems to get defensive. The customer may wonder, "Why are you asking all these questions?"

You may find it helpful to begin the Discover process with a transition or bridge that gains the customer's permission and paves the way for you to ask several questions. In effect, you answer the customer's "why" question before the customer even asks!

It would be best to begin your transition or bridge with a benefit. Tell them what they can gain by talking with you and answering a few questions. After all, customers are only human. Like the rest of us, they're concerned first and foremost with their own needs, not ours. Customers want to know the WIIFM: "What's in it for me?" A benefit is the answer to the WIIFM question.

Here's an example of what you might say:

Let me ask you a few questions to get you into the right space at the best price.

In this example, what benefit did the manager present?

NOTE: The answer is "to give you the right unit at our best price."

There are a variety of possible benefits you can use when you transition to the Discover step. For example:

- To find the best solution for you
- To help you as quickly as possible
- To make sure you don't pay more than you have to
- To make sure we meet all of your storage needs
- To help you get the best value

Here's an example of what you might say:

To get you the right size at the best price, I'm going to need a little information about your storage needs — so let me ask you a few quick questions.

Ask specific questions about items the person wants to store. The more you know, the better your recommendation will be:

Starting with your largest items, what will you be storing?

Use the description to estimate storage size.

Ask follow-up questions to determine the correct size:

When do you need your storage?

Use information to check the availability of units.

How long will you be storing your items with us?

Use information to inform pricing strategy.

The next question is vital because it will provide you with the information you will need to tailor the rest of the call around the customer's hot button(s):

When choosing where to store, what's most important to you?

This also allows you to discuss the amenities SPS offers once again and the manager's role in creating and maintaining a safe, secure, and clean storage experience. By doing this, you are establishing VALUE.

The question aims to take the customer's answer and tie it back to the importance of quality proactive management. Here are some examples:

If the customer says:	Then you respond:
Price	<i>Price is important, and we are competitive. You will find, though, that it truly is the quality of the onsite management team that makes the difference in whether you have a good or bad storage experience.</i>
	<i>You know, when I'm shopping, the price is important to me as well. We offer honest pricing — which means the price I'm about to quote you is all-inclusive. And the quality of the manager is the key to a great storage experience.</i>
	<i>Price is important, and we're competitive. Not only do we have THE BEST security, but our entire staff here is dedicated to providing you with a safe, clean, and secure storage experience. We definitely provide you with the most value for your money.</i>
Security	<i>Not only do we have THE BEST security, but our entire staff here is dedicated to providing you with a safe, clean, and secure storage experience. It truly is the quality of the onsite management team that makes the difference in whether you have a good or bad storage experience.</i>
	<i>We have individual alarms on every unit and state-of-the-art surveillance. You're not going to get that anywhere else.</i>

Cleanliness	<i>Our entire staff is dedicated to keeping our facility clean, safe, and secure. We are VERY proactive and take much pride in doing so.</i>
	<i>Our management team is incredibly proactive. In addition to keeping the site clean, we ensure that an outside exterminator checks our facilities once a month. That provides all of our tenants additional peace of mind.</i>

If the customer says:	Then you respond:
Accessibility	<i>We are conveniently located at (description of your location.) There are other storage facilities in the area — but what sets us apart is that our entire staff here is dedicated to providing you with a safe, clean, and secure storage experience. It truly is the quality of the onsite management team that makes the difference in whether you have a good or bad storage experience.</i>
	<i>Our access hours are 8 a.m. to 9 p.m. We want to make it easy for you to visit your belongings. In addition, the onsite management team is key to ensuring a clean, safe, secure storage experience.</i>
	<i>Accessibility means something different to everyone. What do you mean when you say “accessibility”?</i>

Check out [Words That Work](#) in the Recommend section on the SPS intranet.

List the value propositions that set SPS apart from our competitors for each factor below:

Price	Ex: No deposit
Security	Ex: HD cameras
Cleanliness	Ex: Preventative maintenance
Accessibility/Location	Ex: Long access hours
Customer Service	Ex: Onsite managers

Imagine you have asked a prospective customer, “What’s most important to you when choosing where to store?” How would you respond to the following customer answers in your own words?

You should be able to discuss and illustrate these factors with analogies or stories that make them come alive for your customers. As you paint your picture of convenience or inconvenience, always **tie your stories back to the onsite manager's role.**

Step 3 — Recommend: Educate the customer about what sets SPS apart.

As a manager at SPS, you understand that not all storage facilities are the same. You know that SPS provides the highest-quality products and unique amenities in our industry. You are aware of the factors that set SPS apart from our competition. You are probably eager and enthusiastic to share this information with every prospective customer who calls to inquire about the possibility of renting space at your facility.

That's great, except for one thing: **Telling isn't selling.** Your goal is not just to inform the customer. Rather, **your goal is to educate the customer and help them make a buying decision.** And if you're not careful, you can become a victim of TMI.

What's TMI? Too much information. And TMI is one of the greatest obstacles to making the sale. Have you ever heard the adage "the best writers use the fewest words"? Making concise yet impactful statements is the goal.

Remember that buying is an emotional decision. When customers face TMI or TMO (too many options), it becomes harder for them to decide!

Fortunately, you don't have to be a victim of TMI. Remember: As part of the Discover step, you identified which factors will be most important to the customer in making a buying decision. Now you can use that information to tailor your recommendation. You don't have to review every possible benefit in detail. Instead, focus on what's most important to this specific customer. Emphasize how you can provide a storage solution that meets the customer's particular needs. Make it easy for the customer to say "yes."

Again, the main factor that sets us apart from our competitors is not just our A+ security but that we have THE BEST managers (including reliefs) in the industry. You can talk about price, customer service, security, accessibility, or cleanliness, but make sure that you tie those features back to the **quality of the manager.**

Recommending SPS

Be selective about how you use this information with any one customer. Emphasize what's most important to that customer and mention the other points without going into much detail.

Always tie your value proposition back to what the caller said was most important to them. That's what we mean by creating VALUE.

Similarly, remember other sales tools like our website, online ratings, and Top 10

Questions. But don't feel compelled to use every tool on every call. Avoid TMI! Use your judgment and share the information that will help the customer make a buying decision.

Honest Pricing

Our pricing is different than many other quotes your callers will be getting. So it's important to explain what makes our pricing different. We have found that it's far more effective to tell the caller this information BEFORE you quote the price; once you give them the price, they are no longer listening.

Here are some things that make our pricing different from our competitors:

- Honest pricing.
- No hidden fees.
- No deposit.
- No long-term contracts; month to month.
- \$3,000 worth of insurance coverage.
- We never increase current customers' prices above what new customers are renting units for.
- You are not eligible for a rent increase for at least six months.

Explain what this means to the customer. Here's an example of what you might say:

Something else that sets us apart from other storage companies is our Honest Pricing. The price is transparent and all-inclusive with no surprise fees. There are no administrative fees, the lease is month to month, and the price includes a \$ 3,000 insurance policy. Also, unlike most other storage companies, we never increase current customers' prices above what new customers are renting units for, and you're not eligible for a rent increase for at least six months.

Quote the specific size and price with Honest Pricing: No deposit, no administrative fees, no move-in fees, and insurance included. You might say:

Here at Security Public Storage, we have Honest Pricing, with no deposit, no administrative fees, and no move-in fees. It also comes with \$3,000 of insurance, so you never have to worry about your valuables while you're storing with us.

The total cost for your 10X10 is only \$__.

OR

Here at Security Public Storage, we offer Honest Pricing, which is a month-to-month all-inclusive price. That means you only pay for the time you store your

belongings. And we have no deposit, no administrative fees, and no move-in fees. Included in this price is \$3,000 of insurance coverage. All you will need to move in is the price I quote you and a lock. We even sell locks here.

How does that sound?

After presenting the cost and benefits, it's time to determine where the caller is in the decision-making process.

How do you know when to stop recommending and ask for the sale? In other words, how do you know when the customer is ready to make a buying decision? There isn't necessarily a rule to tell you when the best moment is to ask for the sale. But here are a few guidelines that may help you.

- **Remember that buying is an emotional decision.** Keep in mind that a person's emotions can change very quickly. If you feel that the customer is ready to decide, go ahead and ask for the sale. Many inexperienced salespeople have lost sales because they shared too much information and talked past the point where they should have closed!
- **Be attentive to buying signs.** Listen for positive customer comments like "That sounds great" or "Wonderful — that's what we're looking for." These are often signs that a customer is ready to make a decision. If you think you're hearing buying signs, go ahead and ask for the sale.
- **Use a trial close.** You can test the waters with a trial close to determine whether the customer is ready. A trial close is a question that helps you assess the customer's reaction to see if they're ready to buy. Trial closing is an important step in opening negotiation and moving the call toward resolution. Here are some examples:

How does that sound?

What do you think?

Let's go ahead and get that locked in for you!

Should we go ahead?

- **Negotiate appropriately to win the business.** Encourage the customer to visit our website. Inform the customer about 10 Questions, customer reviews, half-off coupons, applicable discounts, etc.

Just because you made a trial close doesn't mean the caller is ready to buy. A few people might say, "That's great — I'll take it." But most people will come back with questions, concerns, or objections. This is a natural part of helping the caller to buy.

So making a trial close doesn't mean you're done — you're just beginning. The most successful salespeople believe the fun doesn't start until the prospect starts sharing their objections and concerns. You have everything you need to close the sale. After all, you know what's most important to the caller in making a decision (Discover), so let's start using that information.

For example, if the caller comes back with a price objection, you might say something like:

Keep in mind, not all storage is the same. We're a 5-star facility. That said, I want to earn your business, so I can offer you a move-in special, taking your first two months down to \$XX per month. How does that sound?

- **Always answer objections and concerns by reminding the caller what they told you was most important to them in choosing a storage facility.**

Reinforce the customer's concerns with the value propositions you listed while explaining what this means to you and giving a possible analogy or story.

Here are some examples:

You mentioned that security is most important when selecting a storage facility. Our state-of-the-art security systems have individually alarmed units, with onsite managers who respond immediately. Have you ever been at a Macy's when an alarm went off? What do you usually see happening? Nothing. The best alarm systems are useless if you don't have an onsite manager who is paying attention and who will respond immediately. At Security Public Storage, our managers investigate any alarm event or any other unusual activity, and this attention to detail gives our customers peace of mind.

You mentioned that a clean place with no rodents is most important to you in selecting a storage facility. Well, we live here, and we treat this facility like our home. No soda cans, food wrappers, or garbage are lying around for rodents to snack on, and our preventative pest maintenance keeps our facility rodent-free. You can feel assured that your items will be in the same condition as when you left them in your storage unit.

Remember, you can always negotiate the price.

TIP: First, use your deluxe, best value, and standard rate units to help with price.

When negotiating, go up in small increments to give yourself more wiggle room to keep negotiating. Research shows that consumers are more likely to buy a product if they feel like they personally negotiated to get a better deal.

Step 4 — Close: Ask for the sale.

In the past, we did not try to close sales over the phone. Instead, we tried to get the caller to come and see the facility. But we've found that less than 50% of callers who say they're coming in do — we found we were giving our competitors too much business!

So now we have a few more effective ways to close:

- Offer to take a credit card and rent the unit now to lock in the negotiated rate, and you can send them the lease via e-sign.
- Offer to secure the sale now with the lease starting when they need it (future-dated rental).
- Offer to rent the unit now and a full refund if it doesn't work for their needs to secure your "in demand" unit.
- Offer to hold the unit until the end of the business day.
- Ask the caller to make an appointment to meet you and see the facility.

Use whichever option seems most appropriate to win the business! But don't go directly to offer to reserve the unit.

Most importantly, remember to **ASK**:

Assume the sale.

Seek urgency.

Keep trying.

- **Assume The Sale**

If you followed the Call Flow Guidelines and you have established rapport with the caller, you've found them the best unit at the right price, and you've answered their objections and concerns, then there is no reason that you shouldn't close the sale. When you assume the sale, you set the emotional tone that your caller will follow. You communicate confidence that this is absolutely the right and best decision for the caller. The question is not IF they will buy from SPS; the question is WHEN and HOW!

So how do you assume the sale? Below are examples of words that work:

I would hate for you to lose this unit at this price, so let's get this locked in for you.

It sounds like this unit meets all your needs, and I'm offering it to you at a great price. Let's lock in this unit at this great price so you can guarantee you get it. Which credit card will you be using today?

I only have a few vacant units in that size, so why don't I rent you that space with a lease date that starts tomorrow to give you a chance to chat with your partner? If it turns out you don't need the space, it is fully refundable as long as you cancel before you move in.

- **Seek Urgency**

Create appropriate urgency and ask for the sale:

I would hate for you to lose this unit.

We only have a couple left in the size you need.

This is one of our most popular sizes. I can't guarantee that I'll have one available when you need it.

That's a great rate, and our pricing and availability change daily.

Ask for the sale in an assumptive/assertive way. Make the decision for them:

To ensure we get you this unit at that great promo, let's go ahead and lock it in now. It will only take a couple of minutes.

If the customer doesn't have a credit card, offer to hold the space for a few hours, gather their contact info, and set a specific appointment for them to come on that day.

If the caller says they will sign up online later, then you might say something like:

That's great. If you have any problems signing up independently, please call me back, and I will gladly help you. In the meantime, if you give me some information, I will gladly send you a summary of everything we discussed today.

Ensure that you get the caller's complete name, phone number, and email. Just because they said they would sign up online later, you have not yet closed the sale; all you've gotten is a verbal commitment. Also, set a specific time within 24 hours that you will follow up with them.

- **Keep Trying**

If the caller isn't ready to commit, offer to reserve the unit for NO MORE THAN 24 hours. You might say:

I certainly understand your situation. I still would hate to have you miss out on getting this unit at this price, so the only other thing I can do for you is a 24-hour reservation. That means I will hold this unit for you and lock in this price for 24 hours. After that, I can't guarantee you will get this great deal on this unit. How does that sound?

Remind the caller why they might want to agree to a 24-hour reservation. What's the WIIFM for them? Also, be sure to set a specific time you will be following up with them.

If the caller still isn't willing to commit, invite them in for a visit and make an appointment, then offer to reserve a unit.

That's great that you will come in tomorrow. What time can I schedule your visit?

That's great that you're coming in tomorrow at 3:00. To ensure that we still have that size available, let me reserve it for you. That means we can lock in the unit and the price for 24 hours. How does that sound?

OR

I only have a couple of this size left. What I can do for you is reserve it for 24 hours. I have limited vacancies, so I strongly recommend that we do that, and then you can come in to meet our staff, tour the facility, and move your belongings in. So I'll put that unit on hold. Would you like to make an appointment to come in today or tomorrow?

If the customer hesitates to make an appointment, reframe value differently and provide encouragement:

Not all storage is the same! We're a 5-star facility — more like a Hilton — while most of our competitors offer very basic service, like Motel 6. You definitely get what you pay for!

When you come in, I'll personally show you how the security works, make sure you're comfortable with our facility, and give you some additional information that compares us with our competitors.

When would you like to schedule an appointment to come by?

If the customer hesitates to make an appointment and wants to continue shopping, this is a good time to bring in what they told you was most important in selecting a storage facility:

You shared that security was most important to you in choosing a storage facility. As I mentioned, “security” is in our name. My wife and I live on site, and we care for your belongings as if they are our own. When you become part of the SPS family, you never have to worry about your belongings — we do that for you. So why would you want to go anywhere else?

You mentioned that price is important to you. This move-in special is a wonderful deal, with no administration fees, no hidden fees, and monthly insurance. In addition to a great price, you will have an onsite management team that provides you with a clean, safe, secure storage experience. So let’s lock in this price for you right now.

Closing the Sale

It is normal for customers to hesitate about making a buying decision. If a customer hesitates, it doesn’t mean you’ve done anything wrong. And it doesn’t mean the customer will decide not to buy.

In this situation, you should emphasize that you want the customer’s business. Put the ball back in their court by asking an open question to find out what they’re wondering about or where they are in the decision-making process. For example:

I’d love to be able to take care of your storage needs. What additional questions do you have for me?

We really want you to join our family. What would it take to earn your business?

- **Answer any questions or concerns.**

If...	Then...
--------------	----------------

The customer asks about payment options.	Explain the different payment options available: Auto-pay Email invoices Paying online Credit card authorization Pre-payment
If...	Then...
The customer is not ready to commit.	Encourage the customer to shop: Say that you understand that they need to continue shopping before committing. Use an analogy to reframe the value we offer (hotels, restaurants, cars, etc.). Say, "Please visit our website and download the Top 10 Questions you should be asking regardless of who you talk to." Say, "If you feel that you've found a better offer, please call me back and give me the opportunity to win your business."

- **Confirm contact information: full name, email address, phone number.**

If you've established a rapport and had a good conversation, most customers will feel comfortable providing you with their contact information. But in some cases, a customer may hesitate or seem reluctant.

You should always be ready to answer the WIIFM question and provide the customer with a benefit or reason for giving you their contact information. Here are some examples of what you might say:

Let me tell you what I can do for you right now — I will gladly send you a summary of everything we've talked about.

In case some additional units become available ...

To let you know about any special promotional pricing ...

If it looks like we're going to rent out the unit you're looking for ...

- **Confirm location and hours.**

I look forward to meeting you tomorrow at 4:00. Remember that we're located at ____, and I'll be here from 9:00 to 6:00.

- **Thank the customer.**

Please review the resources below, which can be found on the SPS intranet (wearesps.com):

[Words That Work archive](#)

[Rapid Fire Videos](#)

[Top 10 Questions](#)

Chapter 7: Marketing Your Facility

You are responsible for marketing your Security Public Storage facility and maintaining a presence in your local community. To do this, you will:

- Post ads on Craigslist,
 - Tip: ChatGPT may be helpful in writing your ad
- Monitor online information about Security Public Storage.
- Contact businesses to make them aware of the SPS services (also referred to as face-to-face contacts).
- Do business-to-business (B2B) marketing.
- Participate in Chamber of Commerce Events, mixers, and ribbon cuttings. (Always check with your Chamber's website and monitor the Members Calendar and Events page).

The primary intent of our local marketing program is to maintain a presence in the community and to nurture relationships with businesses whose customers may likely need storage, aka the "core contact group."

The core contact group includes:

- Apartments
- Real estate agents
- New home developments
- Retirement communities, assisted living, and 55+ communities
- Stagers, organizers, and movers
- Mobile home parks
- Property management companies
- Large employers
- People who attend Chamber of Commerce events

While we encourage you to think outside the box and maintain relationships with other businesses, at least 75% of your local marketing time should be devoted to face-to-face marketing, that is, visiting businesses in the core contact group.

For the remaining 25%, we encourage you to get out into the community. Look into local annual events and festivals in your area. Are there any 5k runs/walks or car shows where you can set up a booth? These are great opportunities to promote your site with games, giveaways, and promotional coupons.

Another option is to network through the Nextdoor App. You can keep feelers out for local businesses that would be good for B2B marketing and specific events that may pop up in your community. Nextdoor can be a great resource.

And don't forget about adopting a local charity! Every SPS site should choose a local charity to support through an annual event. This could include:

- Local pet adoption
- An annual drive
- 5k run/walk for breast cancer, etc.

For more face-to-face marketing tips and tricks, please visit the Marketing section on the SPS intranet.

Semi-monthly marketing reports are due every other Wednesday by the close of business. This report should include ten face-to-face visits to core contacts within a three-mile radius of your location.

Examples of core contacts are:

- The Salvation Army
- Homeless shelters
- Hometown Heroes

We offer local first responders the use of our amenities when they are in the neighborhood. Police- and firefighter-specific flyers are now available for order on the [branding website page](#).

When visiting police or fire stations, encourage them to utilize your facility for the following reasons:

- Restrooms
- Parking to complete various tasks like calls or paperwork
- Free water
- Coffee
- Special discounts for police and fire personnel
- Police training events

We also encourage participation in seasonal events such as:

- Location open house
- Customer appreciation event with hot dogs and refreshments for your clients
- Local parades

To order additional marketing flyers, head to the [branding website page](#).

- From the homepage, click on **Flyers**.
- Fill out the order form on the right side of the page and select **Submit**.
- For promotional materials like water bottles and coffee mugs, inventory is sent to you based on your monthly inventory counts, so be sure that your inventory is always updated by the 10th of each month.

Post weekly ads on Craigslist.

Use the provided templates to post ads frequently on craigslist (should be 10 active ads checked every 3 days to avoid them being marked as inactive) in the category of Parking and Storage. These approved templates list your property information, website, and basic facility amenities. Posting a picture of the facility or merchandise will drive more people to view your ad.

Note: If you need the template or have suggested enhancements, please contact your Regional Manager.

Example Craigslist Ad:

Safe, clean, and secure storage! 50% off 3 months (Bethesda)

© Craigslist - Map data © [OpenStreetMap](#)

[Google map](#)?

At Security Public Storage, we are dedicated to providing the best possible storage experience for each of our customers!

Our caring and helpful staff are committed to maintaining clean, secure, and safe storage facilities for your treasured belongings. We make renting a unit easy with honest, competitive pricing, no hidden costs, no long-term contracts, and insurance included.

Our amenities include:

- Quality onsite management
- 24-hour high-definition surveillance cameras
- Individually alarmed units
- Controlled gate access and personalized entry codes
- Honest pricing: No set-up fees, no deposits, and insurance included in the price
- Month-to-month leases
- Online access and bill pay available 24/7
- Extremely clean and well-lit facilities
- Extended gate access hours 6 a.m.-10 p.m. every day
- Climate-controlled space
- Free moving truck
- Pre-payment, police, and fireman discounts available
- Freight elevators, with carts and dollies available for easy offloading
- Drive-up units
- Preventative monthly pest control
- Affordable moving and packing supplies available on location
- Online videos to help assess the best size unit for your needs
- No call centers: every call goes directly to your local facility

We offer a variety of sizes, from 5x5 to 10x30 spaces.

PLEASE MENTION THIS CRAIGSLIST AD FOR 50% OFF OF YOUR FIRST 3 MONTHS.

Moving is not fun! We do our part to take the stress out of an already difficult situation, so you can rest assured that your items are protected. We're looking forward to earning your business!

(301) 652-6966

5223 River Road

Bethesda, MD 20816

www.securitypublicstorage.com

Make a note on your Contact Sheet for the dates to refresh your Craigslist ad. Below are the instructions for using the Contact Sheet.

Contact Sheet (Marketing Contact Schedule)

Use the Contact Sheet spreadsheet to document your weekly marketing and networking contacts. Each tab lists a different type of Security Public Storage core business types that you will contact to build and foster a long-lasting and mutually beneficial relationship. You may also use this as a marketing schedule planner to develop a biweekly rotation of visits to our core marketing partners.

This list can include any other businesses you think might become mutual marketing partners.

A best practice to use as an ice breaker includes Security Public Storage swag like mugs, pens, water bottles, calendars, and notepads for their employees to use and flyers for their own or customer use.

As you make your visits, fill in the Contact Sheet with the information from your visits, such as whom you contacted, what types of marketing materials you left, general notes about your experience, and more.

Example:

Marketing Narrative Template and Instructions

You must use the following template for your weekly Marketing Narratives. Ask the Local Marketing Manager for a copy of the latest template and complete each section. If you don't have any information for a particular section, note the reason for not having it and when you expect to complete the section.

Important: If you were unable to complete face-to-face marketing for your facility in a given week, you must substitute face-to-face marketing with phone calls to your contacts instead. You will follow the same reporting format for each interaction.

Marketing Narrative Template Example:

Marketing for the week of MM/DD/YYYY – MM/DD/YYYY

This report runs from Monday through Sunday of the following week.

- **General Summary of Contacts:**

Use this section to note calls/contacts, where you've been, who you've met, and details about your conversation during those meetings. For each stop, please number, indicate how long you spent there, and the phone number of the person you spoke with.

Summary - Calls/Contacts

- Name of business (distance from property)
- Objective going into call/business
- Nature of interaction

- Follow-up plan to continue nurturing the relationship

Example:

- **Large Employer Relationships**

Discuss your large employer relationships, those you're trying to cultivate, and any relevant details, such as co-op flyers and special discounts. Use this section to maintain a list of current relationships.

Example:

- **Marketing Flyers**

List any marketing flyers that are outstanding (types include co-op, reprints, generic, and inserts) with the date they were requested. They should be noted by type and basic details about the flyer, including quantities and business names for co-op flyers or reprints. Maintain this list until they are received.

Once received, remove them from the "Pending" section and add them to the "Completed" section, then drop them entirely the next week.

- **Online Reputation (Reviews):**

Enter the current week's totals for your online reviews. (For bad reviews, post them to the forum in a new thread.)

Example:

- **Signage & Lighting**

Use this section to verify that all your exterior signage and lighting, including all SPS branding, monument signs, and mural lights, are fully operational. Note any issues and ensure that tickets are entered into MaintainX if applicable.

Example:

- **Submit**

Use this section to submit a report. Check the box next to **Submit** and hit **Save** to complete the report.

Note: If you have not completed the report and want to return to your progress, hit **Save** without checking the **Submit** box.

Chapter 8: Unit Rentals

Rental inquiries can come via phone, email, or online. **It is mandatory for you to respond to all**

inquiries from tenants and potential tenants. You should check and respond appropriately to your email and phone messages throughout the day.

Phone Inquiries

If you're returning a phone message, refer to the Call Flow Guidelines. The guidelines will help you ask the right questions, provide the right information, and ensure that you cover all the important points.

Print several copies of the most recent guidelines for incoming calls. You can use the information to follow up with a potential tenant or for reference when they call back.

Note: During a phone inquiry, feel free to encourage the person to rent a unit online, especially if they live out of the area. Instructions for assisting a person with an online rental follows.

Email Inquiries

Email follow-up will be done automatically through Sugar, as outlined below.

Important: If a person calls back a second time, label it as "Inquiry Follow Up" and link to the original lead record created during the initial inquiry and noted under the Lead Status report in Sugar.

Walk-In Inquiries

For reference, please use the following video to review how to complete the rental process:

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=LLNmgzT1LmI>

Refer to the Walk-In Guidelines form when a walk-in inquiry enters your facility. This document will help you ask the right questions and ensure that you've done a thorough job selling to a walk-in inquiry.

Print several copies of the most recent Walk-In Guidelines and keep it handy for incoming inquiries. You can use the information to follow up with a potential tenant or for reference for follow-up contact.

Important: All walk-in inquiries should be immediately logged into Sugar as soon as they leave (even if they do not rent) or as soon as the rental is complete. Any inquiries or follow-up inquiries must be labeled appropriately. **Any deliberate mislabeling or failure to log leads may result in disciplinary action.**

Service Center Rentals

For Service Center rentals, it is best practice for the Service Center staff to gather the minimum amount of information to obtain the rental. The Service Center handles company-wide inquiries, so they must be available to answer the phones when possible.

When the Service Center rents a unit, the site **MUST** confirm all the information and adjust it before completing the rental when the customer comes in.

Online Rentals

Customers can rent units online, from a computer or a smartphone.

Note: Online rentals should only be done off site. Terminals in the office should never be used to conduct online rentals. To match an online rental discount, contact your Regional Manager for approval.

To walk a customer through an online rental:

- Explain how to find the website page for your facility.
 - Explain the options for sizes and the different choices that might work for them.
 - Ask the customer to click the **Reserve Unit** button next to the unit size needed.
-
- Ask the customer to verify the information at the top of the screen and make sure that they understand **the rent starts TODAY**.
 - Ask the customer to complete the **Contact** and **Billing** information.
 - When the customer has completed the form, ask them to click **Rent Now**.
 - Make sure the new tenant understands all of the following information:
 - They are automatically charged for the first month's rent.
 - They will receive an email confirming the rental contract.
 - **They must come into the facility to see the unit and complete any additional paperwork.**
 - Offer to help the new tenant set up an online account. For instructions, see the section **Setting Up a Tenant's Online Account** later in this chapter.

When someone rents a unit online, you will be notified by email and through a Bulletin in the Reminders list in SiteLink.

When you receive notice of an online reservation, do the following:

- Cross out the unit on your list of available spaces.
- Contact the new tenant and invite them to the facility. The new tenant **must come in to do the paperwork and sign the Rental Agreement**, at which time you also must show the unit. See details in **Showing a Unit** section below.
- **Important: documents will be completed via eSign, they may be printed out once completed for file and tenant copies**
- If, after seeing the unit, there is any issue with the unit size, show a different unit to accommodate the tenant's needs. If the tenant decides on a different unit, you must do a unit transfer in SiteLink.
- If, after seeing the unit, the tenant decides not to use your facility and nothing has been moved into the unit, contact the Regional Manager for approval to reverse the credit card charge. You don't need to do any other paperwork.
- If the tenant wants to proceed, complete the rental paperwork. **A unit is not considered to be rented until you have completed all the paperwork and received the first month's rent.**
- On the paperwork for an online rental, the rent starts **on the day the tenant makes the reservation online. The rental agreement must reflect the original, online rental date**, regardless of the date on which the tenant comes in to sign it.

Showing a Unit (required for all rentals)

Important: Never rent a unit without showing it first. **This is crucial and non-negotiable.**

When showing a unit, be sure to:

- Let the potential tenant know **you're a resident manager** and what this means for safety, security, etc. **This is what sets Security Public Storage apart from other storage businesses.**
- Show them different sizes of units, with both inside and outside entrances.
- Point out the security cameras.
- Point out door alarms and explain why a disc lock is than an ordinary padlock better (because they are harder to cut off).
- Mention pest control.
- Build a rapport with the person so they feel comfortable renting from SPS.
- Explain that the SPS Rental Agreements are on a month-to-month basis, with no deposits and no administrative or hidden fees, and that the insurance is already included.

Tenant Paperwork (required for all rentals, to be completed via eSign)

- **The new tenant must provide a government-issued ID**, such as a driver's license, passport, or state ID. Make a copy of the ID for the file. **Important Notes:**
- You cannot rent a unit to someone who does not provide the proper ID.
- You cannot rent a unit to anyone who is under 18 or who has an expired ID. No exceptions.
- **The new tenant must complete the following forms:**
- Rental Agreement
- Discount Addendum (if applicable)
- Rules and Regulations

These rules will vary by facility, so each Rules and Regulations document is facility-specific. For example, gate hours and access might be different at different facilities; some states allow firearms storage while others do not; some states have different late fees.

After the tenant reads and signs this form, make one copy for the tenant's file.

- Insurance form (or proof of their own insurance)

Insurance is required for every rental unit. The price that Security Public Storage quotes for a unit includes the cost of basic insurance (\$12 for \$3,000 of coverage). The tenant has the option to increase the amount of insurance at the time of rental or any time during the tenancy.

The tenant also has the option to decline insurance — *but only if the unit's contents are covered by their personal insurance*. For information about how to proceed if a tenant refuses the SPS coverage and for other details about insurance, see the **Insurance** section in this chapter.

If a tenant wants to use their own coverage, you might suggest that many tenants use our insurance as coverage for the deductible on their homeowner's insurance. The Xercor Insurance (the insurance provider for SPS) deductible is only \$100 and is waived if tenants have a disc lock on their unit. SPS handles any refunds for insurance premiums.

- Each tenant must fill out the Xercor Insurance sign-up form. Print the form from SiteLink at the time of the rental and make sure the tenant signs and initials it. In 8-10 business

- days, Xercor Insurance will send a copy of the insurance policy to the address provided.
- Make two copies of the insurance form: one for the tenant file and one for the tenant.
- Payment Authorization form (if applicable)
- Current vehicle registration for any vehicle that is being stored
- Fiduciary Agreement (if the unit is rented in a company's name)
- If you're renting to a business, the account requires a Fiduciary Agreement. This form is in the Forms folder on your desktop computer, and it must be filled out by a company officer with the signing power to authorize payment on the account, such as the CEO, President, or Operations Manager. This document gives the employee they assign to rent the unit the power to sign the Rental Agreement and any other rental form.
- Military Waiver of Rights (if the unit is rented by an active military service members)
- If you're renting to active military service member, they **must** complete and sign a Military Waiver of Rights form. You can find it in the Forms folder on your desktop.

The tenant must sign this waiver. If the person does not want to sign it, you must refuse to rent to them. There have been instances where units were held for years without the rent being paid, but they couldn't be auctioned off because this waiver hadn't been signed. If you have this signed waiver, you can auction off the unit's contents if the property goes into lien and you can't locate the tenant through the Military Locators process.
- After completing all the forms, you will do the following. Detailed instructions follow:
- Set up the tenant's account in SiteLink
- Help the tenant set up their online account
- File the tenant paperwork

Setting Up a New Tenant Account in SiteLink

Once the forms are completed, enter the information into SiteLink.

Note: The new tenant's account must be set up in SiteLink before the tenant can set up his or her online account.

To set up a tenant account in SiteLink:

- On the SiteLink **Operations** screen, in the **Accounts** box, click **Move In**.
- Double-click the **number for the unit** that is getting rented.
- In the **Tenant** box on the right, click **Add**.
- Enter all of the customer's information.
- If the tenant gives a middle name, include it in the **First Name** box, as shown below, with a space between the first and middle names.
- Only use the **Middle** field only when the client provides a single middle initial.

- When done, click **OK**.
- At the prompt to add the entry, click **Yes**.
- In the **Select Tenant** window, highlight the new tenant, then click **Next**.
- On the **Move-In** screen, fill in all the billing information. You will enter payment dates, amounts, promotional discounts, insurance, and more from this screen.
- **For invoicing the tenant:** In the **Billing** box, **encourage the tenant to be invoiced by email**. Tell the tenant that it's free. If the tenant chooses this option, select the **Send an Invoice** checkbox.

If the tenant wants to receive a paper copy via USPS mail, be sure to explain that there is a fee of \$1.00 per month for this. If the tenant chooses this option, select both the **Send an Invoice** and **Charge Invoice Fee** checkboxes.

If the tenant provided credit card or bank transfer authorization, click **Edit** in the **Billing** box to enter the credit card or bank account information.

- **For insurance:** In the **Charges** box, click the plus (+) sign for the **Insurance** option to show that the default insurance is included in the monthly rent. An **Insurance** screen will open. Enter the Rental Agreement number in the **Policy Number** field, then click **OK**.
- **For discounts:** In the **Charges** box, click the plus sign (+) for the **Initial Rent** option. A **Discount** screen opens. Select the appropriate discount for the % Discount option, then click **Yes**. Click **Close** to exit this screen.

Setting Up a Tenant's Online Account

Encourage your new tenants to set up an online account while they are at the facility.

Tell the tenant that it's an easy way for them to:

- Make a payment instead of phoning in every month.
- Set up automatic payments.
- See their payment history.
- Contact you, the onsite manager.

Help the tenant as much as you can without compromising our standards or endangering the security of the tenant's property.

Remember: Payments can be made by mobile devices. If they indicate they do not have a home computer, ask if they use a smartphone.

To help a tenant set up their online account:

- Explain to the tenant how to find the **Pay Online** page.
 - <https://www.securitypublicstorage.com/pay-online>
- Tell the tenant to click **Create Account**.
- Tell the tenant to enter their **Location, First Name, Last Name, Access/Gate Code**, and

Email. Important: All information **must match exactly** what you have on file in the SiteLink tenant account.

- Tell the tenant to enter their **New Password**, then **Confirm New Password**.

Important: Never offer to manually reset a tenant's online password through SiteLink. The tenant must use the "Forgot your password?" link on the website.

- Select **Complete Account Setup**.
- Explain to the tenant about the tasks they can do from this page. Specifically, walk the tenant through the process of making a payment online.
The **Pre-Payment Information** section is where additional months can be paid in advance. Explain to the tenant that they will receive a confirmation email once the payment is processed.

Filing the Tenant Paperwork

Lastly, you will create a tenant file and place the tenant's paperwork in the following order:

Insurance

Xercor Insurance Coverage and Rates

A basic \$3,000 insurance policy provided by Xercor is included in the monthly rental price. This is the minimum that is required to rent the unit. Additional insurance can be purchased at the following rates:

Amount	Additional Cost per Month
\$3,000	\$12
\$4000	\$14
\$5,000	\$16

The maximum allowable policy is \$5,000. If a tenant requests an amount more than \$5,000, contact your Regional Manager. Once the RM approves the amount, the tenant must complete a detailed inventory sheet that Xercor provides. Once the tenant has filled out the sheet, fax it to the number listed. The approval process usually takes 2-3 days. Xercor will contact you and the tenant to let you know if the amount has been approved. Once you have an approval code, you can increase the amount of insurance in SiteLink.

Note: Xercor also provides an order form for insurance supplies, such as inventory sheets, marketing posters, brochures, etc.

Insurance Deviation

When a tenant declines SPS insurance coverage and wants to use their own insurance, **they must provide proof of their insurance at the time of rental.** Only when you have this proof of insurance will you be able to cancel the standard SPS coverage.

Place a copy of the proof of insurance in the appropriate month in the Deviations binder, in chronological order with the unit number and tenant name written on the outside margin of the

copy for quick reference.

If the tenant does not have proof of this insurance at the time of rental, the rental price **must** include the basic insurance. Suppose a tenant provides proof of homeowners insurance at some time after the move-in date. In that case, you must put a copy of the homeowner's policy in both the tenant file and the Deviations binder (**for the month the insurance is changed**). You can then remove the Xercor insurance (and its cost). **We do not credit any previous months of paid insurance.**

Important: If you must issue credits to a tenant account for a fee waive, review, or referral discount, do not issue credits toward the insurance balance. Credits should only be issued for rent or fees. We must remit payment to the insurance company each month based on paid policies. You should apply any applicable credits to an account so you can properly allocate them to rent or fees and then apply the necessary payment.

If you have a situation where insurance must be credited, contact your Regional Manager or the Manager of Field Services for approval. Repeated violations can result in disciplinary action.

Insurance Exception for Vehicle Storage

Security Public Storage does not provide insurance for any vehicle, including cars, trucks, RVs, and ATVs that are stored in outside/RV parking. The vehicle must either:

- Be insured by the tenant, and a copy must be provided to you. Make a copy of the policy and place it in the Deviations binder.
- Have up to \$5,000 of insurance from Xercor. This insurance can be used if the vehicle is in an enclosed unit and is **the only item in the unit**.

Vehicle Storage Rules and Documents

Vehicles include cars, trucks, boats, RVs, motorcycles, and ATVs.

For any vehicle storage, obtain a copy of the **current** registration or non-operational whether storing the vehicle inside or outside. The person signing the rental agreement **must be the vehicle's registered owner**. Do not accept the vehicle for storage without this information.

Vehicles are not eligible for coverage by Xercor Insurance. The tenant must provide a copy of their insurance policy.

Make two copies of all forms.

For the vehicle to be stored, the following conditions must be met:

- All batteries must be disconnected.
- The gasoline level must be 1/8 tank or less.
- The vehicle must be driven onto the facility.
- No mechanical or body work can be done while the vehicle is stored.
- Photos of all vehicles to be stored must be uploaded to SiteLink.

Minimum/Maximum Rental Terms

The minimum rental term is one month, after which rent will continue to be due monthly. The

tenant can rent a unit indefinitely. They do not need to indicate a time period on the forms. When the tenant is ready to move out, the final rental period can be prorated **if the tenant gives you notice before that month's rent is paid**. Except under special circumstances, SPS does not refund rent for a partial month of occupancy.

If the tenant requests to cancel the rental agreement on the same day it started, contact your Regional Manager for assistance.

Discounts

A tenant can take advantage of several types of SPS discounts, including:

- *Promotional (or “move-in”) discounts*
- Security Public Storage offers both facility-wide and facility-specific one-time promotional discounts to potential tenants. When a tenant mentions a promotional discount or provides you with a coupon (usually printed from the SPS website), complete the Discount Addendum form.
- *Permanent (or “forever”) discounts*
 - A permanent discount (previously known as a “forever discount”) is one that the tenant receives every month. They are offered to large companies as an incentive to have our name placed on their employee benefits page.
 - Permanent discounts are approved and set up by your Regional Manager after discussion with top management personnel, including the President. Ask your Regional Manager for the latest list of all the companies that receive permanent discounts.
 - The tenant requesting the permanent discount must show the proper ID — a company ID card, a passport, a credit union check with their address on it, etc. — to prove they're associated with the company that receives the SPS permanent discount.
 - The discount is usually 10%, but firefighters and police officers receive 15%. There also may be other discount levels, and they vary widely from facility to facility. Consult with your Regional Manager about the various discounts offered at your facility.
 - You can find the permanent discount forms in SiteLink. Ensure that the form is filled out accurately and that the necessary coupons or other eligibility documents are provided.
 - Make two copies of the form. Place the original in the tenant file. Give one copy to the tenant and file the other in the Deviations binder.
 - **Important:** If a permanent discount is given and the tenant pays cash, a copy of the discount addendum must be emailed to the Internal Auditor.
- *Tenant referral discounts*

When an existing tenant refers someone to you who then becomes a new tenant, give the referring tenant a \$25 or \$50 discount. To issue this discount:

- In SiteLink, go to the referring tenant's account (the one receiving the discount).
- Go to the **Letters** menu and process the **Referral Discount** form.
- The referring tenant and their referral (the new tenant) must complete the printed form. Once signed by both parties, make two copies. Place the original in the referring tenant's folder, a copy in the new tenant's file, and a copy in the Deviations binder. Attach the receipt to the Deviations binder copy.
- Then click **Payments**.
- Select the unit, then click **Next**.
- In the **Payments** window, click **Edit Charges & Payments**.
- Under **Apply Discount Plan**, choose **\$25** or **\$50 Referral** from the drop-down list.
- It will ask, "Are you sure you want to apply this concession plan?" Click **Yes**.
- Click **OK** to exit the **Edit Charges & Payments** screen.
- Click **OK** on the main **Payment** screen to process the discount.

- *Review discounts*

- When a tenant posts an honest review of your facility on the internet, verify that the review was done **BEFORE** applying the review discount. Once verified, apply the discount and make two copies of the review. Place one in the tenant's file and one in the Deviations binder.
- For the first honest review, you can give that tenant a \$15 discount on the next month's rent.
- **Important:** A tenant can submit an honest review on YP.com and Facebook to receive the \$15 discount. They can **ONLY** do one review per site per month, with a maximum of two reviews.
- Remember not to stack discounts. If the tenant already has a promotional discount or referral discount applied to the current month, you must apply the review discount to the following month.

- *Pre-pay Discounts*

SPS offers the following discounts to tenants who pre-pay rent:

- Pay 5 ½ months, get ½ month free
- Pay 11 months, get one month free

We also allow multi-year payments, but they cannot be processed like a single-year payment. To process a multi-year payment:

- Instead of applying the "Pay 11 months, get one month free" discount, you must manually advance the pre-pay months on the SiteLink **Payment** screen.

- Then go to **Edit Charges & Payments** and manually credit the last months of the term (all free months will go to the end of the paid period, so reduce credit liability if they vacate before using all credits).
- Proceed to make payment.

Multiple Discounts

There are some discount programs in which the tenant first gets a promotional discount and then gets a permanent discount. For example, a promotional move-in discount might offer a few months at half off and then a permanent discount of 10% to 15%. The discounts are always consecutive, never two in the same month. Both forms must be completed for these combined discounts, and copies should be appropriately filed, as previously noted.

Extending Existing Discounts

As a rule, we do not extend promotional discounts beyond the term given at the time of rental. If a tenant requests this, you can offer them other ways to save, such as review and referral discounts. If they persist or you feel there is good cause for an extension, you may contact your Regional Manager for approval. They will only be authorized on an exception basis and only by the Regional Manager. *Any unauthorized extension of discounts or price manipulation to reduce the rate will violate policy, and disciplinary action will be taken.*

Authorization for Automatic Payment

Tenants can set up automatic payment for their rent using a credit or debit card or by having the payment automatically transferred from their bank account (ACH) by completing the Payment Authorization form.

- **Credit/debit card authorization**

Have the tenant complete the Payment Authorization form using the Credit/Debit Card section of the form. Accepted credit cards are VISA, MasterCard, Discover, and American Express. We also accept debit cards if they have the Visa or Mastercard logo. These debit cards are treated like credit cards; the authorization form must be filled out.

The tenant can choose to have SPS charge them automatically each month in one of the following ways:

- On the billing date (the move-in date or anniversary)
- On a specific date of their choosing, up to 10 days following that date
- By calling the SPS facility on the day they want to make the payment
- **ACH authorization (for automatic transfer from a bank account)**

If the tenant wants to automatically pay each month by electronically transferring the rent from a bank account, complete the Payment Authorization form using the Checking/Savings Account section of the form. As noted in the previous section, the tenant can optionally specify the date the money will be transferred.

Make sure you get a blank, voided check from the tenant and attach it to the form.
For more information about credit cards and other forms of payment, see Payments chapter.

Assigning a Gate Code to a Tenant

Security Public Storage recommends that you use the following 10-character formula for your tenants' gate access codes:

- The first character is **always** an asterisk (*).
- The asterisk is followed by eight numbers, starting with the unit number (four-digit format). This longer sequence of numbers provides additional security for your facility and your tenants' belongings.
 - **Note:** Not all gate pads will accept a zero as the first digit.
- Follow the unit number with four digits of the tenant's choosing.
 - **Note:** Some facilities use the last four digits of the tenant's social security number, but **this is not recommended**.
- The last character is **always** a pound sign (#), provided that the gate pad has a # sign.
- An example of a good gate code is *10234690#

Renting to Family and Friends

We welcome your family and friends to rent a unit with SPS; however, we need to verify that there is no conflict of interest during the rental process. **A Regional Manager must authorize any rental to a family member or friend before execution so they may review the discount and rate being offered.**

If a rental is executed without authorization, the contract may be voided, and disciplinary action may be taken. In the event of a separation of employment from SPS, any contracts written are subject to be voided or returned to full rate if a discount is found to have been issued improperly. The standard discounts offered to family and friends should not exceed the standard discounts being offered to the public.

Liability Release

Occasionally, a tenant will want to receive packages at your facility. If so, you must first get approval from your Regional Manager. There should be a strong reason for making this request. The tenant must complete the Liability Release form. Packages are held for 48 hours. Make one copy of this form for the tenant file.

Tenant Ledger

This is the tenant history that is kept in SiteLink. It records all the Charges & Payments for a tenant's account. You must learn to read the ledger and understand it. You will learn to do this in your training sessions. It is not otherwise documented in this guide.

Manager Units

- Each management team that lives onsite or associate manager that does not live onsite is entitled to one 10x15 unit at a rate of \$1.00 per month. We ask that the unit not be in a prime location.

- Full-time employees (not living onsite) are entitled to one unit at a 50% discount each month.
- Part-time employees are entitled to one unit at a 25% discount each month.
- An employee may occupy no more than one discounted unit at any point.
- Any units outside of the \$1.00 managers' units are subject to rate change.
- Employees should not rent the unit to themselves; a supervisor or Regional Manager should sign the contract and verify all information before the completion of the contract and custody of the unit is taken.
- **Important Note:** Employee rates are subject to review and rate increases. The unit rate will immediately return to the standard rate upon separation.

Other Rental Activities

In addition to renting new units, you may also need to handle the following types of rental activities:

- **Rent a second unit to an existing tenant.**
When renting a second unit to an existing tenant, follow the same process as renting the initial unit, BUT:
 - **DO NOT** synchronize the billing dates. The tenant will receive two separate invoices for the two dates (and will make two separate payments).
- Click **No** when asked if you want to synchronize, as shown in the following screenshot:

- **Transfer a tenant to a different unit.**
When a tenant wants to transfer their belongings to a larger or smaller unit, they must vacate the existing unit and fill out new rental information.
Add a note in SiteLink that the tenant is transferring to a different unit.
Any credit left on the existing unit is transferred to the new unit.
Important: Never transfer a unit unless the original unit has already been vacated or was never moved into. If the tenant is unsure of when they can complete the transfer, **they must rent a second unit and pay for the first month.** When the tenant is ready to vacate the original unit, transfer the credit (if any is available).

To transfer a tenant to a different unit in SiteLink:

- On the SiteLink **Operations** screen, in the **Accounts** box, click **Transfer**.
- In the **Select Tenant** list, click the **name of the tenant/unit** being moved out.
- In the **Select Unit** list, click the **unit** the tenant is moving to.
- In the **Transfer** window, you will see information about these two units in the upper right corner.
- SiteLink will make any necessary adjustments for credits or payments owed for the unit change.

- You will see several prompts about printing receipts, printing a new rental agreement, taking a payment, and more.
- Respond to each prompt as needed.

- **Change the name of a tenant on a unit.**

Complete the **Tenant Name Change** form when a tenant no longer wants to be responsible for the unit and wants to transfer it to someone else. You will file the original in the tenant file.

This transfer is arranged between the two parties. However, the second party must come in and signs a new Rental Agreement in order for the change to take effect. Once the new Rental Agreement has been completed, change the contact information in SiteLink.

For example, let's say a woman rents a unit for her brother because he is busy packing and moving. Later, she does not want to be responsible for the rental cost, so they agree to change the name on the account. The woman must complete the form, and her brother must come into the office to officially make the change and sign a new rental agreement. Until her brother comes into the office, the woman is still responsible for payment of the rent.

Important: A unit cannot be transferred if the account is currently due or past due. We cannot transfer debt from one person to another. The account must be paid ahead of the current day before transferring.

- **Process the death of a tenant.**

Upon hearing that a tenant has passed away, you must immediately overlock the unit, and it must remain so until all paperwork and releases have been finalized.

When someone advises you about the death of a tenant and asks for access to the unit, they must give you an original Death Certificate.

- **If the tenant died intestate** (no will or trust documents), the person wanting access to the unit must wait 40 days from the date of death before they can access the unit. Give the person a Certificate of Probate and tell them to get it notarized. You can find a copy of this form in the Forms folder on your desktop computer.

After 40 days, if the person presents the notarized form, they transfer the unit into their name and can either vacate the unit immediately, transfer to another size, or keep the unit and sign a new Rental Agreement. This person must pay any amounts that are owed for the unit.

- **If the tenant died with a will or trust**, be sure to notify your Regional Manager to ensure that all of the necessary legal steps are taken. Once approved, the person requesting access is named as beneficiary. That person transfers the unit into their name and can either vacate the unit immediately, transfer to another size, or keep the unit and sign a new Rental Agreement.

Oregon Death of a Tenant:

- If the tenant has provided another individual with both a copy of their key and the gate code for the facility, that is recognized as the deceased having given access to the space. In this event, no further documentation will be necessary and the person(s) that has both the key and code can have full access to the space to retrieve the tenant's belongings.

- Important note: In the state of Oregon there is no probate paperwork that we can provide to the surviving family/friends. If they do not already have the code and keys to the space, documentation from the court will be necessary to identify who has legal rights to the stored property.

- **Non-Tenant with Power of attorney**

If a person comes in with a power of attorney for an existing tenant, find out the following:

- What is the disposition of the person who has granted the power of attorney? Is it permanent? Is the tenant incarcerated, in the military, or physically or mentally incapable of conducting affairs?
- Put the person holding a power of attorney as the alternate contact. Get all contact info, including copies of ID or driver's license.
- Copy the power of attorney and verify the document's legitimacy, as it should be notarized.

- **Tenant in Jail**

If a tenant is in jail and wishes to grant a secondary person access to their unit, the preferred method is for them to grant a power of attorney to that person (**see Tenant with Power of Attorney** above). If they cannot do this, they need to provide the person with the key to the unit, the unit number, and the gate code. We will not grant access to a third party.

- **Non-Tenant Claiming Ownership of Contents**

While infrequent, we do get non-tenants asking for access to a unit because some of their contents are inside. Per our contract, we assume everything inside a unit belongs to the contract holder and offer no opinion otherwise. We cannot grant access, give information, or speculate on unit contents to anybody other than the contract holder. If they feel that some items in the unit belong to them, you can advise them to file a police report for stolen goods.

- **Process a Tenant Move-Out**

To move out of a unit, a tenant must fill out an Intent to Vacate form. Contractually, this should be done at least seven days before the move-out date. If the tenant does notify you beforehand, you can schedule the move-out in SiteLink and be reminded about it as the date approaches.

To schedule an upcoming move-out in SiteLink:

- Ensure that you have the tenant's signed Intent to Vacate form.
- On the SiteLink **Operations** screen, in the **Accounts** box, click **Payments**.
- Select the tenant.
- Click **Schedule Move-Out**.
- Select the date the tenant plans to vacate the unit, then click **OK**.

- If the tenant is set up for automatic payment, remove it from their account so that you do not accidentally bill them for the next month.

On the day of the scheduled move-out date, SiteLink will remind you to double-check the unit and that the tenant has given notice.

To enter a move-out in SiteLink (after the tenant has vacated the unit):

- Ensure that you have the tenant's signed Intent to Vacate form.
- Ensure that the tenant did not leave a lock on the unit and that it is empty and clean.
- On the SiteLink **Operations** screen, in the **Accounts** box, click **Move Out**.
- In the **Select Tenant** list, click the **name of the tenant** moving out.
- On the **Move-Out** screen, enter the **Move-Out** date.
- Complete the Credit Options, Payment Options, and Adjustments.
- Make sure that the account is paid in full.
- If the unit was prorated to a specific date, select the **Prorate Rent** checkbox so that SiteLink will allow you to vacate the unit at the amount you collected. Remember, you can't prorate a unit if the tenant already paid for the month prior to telling you that they are vacating.

We do not refund partial months' rent. For a prorated cash payment, send a copy of the signed Intent to Vacate notice to the Internal Auditor.

- Click **OK**.
- You will be prompted to make sure the address is correct. If so, click **OK**. If not, click **No** and make any necessary corrections.
- At the prompt, click **Yes** to proceed.
- Print the Move-Out Receipt, Ledger History, and Notes History.

Personal Information Security and ID Authentication

More and more, Security Public Storage is handling online transactions, and our tenants are moving toward online account management. Our tenants frequently call us with questions about how to set up the account and to get the necessary information to do so. Many tenants forget their unit numbers or gate access codes.

To help them, we are giving out information that allows them to access our grounds and disable the alarm on a unit. **The last thing we want is to give out information on a unit without some degree of authentication.** This includes resetting a user's online account password for them. They must use the "Forgot your password" link and do it themselves.

Take extreme caution in releasing personal information about a unit over the phone. Making a mistake and giving information to someone who is not a tenant could compromise a tenant's security and grant the wrong person access to a unit. Do not risk exposing the company to liability. Maintain high standards of security.

For example, while trying to locate a person for a law firm, an investigator called a facility and said the following:

Caller: I think I owe you some money.

SPS Manager: What is your unit number?

Caller: Oh, I've forgotten it. Can't you find me by my last name? (He gave the last name of another person he was trying to find.)

SPS Manager: Oh, Mr. X, your unit number is B47.

Caller: How much do I owe you? Am I paid up?

SPS Manager: Your scheduled rent is \$114.00, but you are paid up to May 2nd.

Caller: I have not received any of my invoices. What address do you have on file?

This is how the manager should have handled the call:

Caller: I think I owe you some money.

SPS Manager: What is your unit number?

Caller: Oh, I've forgotten it. Can't you find me by my last name?

SPS Manager: I'm sorry, but I can't give out that information over the phone without you giving me some proper identification. Can you give me your driver's license number or the last four digits of your Social Security number?

Important: When a tenant calls for confidential information, take a moment and go through the account to find personally identifiable information you can ask the caller for. **Get specific information from the caller.** Ask a combination of questions to identify the caller as a legitimate tenant, such as:

- What are the last four digits of your Social Security number?
- What is your driver's license number?
- What is your date of birth?

Alternatively, you can ask the caller to scan and email you a copy of their driver's license. You should ask at least two questions to verify your identity. **Do not give out any information unless you can identify the caller as your tenant.**

Chapter 9:

SugarCRM (Customer Relationship Management)

This chapter provides information for using Sugar for customer service management.

Note: These are not step-by-step instructions for training. Use this information as a reference for your Sugar tasks.

Sugar URL: <https://www.bacorealty.sugarondemand.com>

Sugar Home Page:

The basic components of Sugar are as follows:

- The Sugar cube in the top left corner is the home button. It will take you back to the home page from any menu or report in Sugar.
- The top toolbar has links to reports, calls, leads, daily cash, local marketing, inventory

counts, etc.

- The **Calls** module shows the inbound recorded calls, with the most recent at the top.
- The **Leads** module shows the most recent leads, the date they were created, and the status.
- The **Daily Cash** module shows the most recent cash logs.
- The **Reports** module shows a list of available reports. To mark a report as a favorite, click the star next to that report.
- The **Inventory Counts** module shows the most recent inventory counts (related to promotional items, not resell merchandise).
- The **Local Marketing** module shows the most recent Marketing Reports submitted.
- The **Facility Status Report** module shows the most recent Facility Status Reports completed.
- The **OSVs** module shows your most recent site visits.
- The **Walk Thru & Merchandise Counts** module shows your most recent walk-through and merchandise counts.

Your screen may differ slightly in orientation or content.

Listening to Calls and Labeling Recorded Calls

All calls must be labeled for ease of identification and reporting purposes. A best practice is to label the calls as they come in so there is never a buildup, and 100% of the recorded calls must be labeled daily.

Use Sugar regularly to listen to your phone calls. Do this to verify the accuracy of the information you gathered, to make additional notes for follow-up self-critique, and to ensure that the associate and relief managers conduct themselves properly from a sales and customer service point of view.

To label a call:

- From either the home screen's **My Calls** dashlet or the **Calls** module, click the hyperlink under the **Subject** column.

If you need to identify the call's content, click the link in the **Call Recording** box.

- From the **Call Label** drop-down, select the most appropriate label.

Refer to the **Sugar Call Label Description** form to identify the appropriate label. To get a copy of the Sugar Call Label Descriptions go to the intranet, wearesps.com and go to Resources then select Sugar Labeling Descriptions.

- Use the **Description** text field to provide additional details on calls when necessary.
 - When using the **Other (Use Description Field)** label, enter details into the **Description** field.
 - If labeled "**Inquiry – Follow Up**," link the call to the previous lead via the **Related To** field. Select **Leads** from the drop-down, type the lead name into the text field, select the appropriate name from the list displayed, and click **Save**.
- Fill in the **Employee Name** field with the name of the employee on the recorded call. When filling out the **Employee Name** field, it is important to always spell and capitalize the name in the same format every time to ensure the data accuracy of the Sugar reports. For example, if you enter "Tina" on one call (and lead) and then "TINA" on another call (and lead), Sugar will think it is two separate people, making the reports harder to decipher.

- Click **Save**.
Note: You can use the “**Recorded Calls – Breakdown by Call Description**” report to search by date and call label. You should self-audit your site daily to ensure that all calls have been labeled by filtering this report to **Call Label > is > Unlabeled**.
Important: Any follow-up inquiries must be labeled appropriately and have corresponding leads attached. Any deliberate mislabeling may result in disciplinary action.

Verify that all calls labeled **Inquiry**, **Inquiry-Current Tenant**, and **Inquiry-Follow up** have leads attached. This should be audited daily and corrected by the day's end.

To self-audit:

In Sugar, along the top row, click **Calls**.

This will bring up a list of your site's recorded calls. Filter it to show only the calls you need to see. On the left, click the blue **Create** button next to the filter.

Select the following options from the drop-down boxes that appear: **Call Label**

- **Is Any of**
- **Inquiry, Inquiry-Current Tenant, Inquiry-Follow up**

This will filter your calls to show only the inquiry-related calls. This list shows that all the calls should have a corresponding lead attached. You can tell whether a lead is attached by looking at the **Related** column.

If there is a name in that column, a lead is attached. If empty, a lead still needs to be linked to the call.

To link a lead to a recorded call when the lead was not created from within the call itself:

All calls labeled as **Inquiry**, **Inquiry-Follow Up**, or **Inquiry-Current Tenant** must have the corresponding lead attached. To link a lead to the call, follow these steps:

- Open the call recording as you do when labeling your calls.
- Next to the field that says **Related to**, select **Lead** from the drop-down menu.
- This will generate another box to the right. Type the lead's name in this box and **select the appropriate lead**.
- Click **Save**.

To create a lead from an email, walk-in, or phone inquiry that did NOT call on a recorded line:

All leads must be entered into Sugar. This includes potential tenants who come into your office, call on the phone, or email you as well as those who have been developed as leads through your marketing efforts. Follow these steps to enter a lead:

- If you create the lead from a phone call, always verify in the **Calls** module that the call was not recorded. You can do this by looking at the time stamp on the call. To verify all

- content, see the section titled **Listening to Calls and Labeling Recorded Calls**.
- Click the drop-down arrow to the right of **Leads** on the Sugar toolbar.
- Click **Create Lead**.
- When creating a lead, there are four separate tabs you will need to fill in when you initially enter the lead. You will start on the tab labeled **Greet and Connect**. Fill out the form completely, making sure to complete the information for all required fields (marked with *).
- Click on the **Discover** tab and fill out that section completely. Repeat this step for the **Recommend** tab and the **Close** tab.
- In the final tab labeled **Close**, click **Call Score**, then select the choice that matches the interaction from the visit, call, or email, as shown below:
 - A score of 1 indicates a rental opportunity we can't accommodate, such as needing RV parking or climate control when your facility does not have that type of storage. This should only be used if the required amenity is unavailable on your property, regardless of occupancy.
 - A score of 2 indicates that we have the potential to rent, but it is very unlikely. We compete to secure the rental, but we are not the front-runner for the competition. This can be due to pricing, not having the ideal size, or general availability.
 - A score of 3 indicates that you don't have a strong feeling about the likelihood of renting one way or another. It's a good inquiry contact but has no strong indication of rental.
 - A score of 4 indicates a strong inquiry, such as a person who has made a soft commitment to tour the facility or rent online.
 - A score of 5 indicates that the person rented upon first contact. If you are labeling a call with a score of 5, you must also complete the **Conversion** tab.
- Click **Save**.

To create a lead in Sugar for an inquiry call:

If a lead is from one of the recorded lines, you will need to create the lead from the call to link it with the call recording.

The only variation in lead creation between recorded and non-recorded calls is where you initially click **Create Lead**. Creating the lead from the recorded call in the **Calls** module will connect the recorded call with the new inquiry for your records.

Converting a lead

When a potential tenant returns (or comes in following a phone conversation or marketing visit) and decides to rent a unit, convert the previously entered lead into a rental (or a future-dated rental if applicable).

To convert a lead into a rental:

- Find your inquiry using the search box on the top right side of the main toolbar.
- Once you have located the appropriate lead, select **Edit**.
- If applicable, correct the first and last name of the lead to ensure that it matches the rental in SiteLink.
- In the **Greet and Connect** tab, change the status of the lead to **Converted** (or **Future-Dated Rental** if applicable)

If marking a lead as a future-dated rental, you must also edit the **Date Needed** section under the **Discover** tab to match the lease date in SiteLink.

- In the **Close** tab, enter the unit number exactly as it appears in SiteLink. (**Do not** adjust the original call score on the lead.)
- In the **Conversion** tab, you must enter a reason for the storage discount given and answer the appropriate eSign questions.
- **Important:** DO NOT change the employee name on the lead. Whoever made the initial contact gets the credit regardless of who is on staff when the person comes in to rent.

Lead follow-up

We must follow up on leads 24 and 48 hours after the person initially inquired.

To follow up on a lead:

- Go to the **Reports** module.
- Select the **Lead Status** report.
- By default, under **Run-Time Filters**, the **Status** is set to **Be One Of**, and the following items are selected from the second list: **Attempting Contact, Future Dated Rental, In Process, New, Reserved, and Wait Listed**.

If settings differ, select **Reset**, then **Apply** to reset the form.

- Click on the name of the person you will follow up with to open the lead. Use phone numbers and email addresses to attempt follow-up contact.
For best practices and ways to make your follow-up calls count, watch our Advanced Training video on the forum: [insert hyperlink for resource](#).
- Click on the **Follow-up Notes** tab and click **Edit**.
 - Click on the appropriate follow-up attempt (**Follow-up #1, Follow-up #2, Additional Follow-ups**).
 - For **Follow-up #1 and Follow-up #2**, add the date, your name, and notes from the follow-up attempt into the proper fields.
 - For **Additional Follow-ups**, click in the **Add'l Notes** field, enter a date, enter notes about the follow-up attempt, then put either your first name or your initials after the note.
 - Click **Save** each time you make changes.
- Once you have updated the notes, click on the **Greet and Connect** tab and modify the Status field as appropriate:
 - **Attempting Contact** – If you've tried calling or email without response. Try via phone and/or email at least three times.
 - **Converted** – If the lead completed a same-day rental with you.
 - **Dead** – If you have a solid reason to think they will not rent with SPS (either because you were directly told *no* or you made multiple unsuccessful attempts at contact).

If labeling a call as **Dead**, select a reason from the drop-down menu.

- **Duplicate** – If a lead had already been created but you created a new one in error. If a lead is marked as Duplicate, you must link the original lead to it and send a link to the lead to Adam Castro for deletion.
To link the original lead, click in the **Original Lead** box, type the lead's name, select the appropriate lead from the list, and click **Save**. Be sure to verify the dates that each lead was created and mark the second lead as a duplicate.
- **Future-Dated Rental** – If payment was taken for a rental with a start date in the future.

If a lead is marked Future-Dated Rental, you must also enter the date needed in the **Discover** tab and answer the questions in the **Conversion** tab.

- **In Process** – If the potential customer made a soft commitment to come in and tour the facility or rent a unit.
 - **New** – All leads should begin in the **New** status and remain in that status until the initial follow-up call is completed. Once you have made your first attempt to follow up with the lead, whether successful or not, the status should be adjusted to the next applicable status.
 - **Reserved** – If the customer has not yet paid for the space but intends to rent the space that day.
Important: Never reserve units in SiteLink for more than 24 hours without RM approval.
 - **Wait Listed** – If we cannot accommodate the rental and the person is willing to wait until we have a unit available.
- Click **Save**.

Automatically generated emails

The Sugar system is set to automatically generate certain emails if you put an email address in the initial lead script. When initially entering the lead, be sure to enter the customer's email address before clicking **Save**. Sugar will NOT send the Inquiry Response emails to customers if their email address is not added to the initial lead.

Types of emails:

Inquiry Response – No Discount

If you do not enter a discount in the **Recommend** tab on the lead, the system will send a Thank You for Inquiring template that does not mention discounts.

- Inquiry Response – Discount

Same as above, but the email will include discount verbiage and information if you enter a discount in the **Recommend** tab.

- Welcome

After you mark the lead as converted, the system will send the new customer a Welcome email with helpful links for forms and online payments.

Self-auditing - SiteLink vs. Sugar Balancing

We use the Sugar system to house the bulk of the data for various reports, site visits, year-over-year statistics, digital marketing, pricing, etc. If your site does not balance 100% between SiteLink and Sugar, it disrupts the processes for numerous aspects of the business.

Every team member is responsible for ensuring that SiteLink and Sugar balance every night before leaving.

To self-audit on a nightly basis:

- Pull the **Move-In** report in SiteLink:
 - On the main screen, click **Reports** on the left side.
 - In the second column, select the report labeled **Move-Ins & Move-Outs** and double-click.

- Adjust filters:
 - Reporting period - **Whatever month you are auditing**
 - Select Period - **Monthly**
 - Sort By - **Unit**
 - Filter - Show **Move-Ins Only**
- Click **OK**. This will organize the report by unit number to make it easier to reference against Sugar.
- Select **Print Report**.
- Pull the **New Rentals** report in Sugar:
- On the top toolbar, click **Reports**.
- This will take you to a list of various reports; click the report titled **New Rentals**.
- Adjust filters:
 - User name - **Your site**
 - Start date - **This month** (Or switch to last month if auditing previous month)
 - Method of Contact - **Is Not Empty**
 - eSign Adherence - **Greater Than Equal To – 0**
- Click **Apply to** re-run the report with your set filters. (This will only need to be selected if the filters were adjusted; once adjusted, they will remain on said filters until you change again.)
- To make it easier to compare reports, filter this report by unit as well. To do so, click **Unit #** along the top column of the report below.
- Now use the printed report from SiteLink and cross off each of the rentals on the paper report one by one as you verify it is in Sugar and accurate.

You should verify that the overall number of rentals matches on both reports and that the names, unit numbers, and discounts are correct. In addition, you should verify that all eSign documents are collected and that Sugar is up to date with the most accurate eSign information.

How to make a correction in Sugar when an error is identified:

- Click on the **blue underlined name** in the **Name** column.
- This will open the original lead so you can make the necessary changes.

Types of errors:

- If the error is regarding the *discount*, click the **Conversion** tab (NOT the quote

tab, as the original quoted discount should never be changed).

Edit discount offered at time of rental.

- If the error is regarding the *unit number*, click the **Close** tab and edit unit number.
- If the error is a *duplicate* rental:
 - Right-click on the **blue underlined name** for both leads and click **Open in New Tab**.
 - Compare the time created on both leads to identify which was created first. This is located on the **Greet and Connect** tab.
 - Change the status of the second one created to **Duplicate** in the **Greet and Connect** tab by clicking the drop-down menu next to the status.
 - Link the original lead to the duplicate.
 - Click the box next to the original lead.
 - Type the original lead's name and select from the list of names that appear.
 - Click **Save**.
 - Once you have linked the original lead to the duplicate, email your RM for assistance with removing the duplicate.
- If the error is related to an Future Dated Rental that was accidentally marked as converted too soon:
 - Click the **Greet and Connect** tab.
 - Change status from **Converted** to **Future Dated Rental**.
 - Click the **Discover** tab and note the date the lead should be converted in the inquiry follow-up notes section.
 - Email your RM to remove the lead from the **New Rentals** list and then convert again once it is the appropriate date.
 - Once all necessary changes have been made, click **Save**.

Useful Reports in Sugar

- **Conversion %:** Displays information on conversions, detailed by specific criteria
- **Lead Status:** Details the status of recent inquiries within a date range
- **New Rentals:** Lists all rental activity within date range; typically used month-to-date
- **Recorded Calls: Breakdown by Call Label:** Displays call information, detailed by specific criteria

Chapter 10:

Payments

Payment Rules

- Payment can be made by cash, check, credit card, or debit card (only if it has a Visa or Mastercard logo).
- Accepted credit cards are Visa, Mastercard, Discover, and American Express.
- DO NOT accept partial payments. Please note:
- When a tenant moves in, they must pay the entire move-in amount, including any insurance.
- Subsequent payments must also be for the entire monthly rent.
- The only exception is when a tenant gives you an Intent to Vacate form before the final month's payment. You can then prorate that last month for the exact amount.
- DO NOT accept credit card payments or checks on move-outs or lien-status accounts without the approval of your Regional Manager/Supervisor.
- DO NOT accept any other form of payment on move-out or delinquent accounts without first getting approval from upper management. Please note:
- For accounts that are in lien or auction status, get authorization from your Regional Manager/Supervisor.
- Final payment must be in cash, money order, or cashier's check.
- For payments remitted in large amounts—for example, paying for more than a year or more than \$1,500—get approval from your Regional Manager.
- A tenant's family member can authorize payment over the phone **only** if they have been pre-approved by the tenant to use the authorized credit card on file. If that family member wanted to pay with a card not on file, they would need to provide a signed authorization to charge (which must be completed before the payment is made).
- Anytime you post a credit card payment, you must input the CVV2 (3 digits on the back

of the card) into the appropriate box on the payment screen for in-person and phone authorization. This info cannot be stored for autopay.

- If a payment does not match the amount due on the unit number listed on the check, make a quick verification with a name search. Often, people write the wrong unit number on the checks when mailing them in.

Making ACH Payments on “Will Call” Accounts

A tenant can put a bank account number on file to be processed only when the tenant calls in by phone. You can store the bank information on the same screen as a credit card. For “Will Call” accounts, leave Monthly Automatic Billing set to **None**. To post a payment:

Go to the payment screen.

Hit the key combination CTRL+SHIFT+H.

A new box will appear on the payment method for ACH Bank Debit.

Finalize as you would any other standard payment.

NOTE: You can find ACH demo videos from SiteLink at <https://storable.teachable.com/p/sitelink>

Payment Methods

The following table details the ways a tenant can pay their rent.

Payment Method	How it works
Automatic payments	Tenants can make automatic payments via credit card—Visa, Mastercard, Discover, or American Express—or debit card that has the Visa or Mastercard logo. The tenant must complete the Payment Authorization form. When the tenant’s rent is due, it is automatically charged to the card. Tenants can also do automatic transfers from a bank account. The tenant must complete the Payment Authorization form. When the tenant’s rent is due, it is automatically transferred from their bank account.
Online payments	All Security Public Storage sites offer online payment. The tenant sets up an online account and makes the payments through it (via credit card) at their convenience.

Cash/Checks/Money Orders	Accepted via walk-in, drop box, or mail. Write the unit number in the memo field of the check if not already there. Important: Cash is the only payment method accepted for an auctioned unit. Lien payments must be made by cash, money order, or cashier's check.
--	--

Updating Expired Credit Card Information

When you see a notice for Expired Credit Card in the SiteLink Reminders list, double-click it to see the tenant information. Give the tenant a courtesy call.

Let the tenant know you will mail or email a new form. Ask them to complete it and get it back to you ASAP before the next payment due date.

Note: You can also email a form to the tenant, but they must then fill it out, sign it, scan the signed form, and then email the scanned form back to you. You must have a signature on the form.

If you cannot reach the tenant by phone, you can use the letters in SiteLink to notify a tenant if the card has expired or has been declined.

If the cardholder is not the tenant, request a copy of their driver's license so you can match the signature and name of the cardholder. Be sure to put a copy of it in the tenant's file.

Handling Address Verification (AVS) Mismatches

When SiteLink finds a tenant who is set up for automatic credit card payment but for whom the address cannot be verified, it posts an AVS Mismatch in the Reminders on the Operations screen.

To resolve an AVS mismatch:

- On the SiteLink **Operations** screen, in the **Reminders** list, click **AVS Mismatch**. You will see a report listing the tenants with the address mismatch issue.
- Print the report for reference.
- Click **Operations** in the list on the left.
- In the **Customers** box, click **Tenants**.
- Highlight the account you want to look at by typing in the unit number.
- Click the **Credit Card** checkbox. You will see the credit card information, including the last four digits of the card number and the billing address. If there is a question about whether the credit card number is correct, you can reenter the number based on the credit card information in the tenant's file.
- Make any changes you need, then click **OK**.

Handling Checks Returned for Non-Sufficient Funds (NSF)

When a rent check is returned because of non-sufficient funds (NSF) in the tenant's bank account, the corporate office will notify you. It is your responsibility as the facility manager to address the NSF problem with the tenant **on the same day that you receive the notice** (or the first day back from a day off). Failure to do so may result in a written warning.

To handle an NSF check, you must reverse the payment and add a late fee in SiteLink.

To reverse an NSF check:

- On the SiteLink **Operations** screen, click **Adjustments** in the list on the top left.
- In the **Adjustments** box, click **NSF Payment Reversal**.
- Click **Show Only Current Tenants**.
- Highlight the tenant's name.
- Click **Select Transaction**.
- Ensure that both the **Reverse Payment** and the **Add NSF Fee** are checked. The NSF Fee is \$35 in Maryland and \$50 in all other states.
- Click **Process**.
- When prompted to print the letter, click **Yes** and print two copies (one to send to the tenant and one for the tenant file).
- Mail the letter to the tenant.
- Call the tenant to tell them the check was returned, that the balance now needs to be paid by money order, cash, or cashier's check, and that there is an additional fee for the returned check. Be sure to make notes about the conversation in Sitelink.
- On the SiteLink **Operations** screen, click **Reports** in the list on the upper left.
- In the **Financial Reports** box, click **NSF Checks**.
- Select **Daily** in the **Select Period** box, then click **OK**.
- Click the envelope icon in the toolbar at the top of the report window and save the report to your desktop.
- Email the report to Justine Ganibi and your Regional Manager.
- Put an overlock on the unit.

For information about overlocking a unit, see Chapter 3: Daily Procedures.

Handling Refund Requests (Not Related to Auctions)

Note: For information about refunds related to an auction, see Auctions, Chapter 12

Security Public Storage does not refund partial months of insurance because our insurance provider, Xercor, will not do so.

We generally do not refund a partial month's rent without a pre-notice of Intent to Vacate. We refund whole, unused months, for example, if a tenant pays a year ahead and then moves out earlier than expected.

That said, there are always exceptions to the rule, which SPS handles on a case-by-case basis. Here are a few examples of when SPS has made an exception in the past. **Always get approval from your Regional Manager** for these situations:

- A tenant comes in the day after renting and tells you they no longer need it.
- A tenant paid far in advance but then needs to vacate. In this case, SPS would refund the extra paid months.
- A good, long-term tenant who has never been late paid for a full month a day or two before vacating.

To make a refund to a tenant:

- If the situation requires it, as noted above, get approval for the refund from your Regional Manager.

- Confirm the tenant's address. If you need to update the tenant's address, have the tenant complete an **Account Changes** form.
- Enter the **Scheduled Vacate Date** in the tenant's account.
- Process a **Request for Refund** form in SiteLink. Fill out the form as completely as possible.
- Email the request to your Regional Manager within 72 hours of the tenant vacating:
 - Title of the email: *Refund Request – Facility – 9xx Unit XX first name, last name*
Example: *Refund Request – Ceres – 937 Unit 061D John Smith*
 - Attach in this order:
 - **Request for Refund** form
 - **Tenant Ledger** (after move-out)
 - **Account Changes** form with new addresses (if applicable)
- Your Regional Manager will review and approve the request, then send it to Steven Ford within two business days of receiving the request.
- Steven Ford will review the request.
If approved, he will send it to Crystle Fry within two business days of receiving the request.
If the request is rejected, he will send it back to the Regional Manager to request an update on information or state that the refund was rejected, with reason for rejection.
- Crystle Fry will bundle all requests for refunds every Friday by EOB and forward them to Shan Liu for processing.
- A tracker will be maintained for all active refunds and will be updated periodically.

Important Note: Never refund a customer in SiteLink. If you see any prompt that asks you to refund a customer, DO NOT continue until you discuss with your Regional Manager.

Reversing a Credit Card Payment

You might occasionally need to reverse a credit card charge due to an error in the amount charged or because of a chargeback.

- **For same-day reversals:** Get approval from your Regional Manager, who can authorize you to void a same-day transaction and verify the proper steps to balance your system.

To reverse a credit card payment on the same day:

On occasion, we will need to cancel a credit card transaction. **All credit card voids must have approval by the RM before processing.**

- **To void/refund a credit card payment:**
- Void receipt in SiteLink.
 - On the left side of the **Operations** page in SiteLink, click **Adjustments**.
 - Click **Ledger Adjustments**.
- Select the tenant and click **Next**. Highlight the appropriate receipt, then click **Refund/Void** on the right side.

- You will be asked if you want to delete one entry. Click **Yes**.
- You will be prompted to enter a reason for deleting a payment. Type the reason for your void (example: **Cancelled Rental**) and Click **OK**.
- You will be asked if you are sure. Click **Yes**.
- You will see a little box as if you will take a payment. Click **OK**.
- You will get a message saying the payment was approved. Click **OK**.
- You will get another message saying **Payment Successfully Deleted**. Click **OK**.

Handling Chargebacks

You will need to reverse a credit card charge if you receive notice from the corporate office of a **chargeback**. A chargeback is when a tenant disputes a credit card charge and can be due to various reasons, such as the cardholder disputes the charge, the card is over its limit, the card has been lost or stolen, and more.

As the facility manager, you are responsible for addressing the chargeback issue with the tenant **on the same day that you receive the notice** (or your first day back from a day off). Failure to do so may result in a written warning.

SPS has a limited amount of time to appeal the chargeback. If you delay or send incomplete information to merchant services, the SPS bank account will be debited, and SPS may lose the appeal.

Important Note: This is one reason that we cannot take credit card payments by phone without an authorization on file. Without the authorization documents, SPS would lose the appeal every time.

To resolve a chargeback:

- Use the following instructions to identify the transaction and tenant in question.
- Contact the tenant to inquire why they initiated a chargeback.
- Complete all requested tasks by the given date on the chargeback notice from the corporate office.
- Submit the following to merchantsupport@sitelink.com
 - Signed contract
 - Signed receipts
 - Legitimate payment history from the same card
 - A written letter of the situation which led to the dispute of the original transaction
- **Do not refund the transaction being disputed**
- If you find that the tenant used a fraudulent credit card for an online payment, you must block online payment privileges.
- Make notes in tenant's account in SiteLink to document the steps you took to resolve the issue.
- Overlock the tenant's unit and suspend access to the facility until the payment is resolved.
- Continue reaching out to the tenant for payment. Attach disputed charges to the account (see Steven Ford or Regional Manager for instructions).

- Only accept payment for the chargeback in cash or money order.

Note: If you need assistance in resolving a chargeback, contact your Regional Manager or Steven Ford for assistance in resolving.

Do not arbitrarily waive a late fee!

Your goal as a facility manager is to minimize waived late fees. The ideal for each month is \$0.00.

There are many reasons for waiving a monthly late fee, including:

- Posting payments to the wrong unit
- Not processing payments for “will call” or mail promptly
- Failing to check **Disable Past Due Events** when prorating tenants to vacate
- Misapplying payment to the wrong account or not distributing over multiple units
- Not processing letters correctly, resulting in duplicate fees
- Not doing the walk-through each week
- Not vacating tenants on the same day the unit is verified as empty
- Failing to update credit card numbers or set up a tenant for automatic payment
- Making errors in the tenant information or auction procedure, which requires SPS to restart a delinquency or auction process
- Not properly understanding how to read ledgers or receipts
- Telling tenants incorrect information regarding balance, paid-through date, or when the fee will be charged to the tenant’s account

All of the above are due to personnel errors and are easily avoidable with careful attention or additional training. **You should make every effort to have no waived fees that are due to any of the above reasons.** Repeated errors such as the above, or similar errors resulting in waived fees, will lead to written documentation for procedural mistakes.

Important Notes:

- In the case of mailed payments, we do not waive fees based on the postmark.
- We do not waive fees if a payment is received by mail for less than the total amount owed.

Here are some guidelines to follow:

The **only** time to waive a fee is in the case of an exceptional, long-term tenant with no history of delinquency who has demonstrated cause for the fee to be waived. Use this waiver sparingly, as it is a one-time-only waiver and does not reset after any period. Use this as a gesture of good service where needed, not every time a customer is upset that they have a late fee.

If the tenant has a history of delinquency or has had a fee waived in the past, do not waive any

additional fees. Pay careful attention to the tenant ledger to ensure that no prior fees have been waived.

When a fee is waived, enter information about the waiver in the **Reason** box. Make notes about who you spoke with to get approval.

Always contact a supervisor for approval if you have a compelling reason for any additional waivers.

Posting Checks

It is important to avoid errors when posting a check payment. Before posting, you must review the check and verify the following:

- The check is filled out completely.
- The date is equal to or before the date being posted. Do not post a future-dated check.
- The check is made out to Security Public Storage.
- The numeric amount matches the amount written on the line below.
- The check is signed.

Posting checks that are filled out incorrectly or post-dated interferes with the daily deposit and causes an inconvenience for all staff and the customer. **Make sure the check is valid before posting.** Repeated violations can result in disciplinary action.

Chapter 11:

Merchandise

The onsite managers are responsible for ordering and maintaining inventory and for stocking the merchandise in the office. We have standardized the names and prices of all merchandise items to maintain consistency throughout the company, making it easier for site staff, customers, and field support staff to easily identify items as they travel from site to site.

Under no circumstance can site staff edit the names, prices, or taxes on merchandise items in SiteLink. The only items that can be ordered and included in your site inventory are those listed on the **SPS Approved Merchandise Order Form (Chateau)**. You can find the order form with approved listed items on the SPS intranet under **Forms**.

Merchandise Count Reports Binder

You will keep a Merchandise Count Reports binder to store your monthly inventory reports.

Update this binder as changes or reports are completed. This binder should **always be available on demand** and might be needed in conjunction with future facility audits.

At the end of each year, remove the binder's contents, store it in a labeled manila envelope, and then store the envelope with the Deviation binder envelope in a file box labeled with the year and content. You must be able to easily access the information if the corporate office needs to review anything for audit purposes.

To set up the Merchandise Count Reports binder:

- Get a 1-inch to 1½-inch binder.

- Make a label for the binder titled **Merchandise Count Reports**.

As you finish the merchandise counts, store a copy of the reports in this binder. If you found any problems while taking inventory that required adjusting the system count, attach a Merchandise Activity report to verify that the corrections were made.

Taking inventory

The onsite managers are responsible for ensuring that the inventory counts are completed semi-monthly (twice per month). The first count must be completed by the 15th of each month, and the second count no later than the last day of the month. To complete the merchandise counts, follow these steps:

- On the home page in SiteLink, click **Reports** from the left column.
- Double-click on the **Merchandise Summary** report.
- A small box will appear. Click **OK**, then print the report once it finishes loading.
- In the left column, you will see a list of all the merchandise items carried at your site. The far right column will have an end count, which is the quantity of each item you should have on site. Physically count your merchandise in the office and any additional merchandise stored in your merchandise room. Put the total on the blank line next to the end count column.
- Once you have finished your count, verify that your physical count matches the end count listed on the report. If they do not match, re-count that item to verify that you counted it correctly. If it still does not match, make the necessary adjustments in SiteLink. (See **Merchandise Adjustments** section that follows).
- On the first page of the count, put the name of the site employee who completed the count.
- Put the finished merchandise count in your merchandise binder. This should remain in the binder for a minimum of three months and be easily accessible for any auditor that comes to your site.

Merchandise Adjustments

The most common reason to make a merchandise adjustment is when receiving an order of new inventory. On rare occasions, you may also need to adjust for store-use items and when you identify discrepancies during your semi-monthly merchandise counts. Whatever the reason for the adjustment, follow the steps below.

- On the main page in SiteLink, click **Adjustments** in the left column.
- Click **Returns and Inventory Adjustments**.
- This will open another box with a list of all merchandise items in SiteLink. Highlight the name of the item you need to adjust.
- On the top of the right side, select the type of adjustment you need to make. Choices are:
 - **Return:** SPS does not accept returns. **All merchandise sales are final.**
 - **Scrap:** If, when doing inventory, you found an item that was damaged, you would no longer sell it.
 - **Display:** If you removed an item from inventory to use in a display.
 - **Promotion:** If you removed an item from inventory to give it away as part of a promotion.

- **Received Shipment:** If you enter the inventory you ordered and received.
Note: All new merchandise should be entered on the day you receive it. Be sure to verify the quantities delivered against the packing slip given to you by the driver before you enter the quantities into SiteLink.
- **Other Adjustment:** If there are more or fewer of an item, and there is no valid reason for the discrepancy, use this option.
For example, you might have sold a medium box but accidentally rang it up as a small box. Your inventory count would show an extra small box (because you rang it up as a sale) and one less medium box (the one you sold) than the report.
- On the bottom of the right side, next to where it says **Change**, enter the quantity you will add or remove from the system.
- Verify that the change quantity and new quantities are listed correctly. In the example pictured between steps 4 and 5, we received five boxes that needed to be added to the inventory. We have selected **Received shipment (+)** as the adjustment type and have entered the number **5** next to the change amount. Above the change amount, it displays the current quantity of that item, and below the change number, it displays what the new quantity will be.
- Click **OK**.
- If the adjustment was made because you received a shipment, print the merchandise activity report for that day and set it aside. When submitting the PO to the corporate office to pay the invoice, you must include this report. (The corporate office will not process invoices for merchandise without the Merchandise Activity report.)
 - On the left side of the main screen in SiteLink, click **Reports**.
 - Double-click **Merchandise Activity**.
 - A box will appear for filtering options. Select **Daily** and sort by **Reason**.
 - Click **OK**.

Enter Merchandise Count in Sugar

After completing your semi-monthly merchandise count, enter it into the Sugar database the same day, following these steps:

- Click the drop-down arrow next to **Walk Thru & Merchandise Counts** in Sugar.
- Click **Walk Thrus / Merch. Count**.
- Enter the date, employee who completed the count, and type of count.
- Enter the results of the merchandise count. If there were actionable items, such as those that are over or under what they should be, detail the situation in the notes field.

Ordering Boxes

Your Regional Manager must approve all box orders **before you place the order**. Your Regional Manager can determine whether you'd be ordering more merchandise than can be sold in a reasonable amount of time.

In California and Nevada, boxes are ordered from CDS. You can only place an order when buying enough to qualify for free shipping, which requires a minimum order of \$250.

An SPS-specific order form can be found online at branding.securitypublicstorage.com/branding_resource/merchandise. Fill it out, then get it approved by your Regional Manager. After getting approval, email the completed order form to pgeisler@cds-usa.com.

On the East Coast, boxes are ordered from Willard Packaging. You can only place an order when buying enough to qualify for free shipping, which requires a minimum order of \$250.

An SPS-specific order form can be found online at branding.securitypublicstorage.com/branding_resource/merchandise. Fill it out and get it approved by your Regional Manager. After getting approval, call Willard Packaging at 301-948-7700 or fax the completed form to 301-963-2375.

In Oregon, boxes are ordered from Pioneer Packaging. You can only place an order when buying enough to qualify for free shipping, which requires a minimum order of \$500.

An SPS-specific order form can be found online at branding.securitypublicstorage.com/branding_resource/merchandise. Fill it out and get it approved by your Regional Manager. After getting approval, email the completed form to sales@pioneerw.com.

Ordering Other Merchandise

For all other resale items, all facilities will order through Chateau. As with boxes, get your Regional Manager to approve any order.

Fill out the SPS-specific Chateau order form, which can be found at branding.securitypublicstorage.com/branding_resource/merchandise, and email the completed form to sales@chateauproducts.com.

Receiving Your Merchandise

When your order is delivered, count it and ensure that you received the number of each item that you ordered. Report any discrepancies immediately to the vendor.

To add the items to your inventory, follow the instructions for merchandise adjustments at the beginning of this chapter. When you are finished, print the Merchandise Summary report for your records.

Statements are often included with an order. This is not a bill, so never issue a purchase order for a statement. **Wait until you receive an invoice.**

When the invoice arrives, fill out a purchase order for it. Then email the purchase order, the Merchandise Activity report, and the invoice as attachments to accounting@bacoproperties.com and sliu@bacoproperties.com

Chapter 12:

Auctions

When a unit goes to auction, the entire contents of the unit are auctioned as a single transaction.

The only exception is when a unit contains a vehicle. For specific information about auctioning vehicles, see **Vehicle Auction Rules and Procedures** at the end of this chapter.

Avoiding Common Mistakes

When setting up an auction, be sure to avoid these common mistakes:

- Tenant's name doesn't match communications and publications, such as the Client Information Sheet (CIS), Rental Agreement, all

letters, and auction publication, because of one of the following:

- Misspelled name
- Missing middle initial
- Middle name not fully spelled out (if it is on the CIS/Rental Agreement)
- Alternate did not receive Pre-Lien or Lien Letter.
- Address was updated without signed Account Changes (AC) form, Change of Address (COA) form, or notes in SiteLink referencing online updates.
- COA or AC form is on file, but the account was not updated to match.
- Unit number was wrong in auction publication.
- Incorrect auction date/time on Lien Letter.
- Incorrect auction date/time in auction publication.
- Address missing apartment number on letters.
- Not properly reversing letters when they need to be reprocessed due to error or partial payment. Using the letters function in Sitelink does not update properly; you must reverse and reprocess. For instructions on reversing a pre-lien letter, see Chapter 3.

Auction Calendar

Auctions are held once a month. Each facility has a specific day on which its auctions are held; for example, your facility might always hold auctions on the second Tuesday of each month at noon. The Security Public Storage Senior Manager of Field Operations sets up the schedule for the following year and informs the sites no later than November 1st. You can also find these high-level auction schedules on the Security Public Storage website at <http://www.securitypublicstorage.com/auctions>.

However, the detailed auction calendars that include the cut-off dates, ad placement dates (the date you send it to the newspaper), and the ad run dates are compiled by the facility managers based on the auction dates on the yearly schedule. For more information about setting these dates, see the sections titled **Place the Auction Ad** later in this chapter. If you have any questions about the schedule or specific calendar dates, contact the Senior Manager of Field Operations.

The Delinquency Process

Before you can auction the contents of a unit (because the tenant is delinquent in the payment of the rent), it is a legal requirement to follow a specific procedure called the **delinquency process**. The delinquency process is a series of letters sent out at specific points in time, followed by the placement and running of the auction ad.

The following delinquency letters and collection calls must be completed and appropriately documented in both SiteLink and the tenant file before proceeding with the next steps in the process. See **Chapter 3: Daily Procedures** for details about each task.

- Past Due Notice sent to the tenant.
- Pre-Lien Letter sent to the tenant (and to the alternate contact on the Rental Agreement, if any).
- Lien Letter with the auction date sent to the tenant (and to the alternate contact on the Rental Agreement, if any).

- Final Notice of Sale sent to the tenant.
- Collection calls.
- Documentation of any calls that the tenant made to you regarding the overdue payments.

Note: There are additional steps in the delinquency process for vehicles. See **Vehicle Auction Rules and Procedures** at the end of this chapter.

The following tables give you a quick look at the “days late” schedule for sending out the letters and making the calls.

Days Late Schedule for California, Nevada, and Virginia

Days Late	Action
9	Call to tell the tenant that the account payment is late, that a late fee will be added in two days, and that their unit will be overlocked until full payment is made.
11	Send the Past Due Notice with notification of the late fee and overlock the unit.
24	Call to notify the tenant that the account is delinquent and will go into Pre-Lien status in two days.
26	Send the Pre-Lien Letter.
39	Call to notify the tenant that the account is delinquent, will go into Lien status in two days, and will be scheduled for auction.
41	Set the date for the auction and send the Lien Letter.
54	Call to notify the tenant that the account is delinquent and that they will receive the Final Notice of Sale in two days.
56	Mail the Final Notice of Sale.

Days Late Schedule for Maryland

Days Late	Action
4	Call to tell the tenant that the account payment is late, that a late fee will be added in two days, and that their unit will be overlocked until full payment is made.
5	Send the Past Due Notice with notification of the late fee and overlock the unit.
14	Call to notify the tenant that the account is delinquent and will go into Pre-Lien status in two days.
15	Send the Pre-Lien Letter.

44	Call to notify the tenant that the account is delinquent, will go into Lien status in two days, and will be scheduled for auction.
45	Set the date for the auction and send the Lien Letter.
59	Call to notify the tenant that the account is delinquent and that they will receive the Final Notice of Sale in two days.
60	Mail the Final Notice of Sale.

When a Tenant Opposes a Lien

If a tenant opposes a lien, they must follow Step 1 below; then the onsite manager must follow Steps 2 and 3, with the assistance of the Senior Manager of Field Operations.

Important: This process applies only to **California and Nevada** facilities. When a tenant opposes a lien in Virginia or Maryland, contact your Regional Manager.

Step 1: Declaration in Opposition to Lien Sale Notice

The Declaration in Opposition to Lien Sale notice is automatically generated and sent with any Lien Letter that is processed and mailed by SimpleCertifiedMail.com. For more information about Lien Letters, see Chapter 3.

A tenant in lien status has the legal right to fill out this form and return it to the SPS facility where the lien is held. The tenant can mail it or drop it off during business hours. **The form must be filled out completely and signed to be accepted by SPS. This is the only form that SPS legally accepts.** For example, a tenant cannot simply send you a letter opposing the lien. 99% of tenants in lien will not return the form.

If the tenant loses the form or requests a new one, you can reprint a blank form from the SimpleCertifiedMail.com website. The tenant can come into the office to pick it up, or you can mail or email it to the tenant.

If you receive this form completed and signed by the tenant, the tenant is notifying you that they are opposing the sale. Contact the Senior Manager of Field Operations for assistance with Step 2.

Note: Even if you receive the completed form from the tenant, you will still advertise the unit with the tenant information as you would normally for the auction ad.

Step 2: Notice of Withdrawal of Declaration in Opposition to Lien Sale

The Notice of Withdrawal of Declaration in Opposition to Lien Sale (in the Auctions folder on your desktop computer) is three pages. The first two pages are a letter explaining the process that will follow if the tenant does not return the Withdrawal of Declaration in Opposition to Lien form (the third page).

Fill in the blank areas on the letter with the date, facility, and tenant information.

Mail all three pages (the letter and the form) in one envelope to the tenant's address listed on the Declaration in Opposition to Lien Sale form they sent you. Send it via regular USPS mail no later than 24 hours after receiving the signed Declaration in Opposition to Lien Sale form.

If you receive the completed Notice of Withdrawal of Declaration in Opposition to Lien Sale back from the tenant, contact the Auctions and Support Services Manager for instructions.

If you do not receive the completed Notice of Withdrawal of Declaration in Opposition to Lien Sale back from the tenant after 14 days from the date it was mailed, on the 15th day, call the Auctions and Support Services Manager for assistance with Step 3 in this process.

Step 3: Small Claims Court Filing Form SC100

The state of California requires the Small Claims Court Filing Form SC100 to be filled out completely to begin legal action in a Small Claims Court. The Auctions and Support Services Manager will send this form to you and give you specific instructions for filling it out.

Note: The Auctions and Support Services Manager will instruct you regarding this next step for the Nevada facility.

Once the form is filled out, fax or email it to the Auctions and Support Services Manager for review, and he will then walk you through the rest of the process.

Military Locators

Use Military Locators to track down military personnel who are delinquent on an account. You would use this process when all the following are true:

- The tenant is on active duty in military service.
- The tenant did not sign a Military Waiver of Rights form.
- The tenant is now delinquent.
- You do not have a current address for the tenant.

To use Military Locators:

- Complete a locator letter to the appropriate service. Sample letters can be found in the Forms folder on your desktop computer. In the letter, include the last known information about the tenant, including SSN, driver's license number, address, the date that the account became delinquent, and how much is owed. **Always add two to three months' rent to the balance** to cover the time it takes to return the answer.
- Get a money order for \$3.50, payable to the U.S. Treasurer. Make sure you get reimbursed from petty cash for the money order cost.
- Make a copy of the letter and the money order for the tenant file.
- Mail the letter, the money order, and a pre-addressed stamped envelope to the appropriate service.
The services listed in the next section are Military Locator addresses and phone numbers.
- In one to eight weeks, you will receive a form letter from the military service indicating the last known status of the service member.

If the service member is:

- **No longer active duty:** You can sell the unit's contents at auction.
- **Still on active duty:** Follow the instructions on the returned letter to forward the billing and the letter to the service member. If you do not hear from the tenant within six weeks, contact the Auctions and Support Services Manager for additional instructions.

Military Locator Addresses and Phone Numbers

Branch	Address and Phone	Phone
--------	-------------------	-------

Marine Corp	Headquarters U.S. Marine Corps Personnel Management Support Branch (MMSB-17) 2008 Elliot Road Quantico, VA 22134-5030	703-784-3941
Army	Commander Soldier's Records Data Center (SRDC) 8899 East 56 th Street Indianapolis, IN 46249-5301	866-771-6357
Air Force	HQ AFPC/DPDXIDL 550 C Street, West, Suite 50 Randolph AFB, TX 78150-4752	210-565-2660
Navy	Worldwide locator Bureau of Naval Personnel PERS 312F 5720 Integrity Dr, Millington, TN 38055-3120	901-874-5111
Coast Guard	Commander Coast Guard Personnel Command (CGPC-adm-3) 4200 Wilson Blvd, Suite 1100 Arlington, VA 20598-7200	202-493-1713 866-634-0574

Final Notice of Sale

SiteLink will prompt you to send the Final Notice of Sale at 56 days late (60 days late for Maryland). You must put in the proper auction date when prompted. Failure to put the proper auction date will nullify the current lien and cause a restart for that unit.

Placing the Auction Ad (Legal Notice) – CA and NV

Once the delinquency process letters have been sent, you can place the auction ad in your local paper. This is a legal notice stating that payment for the property is delinquent and that the contents will be auctioned off.

The following figure shows a schedule for ad placement for an auction.

Each month, all units scheduled for auction are announced in a single ad. Every account for which a Lien Letter was sent before the auction cutoff date is included in the ad. An easy way to find these accounts is to run a Past Due Balances report in SiteLink.

To place an auction ad: (CA, NV & OR only)

- On the SiteLink **Operations** screen, click **Reports** in the list on the left.
- In the Tenant Reports box, click **Past Due Balances**.
- Filter the report by **41 or more days late (or 45 or more days late for Maryland)** to ensure that you pull all eligible tenants for the auction. This means the rent will be at

least 71 days late when the unit is auctioned off.

- Print the report.
- Check each tenant file to verify the Lien Letter and auction date. As you verify each tenant, list their names and unit numbers for the ad.

Important: As the onsite manager, you are responsible for the accuracy of the ad. If necessary, double- and triple-check the names and unit numbers as well as the date and time of the auction. The tenant's full name should match exactly on the Client Information Sheet (or Rental Agreement), in the SiteLink file, on all Pre-Lien and Lien Letters, and on the ad itself. If a unit is advertised for auction and the tenant's name differs on documents, the unit will be pulled from the auction and disciplinary action will be taken.

- If you place the ad online through the local newspaper's website, follow the instructions on the site. Otherwise, fill out the appropriate legal notices that can be found in the Auctions folder on your desktop computer and email the ad request to your local newspaper representative.
- Schedule the ad to be published in the paper no fewer than 14 days before the auction date and again seven days before the auction date. Most papers need a week's notice before publishing an ad, so plan accordingly based on your cutoff and auction dates. Some managers have the ad published 15 and 8 days before the auction as a buffer against any delay in the paper.
In Virginia and Maryland, the ad runs only once, when the account is 60 days late.
- Make sure that you get a proof copy of the ad from the newspaper before the ad runs. If you submit the ad online, the proof copy will be emailed. **If you do not receive a proof copy within a reasonable timeframe, follow up with them as soon as possible.**
- When you receive the proof copy of the ad, double-check it to ensure that the newspaper entered all of the names and unit numbers correctly and that the date and time are correct. Again, as the facility manager, you're responsible for the accuracy of the ad.
- Make a copy of the ad and place it in the tenant's file. Wait for the proof to make a copy, including a signature from the legal ad department, verifying that the ad is running.

Auction Checklist

Once you have scheduled the auction ad, you can complete the **Auction Checklist** form.

Note: It is best practice to start filling out this form as soon as the Lien Letter was sent. It should be kept in the tenant file so that you can update it with the remaining information as the delinquency process proceeds.

This document is your roadmap for auctioning off the contents of a unit. It lists the specific actions taken in the delinquency process to ensure that legal requirements were followed. For every tenant contact or checkpoint in the delinquency process, two onsite managers and a supervisor (Regional Manager or Senior Manager of Field Operations) **must initial the form** to ensure that the process is followed accurately. Completing this form ensures that the unit is ready to be sold.

To fill out the Auction Checklist:

- Make sure you have the tenant file and that it includes all the necessary paperwork from the time of rental through the Lien Letter.
- Enter the cutoff date, Lien Letter date, and auction date at the top of the form.

- Fill out the tenant name and rental unit information using the Rental Agreement and the tenant's records in SiteLink.
Important Reminder: The full name of the tenant should match exactly on the Client Information Sheet (or Rental Agreement), in the SiteLink file, on all Pre-Lien and Lien Letters, and on the ad itself. If a unit is advertised for auction and the tenant's name differs on documents, the unit will be pulled from the auction and disciplinary action will be taken.
- For items 1-13 on the form, check **Yes** or **No** and enter any required dates.
- Sign the checklist.
- Ask another onsite manager to follow this process, and on the day of the auction prep, have the supervisor or Senior Manager of Field Operations complete #3. Both managers should sign the checklist.
- When completed, put the checklist in the tenant file.

Updating Tenant Information

Important: When a tenant pays off their balance before the auction, it's a great opportunity to verify the following information on file:

- Correct phone number for primary and alternate contacts (if no alternate contact, get one and stress the importance of an emergency contact)
- Correct address for primary and alternate contacts
- Valid email address (if we do not already have one, get one)

Note: For habitually late tenants, this is our best opportunity to get updated information. Not taking this opportunity may result in being unable to contact the tenant in the future and could result in a unit being sold at auction that we could otherwise get payment on.

Auction Prep Day

Important: Have everything ready and completed for the supervisor or Senior Manager of Field Operations. Trying to finish your paperwork on the day of the auction prep is unacceptable.

Organizing the tenant files

Pull the tenant files for all the auction units. Ensure that everything on the **Auction Checklist** is filled out and that all other paperwork is ready so that you're not scrambling during the auction. All tenant files should be complete and contain the auction papers in the following order, top to bottom:

- **Auction Checklist** (filled out completely and initialed at the bottom of the columns)
- **Declaration in Opposition to Lien Sale** (if any)
- **Tenant Ledger** (showing the last payment taken through until the current date), printed day of auction prep
- **Tenant Notes** (showing the last nine-day call through the current date), printed day of auction prep

You should organize the Auction Sales form that you need to use in the office. Have the following documents ready on your desk for the auction day:

- **Certification of Public Sale** form (in the Auctions folder on your desktop computer). You can fill in the date, unit number, and tenant's name beforehand.
- **Lien Sale Final Accounting** form (spreadsheet in the Auctions folder on your desktop)

computer), filled out as completely as possible.

- **Auction Sales Form** (in the Auctions folder on your desktop computer), with the correct date and time of auction at the top, unit numbers (in the order you are selling them), tenants' names, and amounts owed. Double-check that all the formulas are working correctly and that the sales tax rate is correct.

When completed, place these documents near **your manual receipt book** so that everything is ready when the buyers come into the office to pay.

Recording the Sales

When a unit sells on Storage Treasures, an email will be sent to the site. This email includes a Storage Treasures invoice (if the unit is sold). Print all Storage Treasures invoices as they come in; they will arrive in separate emails per unit sold.

When you receive the Storage Treasures invoices, contact the buyers to find out when they will be arriving to begin removing the items. Buyers have 48 hours from the time of sale to remove all unit contents. If not done, they will forfeit their cleaning deposit, and they can no longer purchase a unit from Security Public Storage (at any location).

To record a sale:

- When a buyer arrives, complete the Storage Treasures invoice by having the buyer sign the bottom. An SPS employee must also sign the bottom.
- Make a copy of the buyer's ID or driver's license and return it afterward.
- Fill out one manual receipt for the auction payment.
- Fill out one manual receipt for the auction cleaning deposit.
- Calculate the auction sales tax (if needed) and collect the Due to Facility Amount (from the Storage Treasures invoice) + sales tax from the buyer.
- Collect the auction cleaning deposit (\$100) from the buyer.
- Give the buyer the pink copies of the manual receipts (auction payment receipt and cleaning deposit receipt).

Important: Inform the buyer that the **pink receipt for the cleaning deposit must be signed & returned to get the cleaning deposit back**. If not done, the buyer will forfeit the deposit. No exceptions will be made.

The following step-by-step instructions will help you understand how to fill out the individual auction forms, how to collect the auction payment, how to post the auction payment correctly, how to move out the unit properly, how to complete the collections step, and how to compile the after-auction paperwork.

Step 1: Fill out the Certificate of Public Sale.

- Open and print the emails that come from storagetreasures.com once the auction ends.
- Click on the orange button that says "VIEW INVOICE" and print.
- Enter the bidder information into the Certification of Public Sale form for each unit.
Best Practice: Fill this in for all units once the auction ends instead of waiting for the buyer to arrive. This will make it easier over the following two days as the buyers come in to pay.
- Enter the "Winning Bid" from the Storage Treasures email into the box next to "I hereby certify that I bid and offered \$" on the Certificate of Public Sale.
- Print a copy of the Certificate of Public Sale, sign, date, and put it back into the file for later.

Step 2: Fill out the Auction Sales form.

- Open the blank Auction Sales form.
- Fill out the store, date of sale, and time of sale categories.
- Enter your local tax rate in the fillable box under **Sales Tax**.
- Enter each of the units along with the corresponding info regarding the tenant names and amount due.
- Using the receipts from Storage Treasures, enter the buyer's name, winning bid, and total due at the facility.

Step 3: Fill out the Lien Sale Final Accounting form.

- Open a blank Lien Sale Final Accounting form.
- Bring up the unit in SiteLink and enter all the information.
- Fill in the boxes on the bottom of the form for the following categories: **Rent, Fees and Merchandise, Insurance, and Other Fees**.
- The total charges on the lien sale final accounting should match the total charges on SiteLink once entered.
Note: If these numbers do not match, open the **Edit Charges & Payments** screen to see the itemized total. On this screen, you will need to deduct any charges listed after the date of the sale.
- When the bidder comes in to pay for the unit, ask them if they have a resale license.
If YES, do not charge the auction tax. However, we will need their resale license number, so you need to make a copy of their resale license for our records. Zero out the tax rate on the auction tax line of the form.
If NO, charge the percent of sales tax for your area. The sales tax should be based on the winning bid amount. Enter the local sales tax rate into the **Auction Tax** line.
- Enter the winning bid amount and the total due at facility on the invoice from Storage Treasures as shown below.

Step 4: Collect payment from the buyer.

The Total payment you need to collect from the buyer is the total due at the facility, the auction tax, and the cleaning deposit (all found on your Lien Sale Final Accounting form).

- Fill out a receipt from your manual receipt book. You will need two receipts per buyer, one for the auction proceeds and one for the cleaning deposit.
Auction Proceeds Receipt:
 - *Date*: the date you are receiving the payment
 - *Received from*: the buyer's full name
 - *Blank line below that*: write out the amount of the payment in words, not numbers
 - *For*: write "Auction proceeds unit # ____"
 - *Amount of account*: on the line before the \$ sign, write Bid: amount of the bid
 - *Amount paid*: write tax on the line before the \$ sign and write the dollar tax amount
 - *Balance due*: \$ ____ (total paid in full)
 - SPS employee signs next to *By* (under *Thank you*)
- Leave the original (white) in the book. Attach the yellow to the auction paperwork. Give the pink copy to the buyer.

Deposit Receipt: (One deposit to be taken for each unit purchased)

- *Date*: the date you are receiving the payment

- *Received from:* the buyer's full name
- *Blank line below that:* write out the amount of the payment in words, not numbers
- *For:* write "Auction unit # ____ deposit"
- *Amount of account:* before the "\$" sign, write Deposit and then enter the deposit amount
- *Amount paid:* write the amount of the deposit
- *Balance due:* write "zero"
- SPS employee signs next to *By* (under *Thank you*)
- Leave the white and blue copies in the book. Attach the yellow copy to the auction paperwork. Give the pink copy to the buyer.
- Once the buyer has moved out of the unit and collected the deposit, they must sign the pink receipt. The SPS employee then staples the pink receipt to the white and blue receipt in the book. It is important to explain to the buyer that they are expected to return the pink receipt after cleaning the space to get their deposit back.
- Email the Regional Manager and Senior Manager of Field Operations, advising them that the buyer has paid.

Step 5: Post the payment to the tenant's account.

Before posting the payment to a customer, you must add the sales tax charges to the account. We must legally charge and pay sales tax on any units sold at auction to a buyer without a resale license.

- From the payment screen in SiteLink, click **Edit Charges & Payments**.
- Under **Add New Charge**, click **Auction Sales Tax**.
- On the right side, it will show two blank boxes. Enter the amount of the auction tax (found on your Lien Sale Final Accounting form), then click **Add New Charge**.
- A small box will pop up asking if you want to add one entry; click **Yes**.
- Click **OK** to return to the payment screen.
- Click **OK** on the main screen to save your changes.
- You will be asked if you would like to complete this transaction; click **Yes**.
- Another box will ask if you want to make another payment; click **Yes** and return to the same unit.
- Enter the payment amount (total collected from the buyer, excluding the cleaning deposit) and select **Cash** as the method.
- If the auction payment is large enough, the tax will be paid automatically; however, if the auction payment is not large enough, SiteLink will allocate the payment to the wrong charges. The most important part of the auction is paying the auction tax first. To do so, click **Edit Charges & Payments** and verify that the payment posts toward the auction sales tax before anything else. The remainder of the payment can go toward any other charges after that.

To reallocate the payment if necessary:

- Go to **Edit Charges & Payments**.
- Delete the payments in the **Payment** column.
- Enter manually where you want the payments to go.

Here is a list of charges that need to be accounted for, in order:

- Auction Sales Tax (if applicable)

- Auction Processing Fee
- Lien Fee
- Pre-Lien Fee
- Late Fee
- Furthest past due remaining charges

Tip: Make sure to check for duplicate charges prior to finalizing

- Once you have verified that the payment is being applied toward the auction sales tax, click **OK**.
- Print a receipt for our records and physically highlight on the receipt showing that the sales tax portion of the payment was allocated correctly.
- The balance owed on the account at this point should match the balance owed on the lien sale final accounting.

Step 6: Move out the tenant account in SiteLink.

The remaining balance on the account needs to be sent to collections, so it is important not to waive the amount owed on the account until after sending it to collections.

- From the main screen in SiteLink, click **Move Out**.
- Select the tenant and click **Next**.
- Click **OK**.
- You will be asked if you would like to take a payment for the remaining charges; click **No**.
- You will be asked if you would like to waive a bad debt; click **No**.
- **Place request on Monday.Com for your regional manager to take the unit offline until the buyer removes all contents and it is verified clean and rent ready.**

Step 7: Send the tenant to collections.

If a unit does not sell for enough at auction to cover the tenant's balance, they will go to collections to help recoup the remaining charges.

You will need to complete a Collections Report spreadsheet. If you cannot find a previous one, contact your RM. Enter all the information you have regarding each unit. The collections agency is AWA Collections.

To submit your list of units going to collections, do the following:

- Send an email to clientservices@awacoll.com.
- Include your site-specific client code, which will be the Subject Line of your email.

Example: "Security Public Storage – Client Code SEPS48-N."

If you cannot find your client code, contact your RM.

- Scan the following documents, one for each tenant going to collections, in this order:
- Completed Collections Report
- Lease (signed by the tenant and SPS employee)
- Copy of tenant's ID
- Tenant ledger (after move-out but before you write off the bad debt)

Once the email is sent, save the Collections Report spreadsheet and scan all the above documents to your Auction folder for that month on your desktop computer.

After sending the collections report, you must return to the moved-out accounts and write off the bad debt. To do so:

- From the main screen in SiteLink, on the left side, click **Adjustments**.
- Click **Moved Out Accounts**.
- Find the unit and click **OK**.
- Check the box that says **Write Off Bad Debt**(near the bottom left of the screen).

Step 8: Send paperwork to the corporate office.

The corporate office requires the following documents to be emailed to your RM and mcoronado@bacoproperties.com within 72 hours after the auction closes.

In this order (top to bottom), scan and email the following:

- Completed Auction Sales Form
- Financial Summary Report (highlight both the auction sales tax charges payments to verify that they match)
To pull this report in SiteLink, go to **Reports – Financial Summary Report** and filter to monthly.
- For each unit in your auction, assemble lien sale packets that include:
 - Invoice from storagetreasures.com, signed by SPS employee and auction buyer
 - Copy of buyer's ID (or person who is authorized to pick up)
 - Resale license from buyer (if applicable)
 - Completed Auction Checklist
 - Completed Lien Sale Final Accounting
 - Completed Certification of Public Sale
 - Tenant Ledger (after move-out, after you write off the bad debt)
 - Payment receipt (from auction buyer payment, highlighting the tax portion of the payment)

Important: If your site had no auction for the month, Send an Auction Sales Form to your RM and mconorado@bacoproperties.com indicating that there was no sale.

Step 9: File paperwork.

After emailing the documents, staple them to your pre-auction paperwork, which includes:

- Past Due Balances Report
- Auction Ad
- Yellow copies of the receipts for all units from the receipt book

Staple the corporate documents together and place them in the post-auction area in your office.

For the move-out file(s), take everything out of the file, place it in one pile, and flip the pile upside down. Take the following documents and place them on top of this pile (face up) in this order:

- Move-Out Receipt
- Payment Receipt (from SiteLink)
- SiteLink printed notes
- Completed Auction Sales Form
- Completed Lien Sale Final Accounting
- Completed Certification of Public Sale
- Tenant Ledger (after move-out)

- Invoice from storagetreasures.com
Staple the move-out file(s) together and place them in the post-auction area in your office.

Post-Auction Paperwork for No Sales

For a no-sale unit (a unit that has no bidders) or a unit that sells at auction but the buyer does not come in to claim the contents, contact Manuel Coronado to confirm the next steps.

- If a second buyer is needed:

Contact Storage Treasures and request a second bidder. Storage Treasures will contact the second bidder to see if they would like to claim the unit. If so, follow the steps indicated previously to complete the auction process.
- If the unit is to be advertised again with next month's auction:

Place the file in next month's group of units and advertise the next month.

- If a unit is deemed a dump unit:

Write "No Sale" on the top of the Lien Sale Final Accounting form and Certification of Public Sale form. Enter "No Sale" for the buyer's name on the Auction Sales form. Complete the forms with the rest of the necessary information and complete the processes as indicated previously.

Processing Refunds from an Auction

When there are excess proceeds from an auction—that is, the amount you received for the auction of the unit is more than what was owed for the unit, including any late fees—gather the following documents:

- Original and a copy of the Refund Request form you completed and signed
- Copy of the Lien Sale Final Accounting form
- Tenant Ledger

Place these documents in the white **Refunds** envelope and send them to the corporate office with your next Monday mailing.

Vacating an Auction Unit in SiteLink

- Ensure that all auction fees, taxes, and payments have been added to the account.
- On the SiteLink **Operations** screen, in the **Accounts** box, click **Move Out**.
- In the **Find** column, enter the unit number.
- When you see the correct unit highlighted, click **Next**. The **Move Out** screen will open.
- In the **Payment Options** box, select **Mark remaining charges as bad debt**.
- Click **OK**.
- You will be prompted to make sure the address is correct.

If it is, click **Yes**.

If it's not, click **No** and make corrections.

- When you see the confirmation message, ensure that everything is correct, then click **Yes**.
- Click **Yes** to print a move-out receipt, ledger history, and notes.
Print **two copies** of each document: one for the tenant file and one for the corporate

- office.
- You will see a message that the move out was successful. Click **OK**.

Processing the “After Auction” Paperwork

- Make copies of the auction documents, as follows:
 - Two copies of the Certification of Public Sale form.
 - Two copies of the Tenant Ledger for each tenant/unit.
 - Three copies (four copies if you are submitting paperwork for a refund) of the Lien Sale Final Accounting form. When completed with the money and taxes collected, this document shows the totals for refunds that must go to the collection agency.
 - Four copies of the Refund form (if applicable).
- Email the following to the Auctions and Support Services Manager:
 - Auction Sales Form (fill out and make sure all columns are balanced)
 - Management Summary report labeled **After Auction**
 - Completed Collections Submission spreadsheet (in the Forms folder on your desktop computer).
- Email the following to the collection agency:
 - Completed Collections Submission spreadsheet. You will email it to the collection agency assigned to your facility (Vengroff Williams VWA or AWA).
- Organize documents in the tenant file as follows:
 - Pull everything out of the tenant file with the Rental Agreement on top.
 - Put the auction documents in the file in the following order, top to bottom, and staple or clip them together:
 - Lien Sale Final Accounting form
 - Copy of the Certification of Public Sale
 - Completed Auction Sales form
 - Tenant Ledger
 - Move-Out form
 - Copy of the receipt
 - Any notes you made
 - Staple together the following documents and send them to the Internal Auditor:

- Copy of the Auction Sales form
- Original Lien Sale Final Accounting
- Original Certification of Public Sale
- Tenant Ledger
- Email the completed Auction Sales form to Justine Ganibi at jcganibi@bacorealty.com. Send a blank form if there is no auction.

Note: All yellow copies of the receipts from the manual receipt book are attached to the daily paperwork at the end of the day.

- Store documents on site as follows:
- Clip these files together in date order and put them where you store your other work related to auctions. (Some facilities set up a file drawer or box labeled “Auction Box”):
- Original ad
- Copy of the Past Due Balances report with the notes
- Copies of Lien Sale Final Accounting (copies of all that sold)
- Copies of Certificate of Public Sale (copies of all that sold)
- Auction Sign-in Sheet
- Collections Submission spreadsheet
- Copy of the Management Summary report labeled **Before Auction**
- Copy of the Management Summary report labeled **After Auction**
- Write “Sold at Auction” on the top edge of these documents. This keeps them separate from your current files and makes them easier to find.
- After a year, move these auction files to where you archive your other paperwork.

Vehicle Auction Rules and Procedures

Important: *For Maryland and Virginia facilities*, the Regional Manager acts as the auctioneer. When you know a stored car is being auctioned, contact the Regional Manager to get instructions for how to proceed. *For all other facilities*, follow the instructions in this section.

You cannot begin the delinquency process on any vehicle, whether parked inside a unit or parked in a designated parking or RV stall, until *after* the scheduled auction for the contents of that unit or space is completed.

For the purpose of the delinquency process, a “vehicle” is defined as any car, motorcycle, vessel, or other similar motor-driven apparatus that has been or is currently registered with the Department of Motor Vehicles (DMV) in any state or province.

The condition of any vehicle must be checked to determine whether it should be sold through the DMV, sold “as is,” or sold “for parts only.”

For vehicles that are to be sold “as is” or “for parts only,” you will forego the delinquency

process, but you must get approval from the Auctions and Support Services Manager. Follow the regular auction procedures as you would for selling the contents of any other unit.

To auction a vehicle sold through the DMV:

- Follow the delinquency process as you would for any storage unit, sending a late letter, a pre-lien letter, and a lien letter.
- When you send the lien letter, fill out and fax a **Pat's Lien Service** form to Pat's Lien Service. The fax number is on the form.

Pat's Lien Service is the collection company that SPS uses to sell a vehicle at auction. We provide them with the vehicle information on the form, and they do all the filing with the DMV to get us clearance (the title) to sell the vehicle.

- Advertise the unit or space where the vehicle is stored along with other units up for auction on that same date. However, only include the unit with the vehicle on the first run of the ad (14 days before the auction), then remove it for the second run of the ad (7 days before the auction). Even though it isn't yet ready for sale, advertising is a legal process requirement.
- Continue advertising the vehicle for each monthly auction until Pat's Lien Service notifies you that the vehicle is cleared through the DMV for sale. This may take as long as two to four months.

If someone wants to bid on the vehicle before it has been cleared for sale (because of the first ad you ran), tell them it is not yet ready for auction and to check back with you in a month.

- Pat's Lien Service will contact you when the vehicle is cleared for sale and the paperwork is complete. The service will advertise the car for sale. You do not need to submit any more ad paperwork yourself.

You will receive proof of publication from Pat's Lien Service verifying that they have published the vehicle for auction. **You must have this document before you can sell the vehicle.**

You will also receive paperwork from the DMV naming Security Public Storage as a lien holder on the vehicle and granting SPS authorization to sell the vehicle at a public auction to pay off what is owed on the lien.

- Follow the auction procedures as you would for any rental unit.

Do not charge or collect sales tax for vehicles sold at auction through the DMV.

- Once the auction is complete, there is a mandatory 10-day hold on the vehicle before the buyer can remove it from the facility. This 10-day period is called the "Right to Redemption" and is provided to the previous legal owner. During this time, the previous owner can pay the entire amount due on the account and redeem the vehicle.
 - If the previous owner comes forward during the 10-day period, the sale to the buyer is nullified and you will issue a refund to the buyer as soon as possible. This refund follows the process for auction refunds and is processed by the corporate office. Contact the Auctions and Support Services Manager before you fill out and send the paperwork.
 - If the sale proceeds, follow the rest of the steps below.
- Post the payment from the buyer to the current day's records.

- Organize the vehicle auction paperwork as you would for the unit auctions.
- When the vehicle is finally removed, vacate the unit in SiteLink.

Important: The **buyer** must transfer the vehicle title through the DMV, since that buyer is now the vehicle's legal owner. SPS does not do the title transfer because SPS is never the vehicle's legal owner. SPS only facilitates the sale to pay off the lien.

Charity Storage Units and Auctions

SPS is one of 300 storage companies participating in the Charity Storage program. Charity Storage accepts new or gently used items and then auctions them off at your next regularly scheduled auction. The proceeds are dispersed as follows: 10% goes to the SSA Foundation Scholarship Fund, 30% goes to Kure It Cancer Research, and 60% goes to the SPS designated charity.

Creating a charity auction unit

Contact your Regional Manager before starting a charity auction unit for approval. Once approved, you can accept donations from your customers to be auctioned for the charities named above.

Charity Storage units should be set up in a size code with the highest vacancies.

Do not let the unit sit for months, waiting for additional items to fill it.

Use your best discretion when accepting donated items since we seek value items that can be sold at auction.

Here is a list of what we are looking for:

- Furniture
- WORKING electronics
- Tools
- Usable household items
- Toys

Never accept any of the following for any reason:

- Mattresses (too bulky, and many auction buyers steer clear of mattresses)
- Pornography of any type
- Guns or weapons of any type
- Drugs or drug paraphernalia
- Flammable, hazardous, or toxic material
- Tires
- Perishable food items
- Alcohol or tobacco products
- Items with no value (broken furniture, trash)

When someone donates items, check them against these lists and accompany the donating person

to the Charity Storage unit and unlock it for them so they can put the items in the unit. A manager should **never** help someone load the donated items into the Charity Storage unit. There is the possibility of liability and injury around this activity, and we do not want our managers to be injured during this process.

Once the person has completed loading the donated items, lock and close the door.

Then, if requested, provide a Charity Storage receipt indicating the date, location of the donation, items donated (general – no need to go into great detail), and signature of a facility representative. Receipts may be filled out electronically and emailed to the customer, but if necessary, they can be printed and filled out manually. Upon completion, sign the receipt and give it to the person for their tax records. The receipt can be found in the Forms folder on your desktop computer.

We encourage managers to notify their communities of their status as a Charity Storage drop-off location. The more people know about the program, the more donations you will receive.

Encourage buyers of other auctioned units to donate unwanted items to your charity unit for the next auction. Take advantage of being a Charity Storage facility because this marketing is a great way to get additional rentals.

Setting up a Charity Storage auction

Include the Charity Storage unit in your auction ad by creating an unsuspecting name. Be sure to use the correct unit number.

Create a separate auction sales form listing charity units only.

On auction day:

- View and record the unit's contents with the Auctions and Support Services Manager.
- Record the buyer's name and the amount bid on the auction sales form at the time of sale.
- Collect the amount bid plus sales tax unless the bidder provides a resale license.
- Give the buyer a receipt, including the unit number and amount bid.

After auction:

- Send the Charity Auction Sales form and the Charity Unit Sales form to Justine Ganibi and the Auctions and Support Services Manager.
- **Important:** Make a separate deposit for all proceeds from Charity Storage unit sales.

Chapter 13:

Accident and Emergency Procedures

Important: Security Public Storage is not responsible for any loss to a tenant's property for any reason.

Best Practice: In the event of an accident or emergency, and only after the appropriate steps are taken, create a MaintainX ticket for any repairs needed.

Forms;

Facility Emergency Kit

Preparation is the most important element of addressing emergencies. The emergency kit provides the tools to support you in an emergency. Each facility should have the following items readily available:

- Suggested kits
 - 4-Person Outdoor Kit
 - 4-Person Deluxe Emergency Bucket Kit
 - 3-Person Emergency Kit/Survival Bag
- Emergency contact information (laminated)
- Map of the local area
- Flashlight
- Extra batteries
- Gloves/safety glasses/N95/ poncho

- Whistle
- Waterproof matches and lighter
- Battery-powered or hand-cranked NOAA weather radio
- Multipurpose tool
- Sanitation and personal hygiene items
- Emergency blanket
- First aid kit
- Trash bags (to protect computers in flooding situations)
- Duct tape
- Survival guide: Tiny Pocket Survival Guide

Fire Extinguishers

You must test the facility fire extinguishers once per year.

- Check existing fire extinguisher inspection/maintenance tags for expiration date. The last inspection date is typically hole-punched with month and year. The next inspection due is the same month in the following year.
- If the expiration is within 1-2 months, contact the vendor listed on the inspection tag to schedule service. Most vendors typically have your facility set on a schedule, but it is our responsibility to verify.
- Create a MaintainX ticket:
 - Use the titled “Fire Extinguisher Inspection.” Include expiration date, for example, “Fire Extinguisher Inspection – Expires 02/28/2023.”
 - Include a photo of the inspection tag.
 - Enter a description with the vendor's name, address, and phone number.
 - Enter due date and schedule.
 - Enter your location.
 - Enter vendor (create vendor if necessary).
- When the work is completed, send the invoice and a completed purchase order to the corporate office.
- Best Practice: Enter the last inspection date in your Microsoft Outlook calendar as a recurring reminder to avoid missing future inspections.
- If you have questions about this process, contact your Regional Manager.

Employee Accidents With Injury – Onsite

If you or another employee are injured on site, follow these steps:

- Report the injury to the supervisor IMMEDIATELY upon occurring (NO EXCEPTIONS).
- If the supervisor is unavailable, an employee may call Medcor without the supervisor present.
- The supervisor and the injured worker must report the injury to the Medcor service via phone (1-800-775-5866).
- The Medcor representative (a registered nurse) will take the initial report of the injury, refer the employee to a clinic, if necessary, and provide HR and the Regional Manager with the Report of Injury document.
- Upon receipt of the Report of Injury, HR will contact the supervisor and the employee directly to collect additional information and file the Workers' Compensation claim.

Employee Accidents Without Injury – Onsite

When an employee has an accident on site but you don't see an injury immediately, follow these steps:

- Fill out an incident report.
- Notify your Regional Manager. If your manager is not available, use Who to Contact to reach the next appropriate person.
- Fill out any necessary Workers' Compensation forms.

Employee Accidents – Offsite

For offsite incidents, for example, when an employee is injured when driving to the bank or doing marketing work for your facility, follow these steps:

- Notify your Regional Manager. If your manager is not available, use Who to Contact to reach the next appropriate person.
- For an accident with a vehicle, contact local law enforcement to ensure that an accident report is written.
- Fill out an incident report.
- Fill out any necessary Workers' Compensation forms.

Tenant Injury – Onsite

If the injury is life-threatening, dial 911.

Important: If you have the proper first aid training and choose to assist someone who is injured, you do so at your own risk. Be aware that this could cause potential liability for you despite your good intentions.

When a tenant is injured, follow these steps:

- **DO NOT** touch the tenant.
- If the injury is minor, provide the tenant with a first aid kit.
- If the injury is serious, **DO NOT** administer first aid except in an extreme emergency. **Immediately call 911** and request paramedics.
- Notify your Regional Manager as soon as possible.

- **DO NOT** make any statements about the apparent cause of the injury or imply that the facility is at fault.
- Complete an Incident Report. See the incident report provided at the start of this chapter or click the link to FORMS on the SPS intranet. Be sure to note specific details, time, parties involved, witnesses, etc. Be as thorough as possible. **DO NOT** offer opinions or conjectures in the report. Only include specific facts that pertain to the injury.
- Take any necessary photos as early in discovery as possible before anything is moved or removed or the condition changes.
- Remove the cause of the injury, but **ONLY AFTER** you have completed your report and taken the photos.

Property Damage

When property damage occurs, your **best response is good documentation**. Gather as much documentation about the damage as you can.

Immediately following the incident that caused the damage, follow these steps:

- Complete an Incident Report. See the incident report provided at the start of this chapter or click the link to FORMS on the SPS intranet.
- Be sure to note specific details, such as the time, parties involved, etc. Be as thorough as possible.
- **DO NOT** offer opinions or conjectures in the report. Only include specific facts that pertain to the incident or accident.
- Notify your Regional Manager. If your manager is not available, use Who to Contact to reach the next appropriate person.
- Take as many photos as needed to appropriately document the incident that caused the damage. Download any video related to the incident.
- **DO NOT** talk about liability responsibility or causes of the incident that caused the damage.
- Keep all physical evidence that helps explain what happened or what contributed to the incident that caused the damage.

Police Searches and Warrants

- **If the police call your facility, note the following:**
- We want to assist however possible while maintaining the confidentiality of our tenants.
- We must verify any officer's identity before giving out details. Follow this process:
- Ask for the officer's name, department, and phone number. Tell them you will return their call shortly.
- Look up the department phone number on your work computer.
- Call the main department number you found (which may vary from what they supplied) and ask the operator to connect you to the officer by name. This process will verify that

you're speaking with someone in the department.

- Once verified, you can discuss basic tenant information. A warrant may be required if specific documents or video footage are requested. Contact your Regional Manager for assistance.
- **If the police come to your facility, note the following:**
- Police officers always carry identification and must show it upon demand. If possible, also ask for the officer's business card.
- To search a unit, the police must present a search warrant that allows them to search a particular space(s) belonging to a specific person(s). Ask to make a copy of the warrant.
- **DO NOT** assist any officer in gaining entry to the unit. **DO NOT** give them your bolt cutters or drill to aid in removing the lock. They must do it themselves.
- If the police remove any items from the unit, they must leave a list of what they took as a record for the tenant. The list is usually left in the unit. Try to get a copy of this list for the tenant file. This will protect you from being accused of missing property after the police leave.
- When finished, the police must relock the unit and take the key. The tenant must contact the police to get the key to their lock.
- Don't talk about the nature of the police visit with any other tenants. A search doesn't imply guilt.
- Notify your Regional Manager. If your manager is not available, use Who to Contact to reach the next appropriate person.
- Document the police action in the SiteLink notes for that tenant. **DO NOT** notify the tenant that the unit was searched. Instead, wait until the tenant comes in and asks about it. Most likely, they will already have been informed by the police.
- Fill out an Incident Report. See the incident report provided at the start of this chapter or click the link to FORMS on the SPS intranet.

Emergencies

You should follow emergency procedures for earthquakes, fires, chemical spills, break-ins, and burglaries. Detailed instructions for each type of emergency follow as well as directions for evacuating the facility.

- **It is important to set up a rallying point:**
- Be prepared! Before any emergency occurs, designate a specific location outside the buildings where all employees and your family members should meet following an emergency. **Make sure the location is not near any power lines.**
- When an emergency occurs, go to the rallying point and account for all employees and family members.

Earthquakes

Earthquake Mitigation Activities

As noted, being prepared for an emergency is important. To mitigate the effects of an earthquake, consider the following:

- Upgrade facilities to withstand the shaking effects.
- Anchor water heaters.
- Move large, heavy, or breakable objects to low shelves.
- Fit all gas appliances with flexible connections and/or breakaway gas shut-off devices or have a main gas shut-off device installed.

Earthquakes – Onsite Staff Procedures

- **Do this immediately!**
- Take cover and protect your head and neck against falling objects. If you are:
- In the office, go under a desk or sturdy table and brace yourself.
- Outside or in a storage unit, move into the open, away from buildings, streetlights, and utility wires.
- In a car, stay there.
- Stay away from windows, skylights, and items that could fall.
- Tell those within the sound of your voice to take cover.
- Do not use the elevators. Use the stairs to leave the building if an evacuation is necessary.
- **After the Shaking Stops**
- Assess the immediate area for hazards or threats if you can do so safely. If you are in immediate danger or trapped, call 911. Watch for:
 - Fallen power lines
 - Gas leaks
 - Water main leaks
 - Structural damage or foundation cracks
 - Hazardous chemicals, solvents, and cleaning agents stored at the facility that have toppled over and might be leaking.
- Be careful when emerging from your shelter. Do not use open flames.
- Locate the Emergency Preparedness Manual and Emergency Supply Kit.
- If safe to do so, locate your facility's gas main valve and turn it off.
- Locate everyone on the premises by referencing gate records, if available, and determine whether there are any injuries.
- Do not attempt to move severely injured people unless their lives are in danger where they are. Wait for emergency medical professionals to arrive.
- Notify your Regional Manager. If your manager is not available, use Who to Contact to reach the next appropriate person.
 - Together, determine whether an evacuation appears necessary and whether any local or government agencies should be contacted.
- Stay alert for possible aftershocks.
- Stay away from areas that sustained structural damage until authorities have deemed

them safe.

- If you are in a coastal area, be aware of the possibility of tsunamis and follow the posted evacuation route.
- **If You Are Trapped**
- If you are trapped in debris from an explosion or a building collapse:
 - Do not use an open flame.
 - Stay in your area so that you do not kick up dust.
 - Cover your mouth with clothing or any other fabric available.
 - Tap on a pipe or wall or use any other resource (e.g., cell phone, whistle) so that rescuers can locate you.
 - Shout only as a last resort since it might cause you to inhale dangerous contaminants.
- **If Someone Else Is Trapped (Search and Rescue)**

Search and rescue operations should be conducted only by properly trained and equipped professionals. Death and serious injury can occur when untrained employees attempt to re-enter damaged or contaminated facilities.

- If anyone is injured or trapped:
 - Wait for emergency professionals to arrive. Untrained people should not attempt to rescue someone inside a collapsed building.
 - Do not attempt to move severely injured people unless their lives are in danger where they are. Wait for emergency professionals to arrive.
 - Do not attempt to move people who appear to have spinal or neck injuries. Wait for emergency professionals to arrive.
 - Administer only minor first aid until emergency medical professionals arrive.

Earthquakes – Regional Manager and Director Procedures

- **Do this immediately!**
- Assess the situation based on the description from the onsite staff. This assessment should include determining whether the onsite staff has checked for gas leaks and the immediate condition of the building structure and deciding whether an evacuation is necessary.
- Decide whether outside emergency responders should be contacted. Remember that an emergency that can potentially affect public health and safety must be reported to the local government agencies immediately.
- Continue to check for emergency updates on your cell phone, radio, or television.
- Decide if you should stay offsite or go to the facility.
- Locate the leadership copy of the Emergency Preparedness Manual and the Emergency Supply Kit.
- Contact all key staff (e.g., Directors, Human Resources) to explain the situation and convey that the emergency plan has been activated.
- If a facility needs to be closed for a significant period, discuss the communication plan with leadership.
- Put emergency suppliers and mutual aid partners on notice that their services may be needed.

Fires

- **Do this immediately!**
- Call 911 or the local fire department, regardless of fire size. Activate any fire alarms.
- As you prepare to evacuate:
 - Locate the Emergency Supply Kit and Emergency Preparedness Manual.
 - Grab your iPhone, petty cash, cash drawer, and a fire extinguisher.
 - Keep the fire extinguisher with you at all times.
- Gather all employees and any family members to the specific outside area that you designated as a meeting place in the event of an emergency.
- Locate everyone else on the premises and begin orderly evacuation.
 - Note:** If the fire is not in the office and the facility still has power, use the gate software to identify where customers are on the property so that you can provide accurate information to the first responders.
- Evacuate the building immediately until cleared by the fire department to re-enter the property. Detailed evacuation instructions follow.
- If, and only if, you can do so safely, close windows and doors behind you as you vacate the buildings:
 - Assess the situation: Determine what caused the fire, its current condition and location, the extent of the damage, and whether it resulted in other hazards such as an explosion.
- Once you are in a safe location, contact your Regional Manager. If your manager is not available, use Who to Contact to reach the next appropriate person. Together you will assess the situation, including any actions you have already taken.
- Do not comment about the fire to tenants, reporters, or others. Use a blanket statement that the fire is “under investigation.”

Additional Fire Response Guidelines

- Always call the fire department, regardless of the size of the fire. NEVER assume someone else will call them or has already called them.
- During evacuation:
 - Remember that the safety of the people on the premises is always first and foremost.
 - Wear one of the N95 masks provided to each site. Cover your nose and mouth with a wet cloth if you do not have an N95 mask.
 - NEVER use elevators to evacuate.
 - Stay as close to the floor as possible and exit the building quickly. Heavy smoke and poisonous gases initially collect along the ceiling.
 - If you encounter smoke, take an alternate exit or crawl on the ground underneath the smoke. The air is cleaner and cooler near the floor because heat and smoke tend to rise.
 - Approach and check doors carefully when a fire is burning in the facility. Feel the door with your hand. If the door is cool, open it slowly and exit immediately. If the door is hot, escape through a window or other exit route because opening the door will give the fire more air and may cause an explosion or fireball.
- If the fire is small enough to be extinguished, you should still call the fire department.

Even small fires can quickly grow out of control.

- To put out a small fire, remove its air or fuel or cool it with water or fire-extinguishing chemicals.
- Do not try to put out a fire that is growing or spreading out of control. Evacuate before it is too late.
- NEVER fight a fire if your escape route can become blocked if the fire spreads.
- NEVER fight a fire if you are unsure how to correctly use the fire extinguisher or are unsure of the type of fire, i.e., the materials that are serving as the fire's fuel.
- NEVER use water on an electrical fire.
- If you use a fire extinguisher, use only the type designated as appropriate for that specific type of fire.

General Considerations

- If your clothes are on fire, you should STOP, DROP, and ROLL:
 - STOP – Don't run, which will make your clothes burn faster.
 - DROP – Lie down because this makes it harder for the fire to spread, especially to your face and head, because flames burn upward.
 - ROLL – Rolling smothers the flames. You can also use heavy material like a coat or blanket to smother the flames.
- Try to control access to the area so that customers and non-authorized people cannot enter, but only if you can do so safely.
- Coordinate contacting staff family members with HR if the situation warrants it.
- Start and maintain a comprehensive incident report, including as much detail as possible. Include the five Ws: What? When? Where? Why? Who? This information will be useful when evaluating the company's response to the emergency.

Emergency Evacuations

Evacuation Preparation and Exit:

- Unplug all appliances.
- Close and lock all windows and doors unless flooding is likely (refer to next section).
- Turn off the main water valve.
- Depending on the threat, you also may want to turn off the electricity and gas valves. Remember that if you turn off the gas, a trained professional must turn it back on. **Do not** attempt to do this yourself.
- Follow the recommended evacuation routes.

If Flooding Is Likely:

- Turn off the main power switch if it is likely to become submerged.
- Store propane tanks and other potentially hazardous materials or secure them safely to the structure.
- Leave building doors and windows open at least 2" to equalize pressure and help prevent the building from shifting.

Returning to the Facility After an Emergency Evacuation:

- Do not return until local officials say it is safe. Use extreme caution when entering any damaged building.
- Wear an N95 mask, sturdy shoes, heavy gloves, and a hard hat when handling or walking through debris.

- Do not use an open flame! Use battery-powered flashlights or lanterns. If you suspect a gas leak, discontinue using light because the light itself could cause an explosion. Leave the building and contact the utility company immediately.
- If you smell gas, turn off the main gas valve at the meter or call the local utility company. Open windows if you can do so safely.
- Notify the power company and/or fire department if you see fallen or damaged electrical wires.
- Check the foundation, columns, and walls for instability or other damage. If walls have cracked or settled badly, temporarily reinforcing or bracing them may be necessary before more extensive repair work can be performed. Bring in a qualified contractor to assess foundation damage as soon as possible.
- If there was flooding/water damage:
- If any appliances are wet, turn off the main electrical power switch in the building before unplugging them. Wear rubber gloves and rubber-soled shoes when touching electrical switches, and do not touch them if you are standing in water. Dry out appliances, wall switches, and sockets before plugging them in again.
- Before entering a flooded basement, turn off electrical power, preferably at the meter, and turn off gas or fuel service valves. Check outside walls first for evidence of cave-ins or significant structural damage. Open doors and windows, and use a blower to force fresh air into the basement and evacuate any fumes.
- If the basement is flooded, pump out only one-third of the water per day to ensure that pressure from water-logged soil outside does not damage the foundation. Standing water in a basement may be protecting the foundation from outside pressure.
- Watch for poisonous snakes in flooded structures.
- Begin cleanup of flood-soaked walls and materials immediately to prevent mold and mildew, using a bleach solution.

Recovery:

- Designate a recovery team.
- Establish priorities for resuming operations.
- Assess any remaining hazards.
- Maintain security and limit access to the incident scene.
- Investigate and brief employees.
- Keep detailed records. Consider audio recording all observations and decisions for future reference.
- Photograph and videotape any damage. This will help with insurance matters.
- Coordinate with Human Resources to notify family members about the status of onsite staff.
- Update insurance carriers and appropriate local government agencies. Follow their advice on the next steps.
- Protect undamaged property and equipment against moisture and other elements using tarps or plastic sheeting.
- Close building openings to prevent further damage from the elements.
- Remove smoke, water, and debris.
- Restore power.
- Oversee salvage operations:
 - Segregate damaged from undamaged property.
 - Keep damaged goods on hand until an insurance adjuster has visited the premises.

- Move damaged goods outside if they create a major obstruction and if exposure to the elements will not worsen matters.
- Take an inventory of damaged goods. This is usually done with the insurance adjuster or the adjuster's salvor. If you release the goods to the designated staff, obtain a signed inventory.
- Restore equipment and property. Review restoration plans with the insurance adjuster and appropriate government agencies for major repair work.
- Assess the value of damaged property.
- Assess the impact of business interruption.
- Check the roof for missing or damaged shingles, loose nails, or screws on metal roofing if it is safe.

Chemical Spills, Gas Leaks, and Discoveries

- **Important:** Refer to your chemical binder and use a spill kit as needed.
- If you discover or even suspect nauseous fumes or liquid spillage (other than ordinary water), **immediately call your Regional Manager** to determine next steps. If your manager is not available, use Who to Contact to reach the next appropriate person.
- If you cannot reach your Regional Manager and believe the substance is flammable, **call 911 immediately** to report the hazardous materials/chemical spill. Provide the following information:
 - Name
 - Facility location
 - Phone number
 - Which gate to use for entering the facility
 - Whether or not there are any injuries
- **After reporting the incident, follow these steps:**
 - **DO NOT** rush into the area or touch any spilled material. **ALWAYS** assume it could be hazardous materials.
 - Move people away from the area and keep them away. Always use stairs in the event of an emergency to evacuate the building.
 - Wear a mask and avoid inhaling fumes, smoke, or vapors, even if no hazardous materials are visible. Don't assume that any gases are harmless because they lack a smell.
 - You do not need to contact any tenants unless you feel the spill may have directly contacted a tenant's items. Please discuss with your Regional Manager before contacting tenants.
 - Determine with your Regional Manager if there is a need to block access to the facility during cleanup, depending on the spill's size and the material.
 - Locate your Safety Data Sheet (yellow binder) for instructions about how to handle the material.
 - **Here is a list of potentially dangerous materials:**
 - Petroleum hydrocarbon products, including benzene, ethyl, xylene, and toluene
 - Heavy metals, including arsenic, beryllium, cadmium, chromium, lead, and mercury

- Herbicides, including 2,4-D or 2,4,5-T
- Pesticides and insecticides, including DDT, aldrin, dieldrin, malathion, and parathion
- Insulation or surfacing materials containing chrysotile, asbestos, or amosite
- Polychlorinated biphenyls, which are found in the oil of older electrical transformers and other industrial applications
- Chlorine, muriatic acid, and other chemicals used for pools, disinfectants, and cleaning agents

Security System Outages

Planned Short-Term Outage (three hours or less)

- Except for the gates do not tip off any tenant about alarm or camera issues. Such issues must be kept confidential until they can be resolved.
- *Onsite Manager Response*
 - Alarms
 - Manager will patrol the property, understand who is on the property, and use cameras to monitor the property.

Take notes of people who are at their units and monitor every person's activity.

 - At the beginning and end of the outage period, perform a lock check to verify that all units are secured with a tenant lock or vacant spaces lock. Inspect any unit found unlocked.
 - Gates
 - Patrol property every 15-30 minutes to monitor cameras and tenant activity.
 - Place a note on the keypad that tenants must enter the office and sign in.
 - If facility has entrance and exit gates, route all traffic through the entrance gate to minimize the opportunity for people to come in without being seen.
 - Camera
 - Patrol property thoroughly every 15-30 minutes, check the gate activity log, and verify that the people logged in are at their unit.

Be very visible. Drive by every tenant on the property.

 - Power down monitors until they are back online to minimize exposure to the outage.
- *Maintenance Response*
 - Tech will contact Kevin Young, Regional Manager, Steve Ford, and site staff with the expected outage window.
 - Tech will send updates to the group beginning, periodically throughout, and after scheduled work.

- Planned outage should have two maintenance crew members onsite, one to perform work and the second to provide additional eyes and security of property.

Planned Long-Term Outage (three hours or more)

- Except for the gates do not tip off any tenant about alarm or camera issues. Such issues must be kept confidential until they can be resolved.

- Regional Managers should make every attempt to be onsite to monitor the situation

- *Onsite Manager Response*

- Alarms

- Manager will patrol the property, understand who is on the property, and use cameras to monitor the property.

Take notes of people who are at their units and monitor every person's activity.

- During each hour during the outage, perform a lock check to verify that all units are secured with a tenant lock or vacant spaces lock. Inspect any unit found unlocked.
- Contact your Regional Manager as additional staffing or resources may need to be allocated to your property.
 - Gates
 - Patrol property every 15-30 minutes to monitor cameras and tenant activity.
 - Place a note on the keypad that tenants must enter the office and sign in.
 - If facility has entrance and exit gates, route all traffic through the entrance gate to minimize the opportunity for people to come in without being seen.
 - Perform a lock check to verify that all units are secured with a tenant lock or vacant spaces lock. Inspect any unit found unlocked.
 - Contact your Regional Manager as additional staffing or resources may need to be allocated to your property.
 - If the outage is past office hours, close the property. Secure gates, note on all keypads that the facility will be closed due to unexpected issues the remainder of the day and will reopen at 9:00 a.m. the following morning.
 - Camera
 - Site staff will contact the Regional Manager to check in hourly on property condition and system status.

- Consider staggered shifts if outages extend before or after normal office hours. Review with the Regional Manager.
 - Perform a lock check to verify that all units are secured with a tenant lock or vacant spaces lock each hour. Inspect any unit found unlocked.
- *Maintenance Response*
 - Tech will contact Kevin Young, Regional Manager, Steve Ford, and site staff ahead of a scheduled outage to inform them of the nature of the work and the length of anticipated resolution.
 - Tech will send updates to the group at the beginning, periodically throughout, and after the scheduled work.
 - For a planned outage, there should be at least two members of maintenance to complete the work and provide additional security for the property.

Unplanned Outage

- Immediately contact your Regional Manager or director.
- Contact Kevin Young in the maintenance department.
- Post in MaintainX.
- Except the gates do not tip off any tenant about alarm or camera issues. Such issues must be kept confidential until they can be resolved.
- The Regional Manager should immediately reroute to the facility to assist in securing property in the event of any outages.
- *Onsite Manager Response*
 - Alarms
 - Manager will patrol the property, understand who is on the property, and use cameras to monitor the property.
 - Take notes of people who are at their units and monitor every person's activity.
 - Perform a lock check to verify that all units are secured with a tenant lock or vacant spaces lock each hour during an outage. Inspect any unit found unlocked.
 - Contact your Regional Manager as additional staffing or resources may need to be allocated to your property.
 - Facility operation may need to be limited to office hours; contact your Regional Manager to assess.
- Gates

- Patrol property every 15-30 minutes and monitor cameras and tenant activity.
 - Perform a lock check hourly to verify that all units are secured with a tenant lock or vacant spaces lock. Inspect any unit found unlocked.
 - Note on the keypad that tenants must enter the office and sign in.
 - If facility has entrance and exit gates, route all traffic through the entrance gate to minimize the opportunity for people to come in without being seen.
 - If the outage is past office hours, close the property. Secure gates, note on all keypads that the facility will be closed due to unexpected issues the remainder of the day and will reopen at 9:00 a.m. the following morning.
- Camera
 - Vigilance will be key; monitor gate logs and alarm activity and be very aware of who is on the property.
 - Site staff will contact the Regional Manager to check in hourly on property condition and system status.
 - Consider staggered shifts if outages extend before or after normal office operating hours. Review with the Regional Manager.
 - Perform a lock check to verify that all units are secured with a tenant lock or vacant spaces lock each hour. Inspect any unit found unlocked.
- *Maintenance Response*
 - Kevin will notify regionals, directors, and Steve Ford of the outage. Internal tech team will respond and contact vendors where/ if needed.
 - Mobilize emergency response. Kevin will send as many technicians as possible to restore service and secure the site.
 - Maintenance response team will contact the Regional Manager, director in charge of the region, and Steve Ford and will provide frequent updates on estimated arrival at the site, resolution, and status.

Break-Ins and Burglaries

In the event of a break-in:

- Notify your Regional Manager as soon as possible.
- Call the police **ONLY** in cases of vandalism or loss **to company property**. For example, if a tenant unit is broken into and our door is damaged, you can call the police regarding the damage to SPS property—but **not** the damage or loss to the tenant property. The tenant would need to file a police report for their own loss.
- Fill out an Incident Report. See the incident report provided at the start of this chapter or

click the link to FORMS on the SPS intranet. Be as complete and accurate as possible. Send the report to your Regional Manager.

- Make a list of all tenants whose rental units have been directly affected.
- Don't make any comments to the press about details of the break-in.
- Make a backup disk of the camera activity in the area of the break-in or damage (Contact the Maintenance Supervisor for assistance if needed).
- Attach a lock (use one from your inventory, not an overlock) and charge the tenant. Put the keys inside before locking the padlock, which assures the tenant that your staff doesn't have access to the unit. In this way, you're maintaining the property in a safe, secure location and guaranteeing the tenant that everything will be as it was left after the break-in.
- The tenant must come into the office and sign a lock out release form (in the Forms folder on your desktop computer) before you can remove the lock. This protects SPS from any liability regarding the contents of the unit.
- If structural damage requires assistance securing the property or location, contact your Regional Manager or Maintenance Supervisor for further instructions.

Robberies, Civil Unrest, and Other Potentially Threatening Events

We must be prepared for worst-case scenarios to help maintain the safety of our employees and tenants. Your safety is paramount; physical property can be replaced, but you cannot.

Robberies

- Prevention is extremely important to avoid being targeted for a robbery:
 - Make it a habit to handle cash out of sight of the front door and customers when not directly engaged with them in a transaction.
 - If outside of business hours, secure doors and count cash out of sight.
 - Keep minimum quantities of cash in cash drawers by depositing cash payments into safes. Keep receipts for the close of business cash count.
 - In the event of a robbery:
- **Important:** Do not attempt to use the panic button to call the police during a robbery. This can create a hostage situation.
 - Stay calm and do not resist. Do nothing that will put you or others at risk.
 - Do not argue.
 - Obey the robber's orders.
 - Let the robber know you intend to obey.
 - If you are not sure what the robber is telling you to do, ask.
 - Give the robber the money.
 - Do not make any sudden moves.
 - If you must reach for something, tell the robber what to expect.
 - Do nothing that will agitate, threaten, surprise, or startle the robber.

- Do not chase or follow the robber.
- Focus on remembering the details about the robber:
 - Hair color
 - Height
 - Weight
 - Voice
 - Age
 - Clothing
 - Distinguishing marks, e.g., tattoos, scars
 - Noticeable traits, e.g., limp, accent, glasses, left- or right-handed
 - If they touched anything so that you can preserve it for fingerprints
 - Do not touch anything that has fingerprints.
- **After the robber leaves**, lock all doors and immediately call the police.
 - Do not hang up with police until you are told to do so.
 - Keep police and any other emergency numbers on or near the telephone.
 - Notify your Regional Manager. If your manager is not available, use Who to Contact to reach the next appropriate person.
- Try to notify all affected tenants as soon as possible.
- **Do not** tell tenants that there was a break-in. Tell them that their rental units were found to have the lock broken or missing.
- Tell the tenants they should “contact their insurance company concerning any loss.” Security Public Storage is not responsible for break-ins.
- Document all of your contacts and conversations with affected tenants. Note your conversation's time, date, and content.
- If requested by the tenants, give them any information they need about Xercor Insurance Company.

Civil Unrest

- If you observe a disturbance such as a riot, demonstration, or other threatening situation:
 - Lock all doors, windows, and lower steel gates (if available) if it's safe to do so.
 - Call the police by dialing 911.
 - Provide the address, location, and other details to the dispatcher.
 - Do not provoke or become part of the disturbance.
 - Secure your work area, log off computers, and secure sensitive files, if it's safe to do so.
 - Remain inside and away from doors and windows if the disturbance is outside.
 - Stay low.

- If you are confronted by angry, belligerent, or violent individuals, follow these steps:
 - Remain calm.
 - Be courteous and confident.
 - Allow the person to express their feelings and concerns.
 - Listen respectfully and objectively.
 - Alert the police immediately if a threat exists.
 - Notify your Regional Manager. If your manager is not available, use Who to Contact to reach the next appropriate person.
 - **Do not:**
 - Corner or crowd the person
 - Attempt to touch the person
 - Disregard or ignore the person
 - Blame anyone

Facility and Operational Problems

• Loss of Data or Facility Records

The loss of your business records might be devastating. However, data loss is the one emergency you can be the best prepared for.

Think about it. What if your facility burned down tomorrow? How long would it take you to retrieve all your records? Could you replace everything and maintain continuity?

Note that all of the operating software is backed up automatically online. All email is backed up on the Baco Realty server.

The corporate office has a copy of all auction-related paperwork and Rental Agreements as of each Monday mailing.

Each Regional Manager has copies of all forms on a flash drive.

Here are the things **you** should do to maintain the integrity of your data:

- Keep daily deposits, records, and backup data in a secured location, such as a locked file cabinet or storage unit.
- Notify your Regional Manager as soon as possible about any data loss. If your manager is unavailable, use Who to Contact to reach the next appropriate person.
- Keep all facility-related papers dry and store them for seven years. After seven years, shred the documents.

• Problems With the Gate

If the gate stops working or gets stuck, contact the Maintenance Supervisor. You can also:

- Check Storlogix Falcon relays that may be held open.
- Check any locked open manual gate switches.
- Check photocells for property alignment:
 - Use a white piece of paper to see if you can see a red beam near the reflector.
 - Align as needed.
- Safely check gate tracks and gates for obstructions:
 - Power off the gate system before attempting to remove any obstructions.
 - Do not attempt obstruction removal if you are uncomfortable with gate systems,

as serious injuries can occur.

- Check Plug for PTI Box.
- **Problems With the Phones**
- Troubleshooting:
 - Unplug Vonage phone power source and Yealink router for 3-5 minutes and power back on.
 - Restart your store cell phone. Once on, turn off WiFi and open the Vonage app.
- Make a test call with your Vonage phone to your store cell phone to confirm if it works.

If the phones are still not working after troubleshooting, use your store cell phone to contact your Regional Manager. If your manager is not available, use Who to Contact to reach the next appropriate person.

- **Problems With the Internet**
- Troubleshooting:
 - Remove the power from your router for 3-5 minutes and plug it back in. Once your router has a constant “internet” indicator light, reboot your PC.
 - Once your PC has restarted, go to any web browser and check for internet connectivity.
- If rebooting the router and your PC does not work, contact your regional manager or use Who to Contact to reach the next appropriate person.
- Best practices:
 - Use your store cell phone to create a hotspot for the internet.
 - Use SiteLink MyHub to access account information and complete payment or rental activities.
- **Power Outages**

If the power goes out:

- Use your cell phone to contact your Regional Manager. If your manager is not available, use Who to Contact to reach the next appropriate person.
 - Using a flashlight, walk the property and ask any tenants you see to exit the property for general safety. Check elevators, emergency exit stairwells, restrooms (knock first), and all other areas in your building.
- Obtain phone numbers and inform tenants of power restoration when appropriate.
 - Best practice: Make note of any non-functional emergency exit signs and floodlights to enter in MaintainX when power is restored.

Chapter 14:

U-Haul

Daily Opening

Check the night drop for keys and check in any after-hour drop-offs as needed.

Daily Closing

Verify your daily deposit as follows:

Go to the U-Haul **Web Best** site.

Click Reporting, Closing, then Preliminary.

Verify **Net amount due** is \$0.

- If there is a negative, you need to see which reservation caused this and resolve it on the current day. If you cannot, follow up the following day.
- If there is a negative balance, verify the charges are for cleaning or after-hours charges. Print out the contracts with those charges.

Weekly Bank Deposit/Monday Final Closing

Go to the U-Haul **Web Best** site.

Click Reporting, Closing, Reprint, then select the most recent Monday Closing Report.

Select Reprint to print Monday Final Closing Report.

Make copies of any cleaning fee contracts from the previous week. Cleaning fees on U-Haul rentals should only be charged by credit card; there should be no cash transactions for cleaning.

Inventory

Inventory needs to be counted at least once per month. If there are any discrepancies, contact your Area Field Manager (AFM) or Regional Manager. To check your inventory:

- Go to the U-Haul **Web Best** site.
- Click **Reporting**, then **Inventory**.
- Select **Display All** from the drop-down.
- Verify that all equipment is on the property, keeping in mind that some equipment will be

rented out at the moment.

Level 1 Inspections

Read and follow the instructions on the U-Haul app, which is updated periodically.

- The first step is to match the equipment number of the vehicle with the customer's name. Make sure you return the right equipment.
- Ask the customer to turn on the headlights and hazard lights of the vehicle, even if they are returning a trailer.
- Walk around the vehicle/trailer with a tire knocker to check the air pressure in the tires. Also check for any new damage to the equipment.
- Check the back of the equipment to see if it has been returned clean. If it needs more than light sweeping, inform the customer that there will be a \$25 minimum cleaning fee. (You can charge more for extremely dirty equipment or trash left in the back.)
- When you get to the back of the equipment, ask the customer to step on their brakes to check the brake lights.
- Ensure that all extra rental equipment is returned (dollies, furniture pads, etc.).
- If the customer is returning a truck, ask them to step out so you can check the fuel gauge and odometer. (If fuel was returned at a lesser amount, advise the customer that there will be a fuel charge or that they can get the missing gas themselves. There is an additional \$30 fee if the tank is below 1/4.)
- Check under the hood of vehicles to see if the coolant or windshield wiper fluid is low.
- If any dashboard lights stay on while the engine is running (other than the tow-haul light), down the vehicle on your equipment scheduling log and contact U-Haul repairs to get your equipment customer-ready. Use an on-board diagnostic reader to identify the engine light code to check engine lights.
- Clean the equipment as needed for the next customer.
- Once you have completed the Level 1 inspection, put your verification sticker on the equipment and shut the equipment as appropriate.

Ordering Free Supplies

You will need supplies to complete Level 1 inspections. To order free supplies through U-Haul:

- Go to the U-Haul **Web Best** site.
- Click **Buyer's Club**.
- Under **Free Supplies**, click **Level 1 Tools & Supplies**.
- If you have any questions, contact your AFM.

Negative Balances

If you end a day with a negative balance, please verify the reason. If your Monday Final Closing has a negative balance, that amount will be added to your next monthly commission. If you have

any questions, contact your AFM.

Commissions

Your U-Haul commission should be processed by the second week of the month. For any discrepancies or questions, contact your AFM or Regional Manager. To view your commission statement:

- Go to the U-Haul **Web Best** site.
- Click **Financial**.
- Click **View Complete Statement**.
- Click **Print a Copy** (bottom of statement).

All commissions are calculated based on hours worked at the facility and will be calculated by HR and the Senior Manager of Field Operations. Commission statements for the previous month will be distributed to employees by the Regional Manager.

Demo Site

A demo site is available as a sandbox to test and learn the U-Haul system. To access this site:

- Go to the U-Haul **Web Best** site.
- From **Point of Sale**, click **Log Out** (bottom right corner).
- Log in using your username and password.
- Click **Want to Practice?** Enter the Location # associated with you for **dealers**.

Important: While the demo site will appear to complete rentals as normal, it will not process anything. Be sure to log out and in to the live system before completing rentals.

Miscellaneous

Contact information for your AFM, Traffic Control Manager, Marketing Company President, and Executive Assistant is located on the U-Haul home page.

Contact your AFM for any questions that are not addressed in this chapter or for further explanation on procedures such as rentals, returns, transfers, reversals, modifications, reservations, rotation equipment, call-backs, follow-ups, repairs, stolen, missing, or damaged equipment, U-Haul Messenger, and prices.

Chapter 15:

Computer Troubleshooting

Installing, uninstalling, or reinstalling any software is not allowed.

Opening attachments or clicking links from unknown email senders is **HIGHLY** prohibited.

When in doubt or for any problems you aren't comfortable addressing, seek technical support.

	SYMPTOM	CAUSE	STEP 1	STEP 2	STEP 3
GENERAL	The computer will not turn on.	Power issue	Check power cable. Confirm power cable is connected securely to the back of the PC and the wall's electrical outlet. Unplug the PC from power for 60 seconds.	Reset the power strip, surge protector, or UPS. Know what else may be plugged in to these devices, and shut off individual items <i>before</i> resetting.	If the problem persists, seek further assistance.
	Lag, slow-down, freeze, etc.	Various	Restart computer.	If the problem persists, seek further assistance.	
	“Blue screen of death” (Stop error)	Various	Write down the Stop error that is on the screen and seek further assistance.		

PRINTER	The printer will not print.	Power issue, stuck queue	Restart printer. Turn the printer off, unplug the power cable for 60 seconds, plug the cable back in, and turn the printer back on.	Restart computer. Check/clear printer queue. Double-click the printer icon in the system tray. Clear any documents by going to Printer > Cancel All Documents.	If the problem persists, seek further assistance.
INTERNET	No internet connection	Computer error, router or modem problem, ISP outage	Restart computer and modem/router. Turn off the computer. Unplug the power cable from the modem or router, wait 60 seconds, and reconnect the power cable. Turn the computer back on.	If the problem persists after 10 minutes, seek further assistance.	

	SYMPTOM	CAUSE	STEP 1	STEP 2	STEP 3
INTERNET (CONTINUE D)	Browser (Firefox, Internet Explorer, Google, etc.), pop-ups, or redirects don't look right.	Malware or zoom settings	In your browser, press CTRL+0 to reset your zoom settings. Restart browser.	If the problem persists, seek further assistance.	

	Website error: "There is a problem with this website's security certificate"	Incorrect system clock	Confirm that the computer's date and time are correct. Click on the clock in the system tray. If the date/time is incorrect, select Change date and time settings (at the bottom). From the pop-up, select Change date and time. Set correctly and hit OK. Under the Internet Time tab, confirm that it is set to automatically synchronize with an internet source (commonly time.windows.com).	If the problem persists, seek further assistance.	
--	--	-------------------------------	--	--	--

	Create a bookmark or favorite.	N/A	In Firefox, navigate to the desired page and select the star icon in the toolbar at the top of the window. Edit details in the pop-up (if desired) and select Done . Alternative shortcut: Ctrl+D.	In Internet Explorer, navigate to the desired page and select the star icon in the toolbar at the top of the window. Select Add to Favorites . Edit details in the pop-up (if desired) and select Add . Alternative shortcut: Ctrl+D.	
	Error: “Server not found”	No internet connection	Refresh page. Press F5 (or click the circular arrow icon in the address bar).	Follow instructions for "No Internet connection" above.	
	404 error: “Not Found” or similar	URL typo, outdated bookmark, etc.	Refresh page. Press F5 (or click the circular arrow icon in the address bar).	Check for URL address typo. If you manually typed the URL address, double-check for possible typos. Correct and try again.	If you navigated from a bookmark, the link is outdated or the address has changed. Find a valid/current URL.

SITELINK	The system fails to save or update data.	Database problem	Log out of SiteLink. Note your Corporate and Location Codes on the log-in screen. (C950, L0XX)	Maintenance . On the log-in screen, select Maintenance, then Reset Local Database. Once complete, click Launch Live Update and follow the prompts. SiteLink will close once complete.	Relaunch SiteLink. Log in using your Corporate and Location Codes.
----------	---	------------------	--	--	--

Chapter 16:

Audit Preparedness

Your facility may be audited to verify that all areas of operation are in compliance and meet SPS standards. The audit may be audited by your Regional Manager or by a director, senior manager, or corporate auditor.

The following areas will be reviewed during the audit:

- **Cash Drawer**

Your facility should have \$200 in operating cash (some facilities may vary). There is zero tolerance for cash discrepancies.

Important: Do not keep spare change in the cash drawer. If you find loose change on the grounds, keep it elsewhere.

- **Petty Cash**

Your facility should have \$200 in petty cash.

- **Hand Receipts**

- **Deposits**

- **Exceptions**

Your Regional Manager or a senior manager or director must approve the following:

- Waived fees
- Deviations binder
- Ghost tenants
- Jumpers
- **Walk-Throughs**
- **Merchandise Counts**
- **Overlocks**
- **Vacant Units That Are Not Rent-Ready**
- **Cleanliness**

Office, bathroom, and facility grounds

- **Files**
- **File Organization**

The tenant files should be organized as follows.

- **File Completeness**

The auditor will verify that all files are complete. Any missing elements are subject to deduction. Files should include:

- Contract
- CIS, if applicable
- Rules and Regulations
- Insurance Addendum (or homeowners insurance declarations page if self-insured)
- Discount Addendum, if applicable
- Copy of ID
- Fiduciary Agreement, if applicable
- Vehicle registration and proof of insurance, if applicable
- Payment Authorization, if applicable
- Account Changes, if applicable

- **Discount Errors**

The auditor will review any applied discounts for effective date, percent, age, dollar amount given, and number of months applied. There are separate categories for simple mistakes, such as a simple date error, and for more complex mistakes that impact the amount of money due or discounted.

- **Safety and Compliance**

- **Compliance Posters**

The auditor will verify that the current year's compliance posters are posted. This section is not a deduction against the facility.

- **Safety Meetings and Binders**

The auditor will verify that all records of monthly safety meetings have been filed in the appropriate binder for future reference.

- **Elevators**

The auditor will inspect each elevator permit to verify that it is current.

- **Fire Prevention**

The auditor will verify that the fire extinguishers have been tested within the last year and are holding correct pressure.

- **Smoke Detectors**

The auditor will verify that the office has properly equipped smoke detectors.

- **Fire Hydrant**

The auditor will verify that the fire hydrant on the property is in proper working order and has had annual inspections.